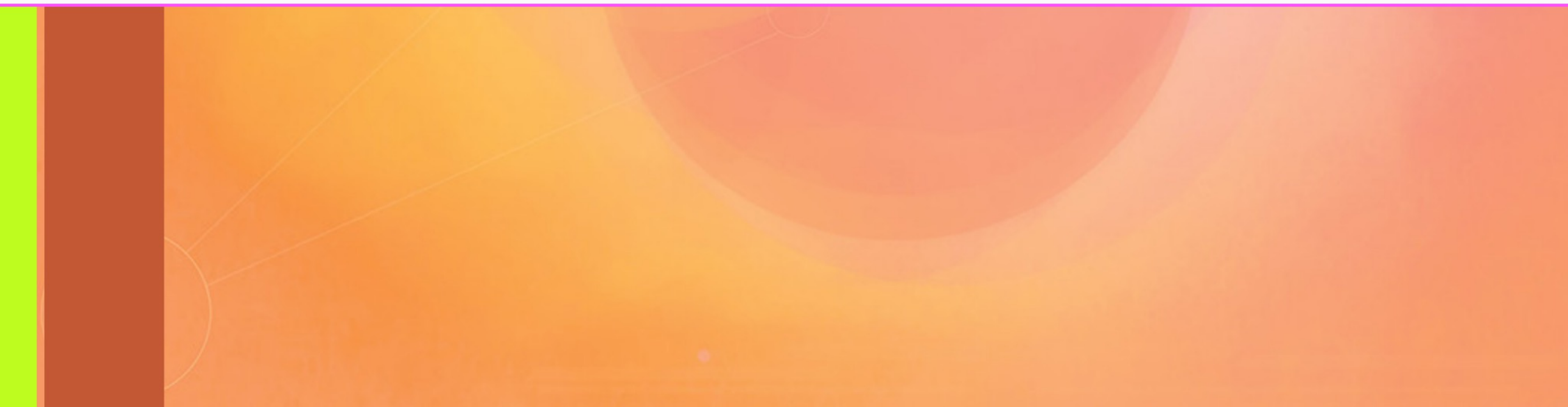
case studies

Lead UX designer for AI products.

Four case studies, each with the calls I made,

how I led the team, and what came of them.

michaelthibodea(UX)
www.michaeljthibodeau.com



POINT OF VIEW

I design trust into high-stakes business decisions.

AI verifies; the person decides

AI translates, explains and checks the user's own criteria. It never recommends, predicts or places orders.

Measurements, not confidence scores

Show what was measured and how often it held, with sample sizes. Abstain when the data isn't there.

Consequences before commitment

Rules are replayed on recent history before they're saved. Every change is logged, with Undo.

Guidance that fits the frequency

Daily users get help that fades with fluency. Rare tasks, like OBI and MOCA, get a short guided path.

CREDIT SUISSE · WELLS FARGO · AMEX · FINVIZ

CASE STUDY 01 · AI PRODUCT · CONCEPT

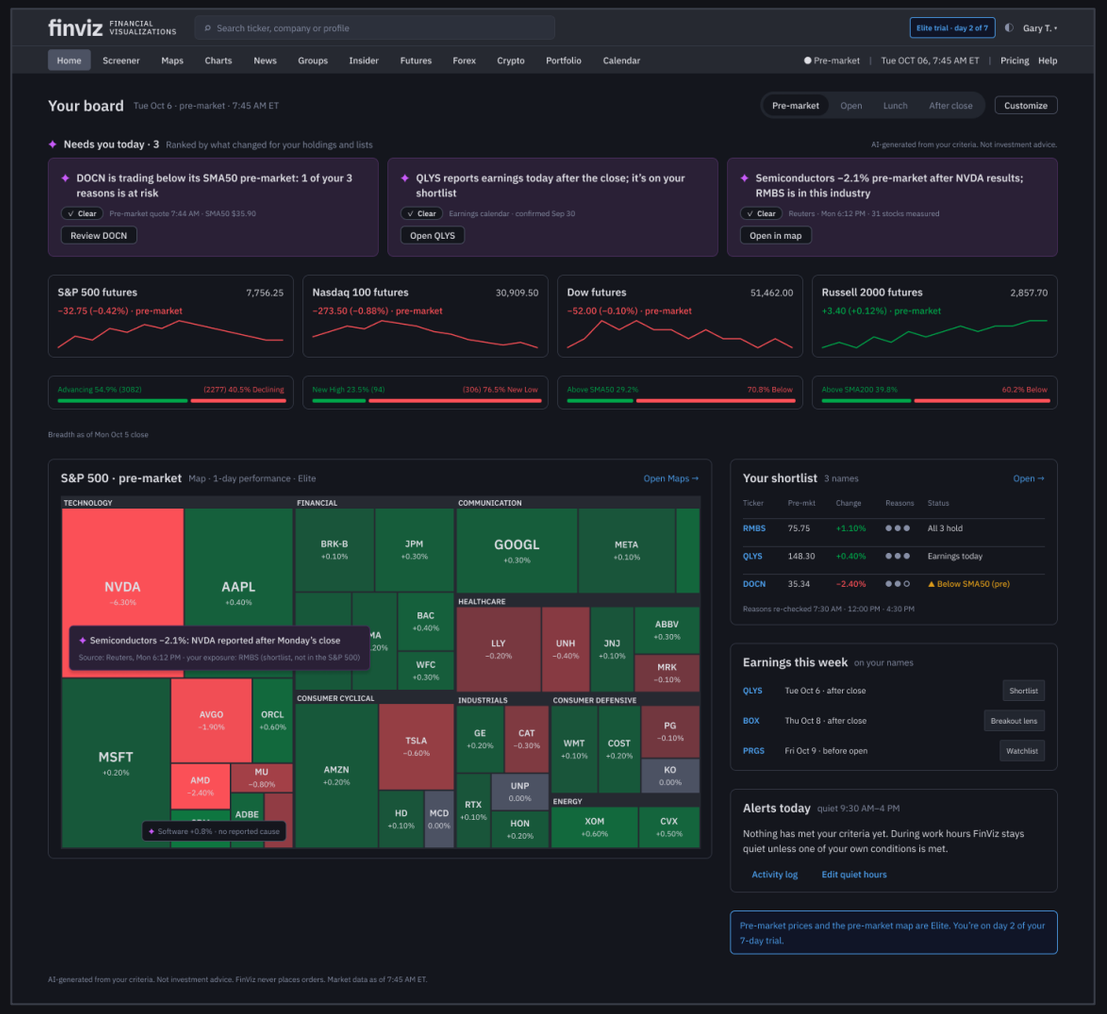
FinViz

AI Screener: The Trading Day

Getting new traders to a screen they trust in their first session, then watching it for them. Goal: cut sign-up to Elite from 42 to 21 days.

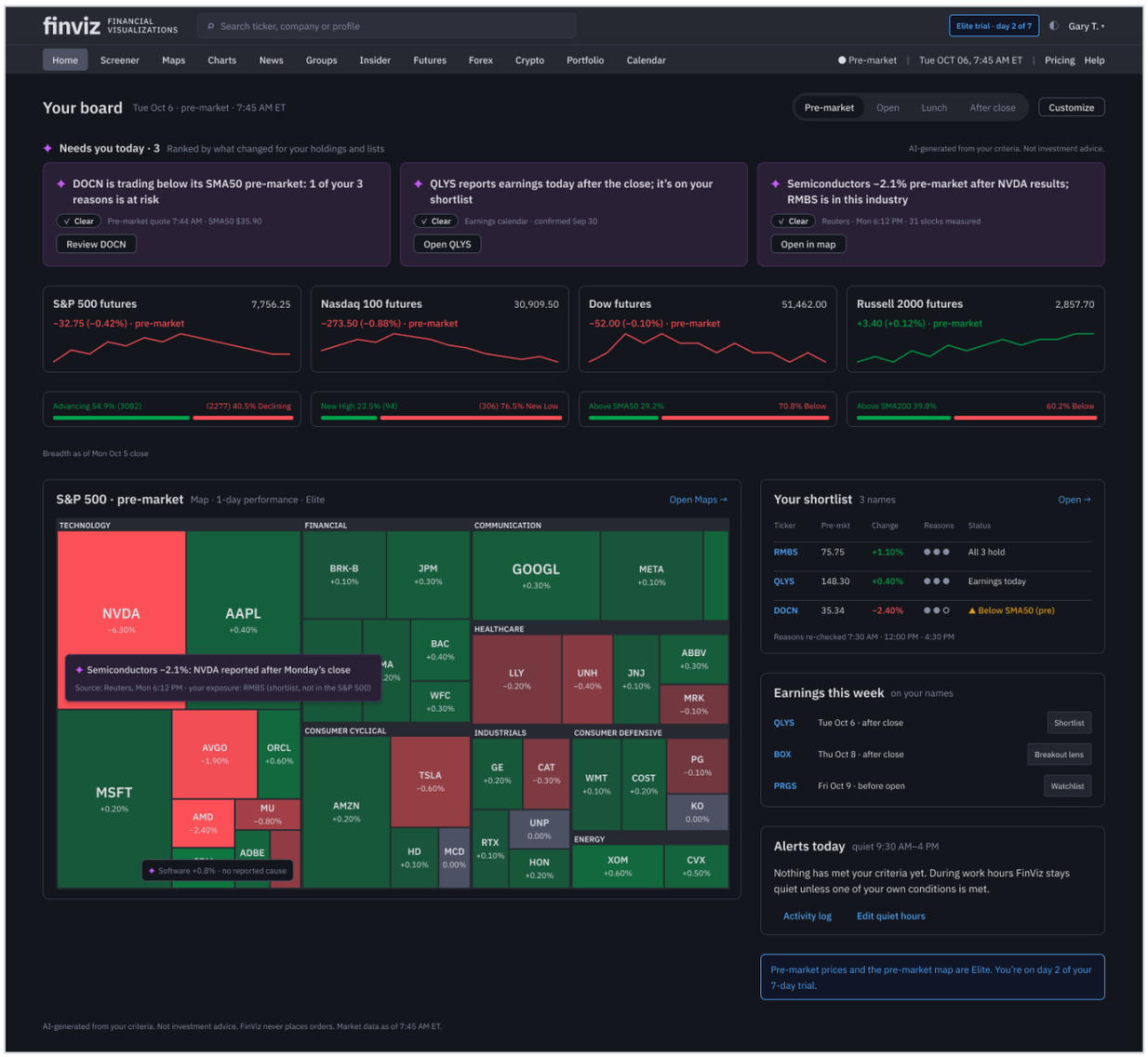
ROLE	Lead UX designer
TEAM	Solo lead with AI agents for drafting; four design reviewers
SCOPE	Research to hi-fi: 19 screens, design system, live prototype
STATUS	Concept. Tests are set; none has run yet

“Alerts are everything. Once you close FinViz, you get nothing.”



FINVIZ AI SCREENER · OVERVIEW

The Trading Day: FinViz keeps watch while you work



HERO The Insight Board at 7:45 AM: three sourced findings about his own names, on the FinViz Home he already knows.

PRODUCT

An AI layer for the FinViz stock screener.

PROBLEM

Swing traders with day jobs build a screen at night, can't watch the market 9:30–4, and miss the moment their setup happens. New users take 42 days to see why Elite is worth paying for.

AI SOLUTION

AI turns the stocks he already likes into a working screen, remembers why he picked each one, watches it on his schedule and explains every finding with its evidence. It verifies; he decides.

MY ROLE

Lead UX designer: research, strategy, AI UX principles, concept, low-fi to hi-fi, design system. AI agents for drafting; every call mine.

19 hi-fi screens · one trade · Monday evening to Sunday · FinViz design system v1.0 · personas and data are synthetic

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · CONTEXT

An AI layer that turns what a trader already has into a working screen, and watches it through the day.

TARGET AUDIENCE

- Swing traders with a day job
- Day traders
- Value investors

THE PROBLEMS

- Ideas don’t become a working, watched screen
- FinViz is nearly absent during market hours
- 89 filters in preset buckets; exact values are Elite-only
- Results show no reason why a stock matched
- New users stall before Elite’s value is obvious

TEAM AND MY PART

- Concept project from a design-course brief. I led it, with AI agents for drafting and four design reviewers
- I ran discovery, research, strategy, the AI design principles and the hands-on design
- I led every deliverable in Figma and FigJam, ran the design review, and made and recorded the key calls

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · WHY

Why design an AI layer for the screener?

42 → 21

days from sign-up to Elite: the business goal

Today: 42 days

Goal: 21 days

89 filter dropdowns, most in preset buckets

87 of 89 filters need Elite for an exact value

0 AI features in the FinViz screener today

“Too many filters, and no filter literacy. And a chat box is not the answer.”

FinViz today: tour-led onboarding, AI only on the news

finviz.com home page, Oct 4 2026

1 The guided-tour prompt

“First Time Here? Watch the Guided Tour”: FinViz’s answer to first use is still a tour, now promoted on the home page.

2 “Weekend Brief”

A news summary that appears AI-generated, with 👍/👎, but isn’t labelled as AI. Nothing like it in the screener.

3 A dense dashboard

Rule-based signals, insider tables, futures, a heat map and heavy ads: what a newcomer meets first.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · CONTEXT AND CONSTRAINTS

The environment the AI had to fit

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Halve the time from free to Elite, 42 → 21 days, without annoying users (course brief, OKR 1). Elite sells persistence: alerts, real-time data, backtests. A user without a working screen has no reason to pay.

STAKEHOLDERS

Traders: Growth Gary (primary), Fast Frank, Value Vivian, Multi Mike. FinViz growth (Elite conversion), compliance (the advice line), engineering (screener, alerts, data feeds).

SUCCESS CRITERIA

Time to first success: an insight that is actionable, timely and relevant to his own holdings, in the first session. Then a habit: a saved screen re-run 3+ days a week (North Star).

TECHNICAL CONSTRAINTS

No AI in FinViz's screener today. 89 filters; Free uses preset buckets. Free quotes 1-min delayed; pre-market is Elite. LLMs can invent: output must map to real filters. No AI-originated advice, predictions or confidence %. Desktop only.

WHAT THIS MEANT FOR THE DESIGN

Free builds and previews; Elite watches

The paywall sits where the value is felt: live alerts on his own names.

Every AI output maps to something real

A FinViz filter, a measured value or a cited source, or it says it can't tell.

Verification, not advice

The AI checks his own criteria; decisions end in his broker.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

FinViz stays the fastest place to find ideas. The AI layer explains them.

	WHERE IT IS STRONG	WHERE THE AI LAYER FITS
TradingView	Charting and community. Ships AI document and news summaries, and a Chart Copilot (beta) that sets alerts in plain English.	Explains the trader's own screen and keeps his reasons. FinViz stays the fastest place to find ideas.
Trade Ideas	Real-time scanning at tick speed. Holly AI posts trade ideas with entry, stop and target; a plain-English scan builder.	FinViz never originates trades or confidence scores. It checks the trader's own criteria and watches his saved screen.
Bloomberg Terminal	Market data and news for professionals, with AI document search and news summaries.	Cost and complexity. FinViz's job is discovery for individual traders.

Source: competitor product pages and reviews, checked October 2026. Competitor features change quickly.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · THE PROBLEM

Two problems, defined separately, so the AI only does what a rule can’t.

User problem

Gary can find ideas but can’t hold on to them. 89 filters with no explanation; a list that forgets why he picked each stock; nothing reaches him at work; the decision to hold or exit happens in his head.

AI problem

Infer a screen from 3 example tickers · explain why each row matched from real values · re-check his reasons against fresh data 3× a day · detect chart patterns with measurable criteria · summarize overnight news on his names, with sources · turn corrections into proposed rule changes.

Why AI is appropriate

Translating examples and plain English into 89 filters, and summarizing many sources, are language tasks. Scanning 30 charts for the same setup is repetitive perception. Where a rule is enough we used a rule: the since-last-night diff, exit lines, quiet hours and the activity log are not AI.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · THE PROBLEM

“Once you close FinViz you get nothing, and setting up alerts today is quirky.”

Design review feedback, Sept 30

SEVEN PAINS, RANKED BY USER AND BUSINESS IMPACT

01 **Ideas can’t become a working, watched screen**

02 **Blind during market hours**

03 Too many results, and no reason why they matched

04 Which metric matters, and what counts as good?

05 Filters in fixed buckets; exact values are Elite

06 Alert noise

07 Catalysts scattered across pages

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · DATA FOUNDATION

Designed for what the data supports.

DATA SOURCE	USED FOR	VOLUME	QUALITY AND CONSTRAINTS
Screener data 89 filters, ~11,700 tickers	Examples → filters; why it matched; lenses	~11.7k tickers × 89 fields, daily; intraday on Elite	Free maps to preset buckets (marked ≈); exact values on Elite
Price and volume bars Daily bars per ticker	Pattern detection; 30-day replay; reasons checks	3+ years of daily bars per ticker	Gaps and splits: the detector says “not enough data” instead of guessing
Calendar, news, analysts Third-party feeds	Morning glance; insight cards; map notes	Dozens of sources a day	Every claim cites source and time; no cause inferred without a source
His data, opt-in Screens, reasons, notes, exit lines	Personal rules; what to watch and when	Small, per user	Visible, editable, deletable; never turned into recommendations
Labels His corrections + weekly audits	Evaluate and tune detection and alerts	Grows with use; 50 detections audited a week	Corrections skew toward noise; sampled audits keep the error rate fair

Volumes are design estimates to validate with FinViz engineering. Every AI output shows the data behind it and its time; when data is missing, the product says so.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · THE SOLUTION

One trade, one trading day.

Hi-fi first: one trade followed through one trading day, Monday evening to Sunday. 19 screens designed in the FinViz dark theme, built only from the design system’s tokens. Purple marks AI and nothing else.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · SOLUTION

One trade, followed through one trading day.

Growth Gary, a swing trader with a day job, finds an idea at night, checks it before work, gets one alert while he's busy, and decides after the close whether his reasons still hold. FinViz watches and explains at the right moment; Gary makes every decision, in his own broker.

1

8–10 PM

Evening

Reviews what's new, pins 3–5 names, taps "Watch these for me"

2

WHILE HE SLEEPS

Overnight

Nothing to do; a bounded agent re-checks his names

3

7:30 AM

Before work

Reads one short note

4

9:30 AM–4 PM

During work

Taps one alert, if it comes

5

4:30 PM

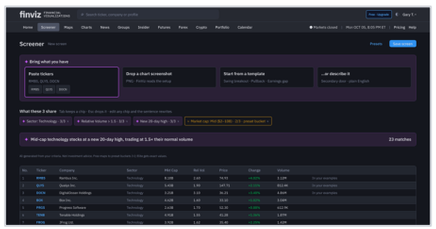
After the close

Decides: hold, or exit in his own broker

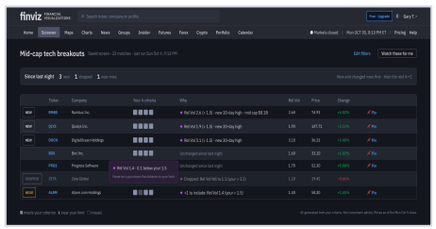
FINVIZ AI SCREENER · SOLUTION

The whole trading day

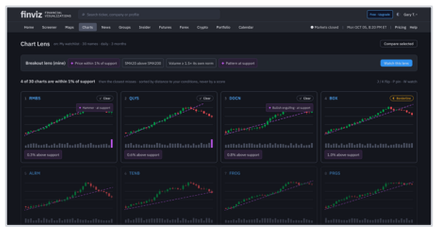
One trade, Monday evening to Sunday. Every screen is designed in hi-fi and linked as a clickable prototype.



01 Show It
Mon 8:05 PM

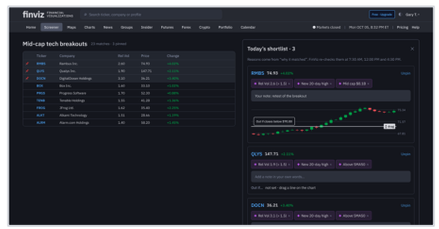


02 Since last night
Mon 8:10 PM

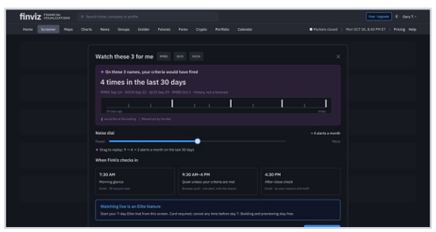


03 Lens grid
Mon 8:20 PM

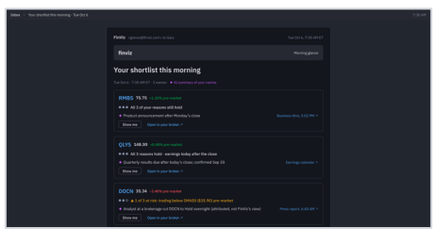
04 Linked compare
Mon 8:26 PM



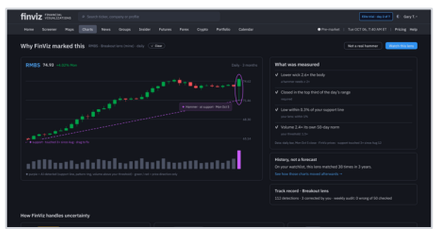
05 Reasons ledger
Mon 8:32 PM



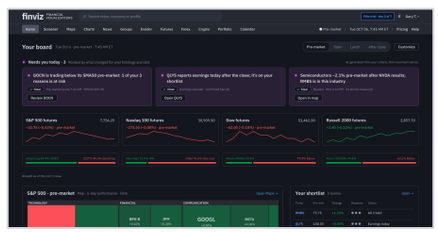
06 Watch these for me
Mon 8:40 PM



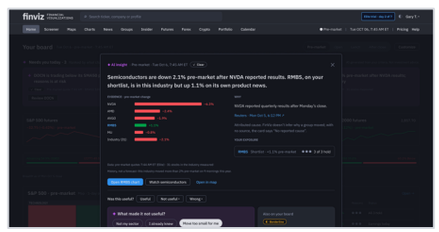
07 Morning glance
Tue 7:30 AM



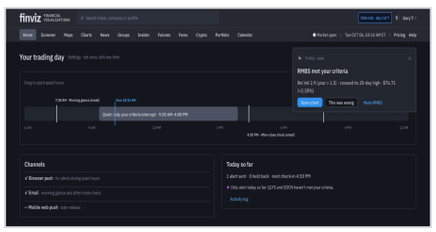
08 Why marked
Tue 7:40 AM



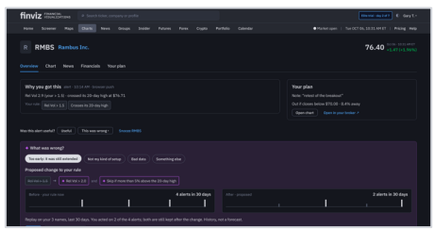
09 Insight Board
Tue 7:45 AM



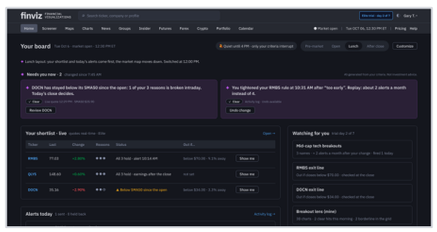
10 Insight, opened
Tue 7:45 AM



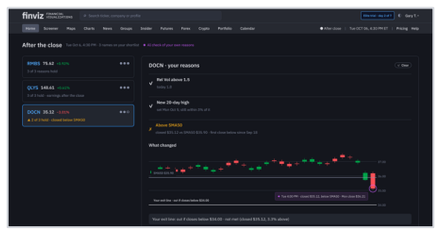
11 Quiet hours, one alert
Tue 10:14 AM



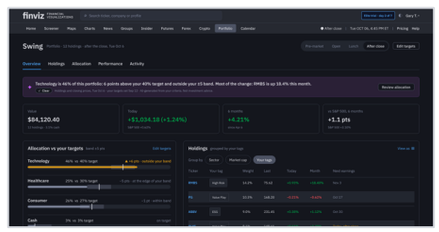
12 This was wrong
Tue 10:31 AM



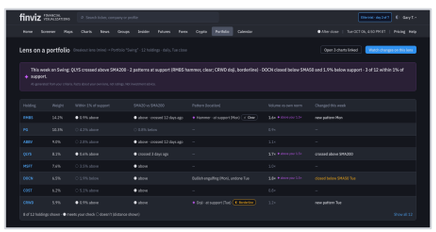
13 Board at lunch
Tue 12:30 PM



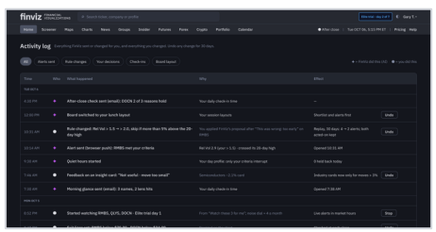
14 Reasons still hold?
Tue 4:30 PM



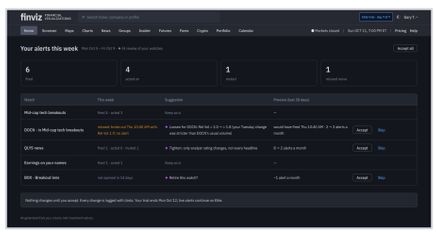
15 Portfolio vs plan
Tue 4:45 PM



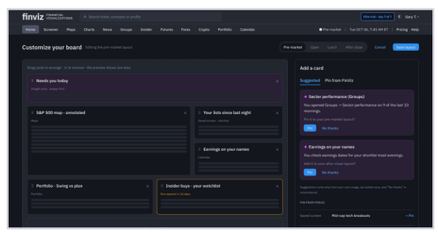
16 Lens on portfolio
Tue 4:50 PM



17 Activity log + Undo
Tue 5:15 PM



18 Weekly review
Sun 7 PM



19 Build the board
Sunday

TRY IT

[Open the clickable prototype →]

Starts at step 1 in Figma

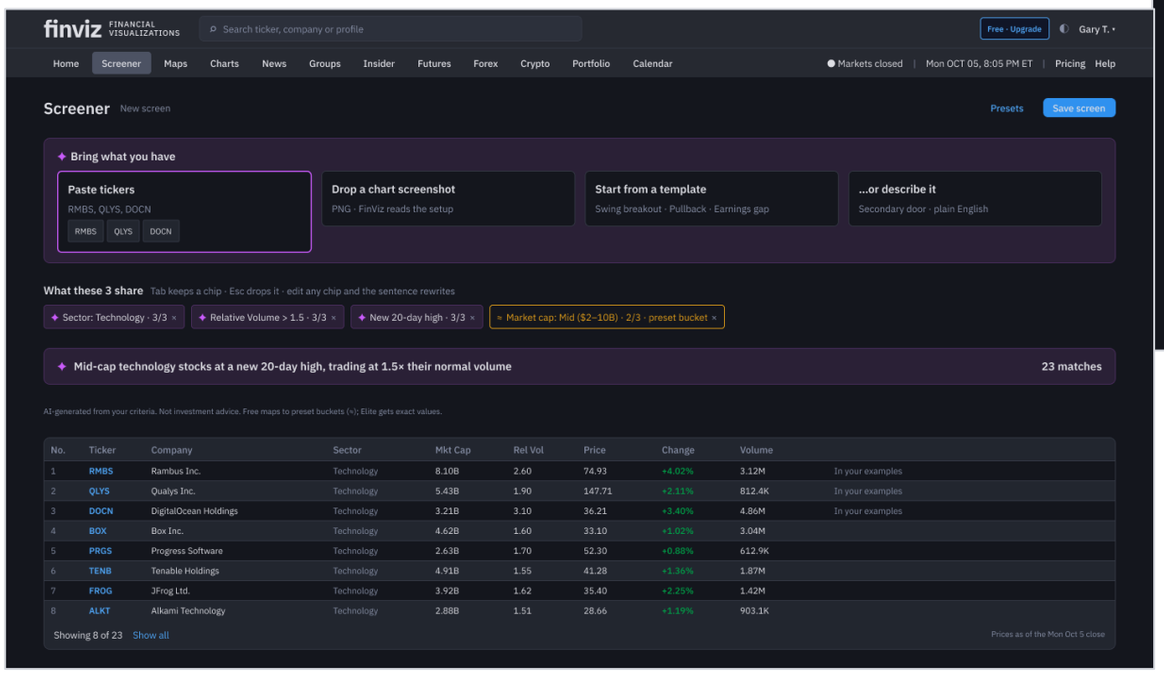
FINVIZ AI SCREENER · SOLUTION · STEPS 1–2 OF 19

Show It + Since Last Night: an idea becomes a screen he trusts

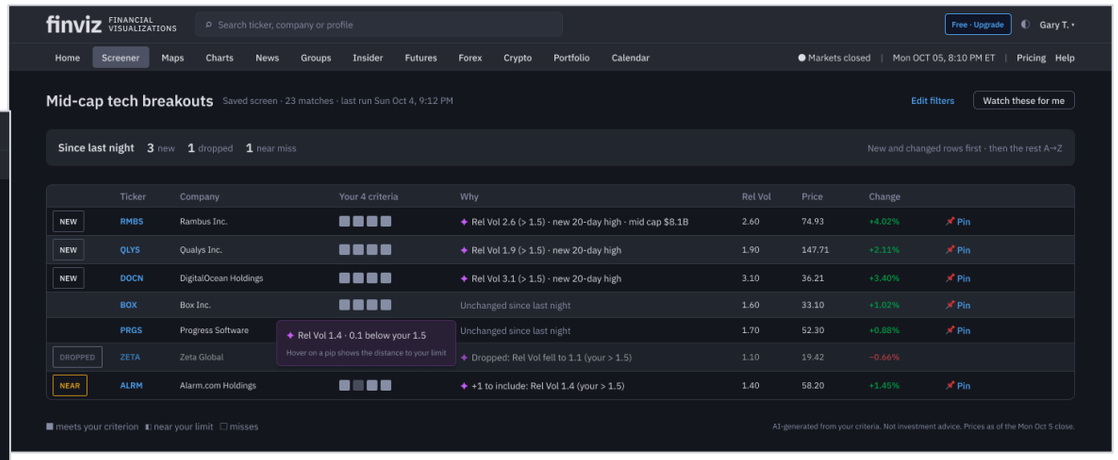
Mon Oct 5, 8 PM, after Monday's close. Free account.

THE DAY **Evening** › Overnight › Before work › During work › After the close

Where the story starts: Monday after the close, on a free account.



STEP 1 · OW1 Pastes 3 tickers; AI writes what they share as editable filter chips



STEP 2 · OW2 New, dropped and near-miss rows first, each with which of his criteria it meets

AI BEHAVIOR

Programming by example: three tickers become editable filter chips

Constrained to FinViz's real filters; nothing invented

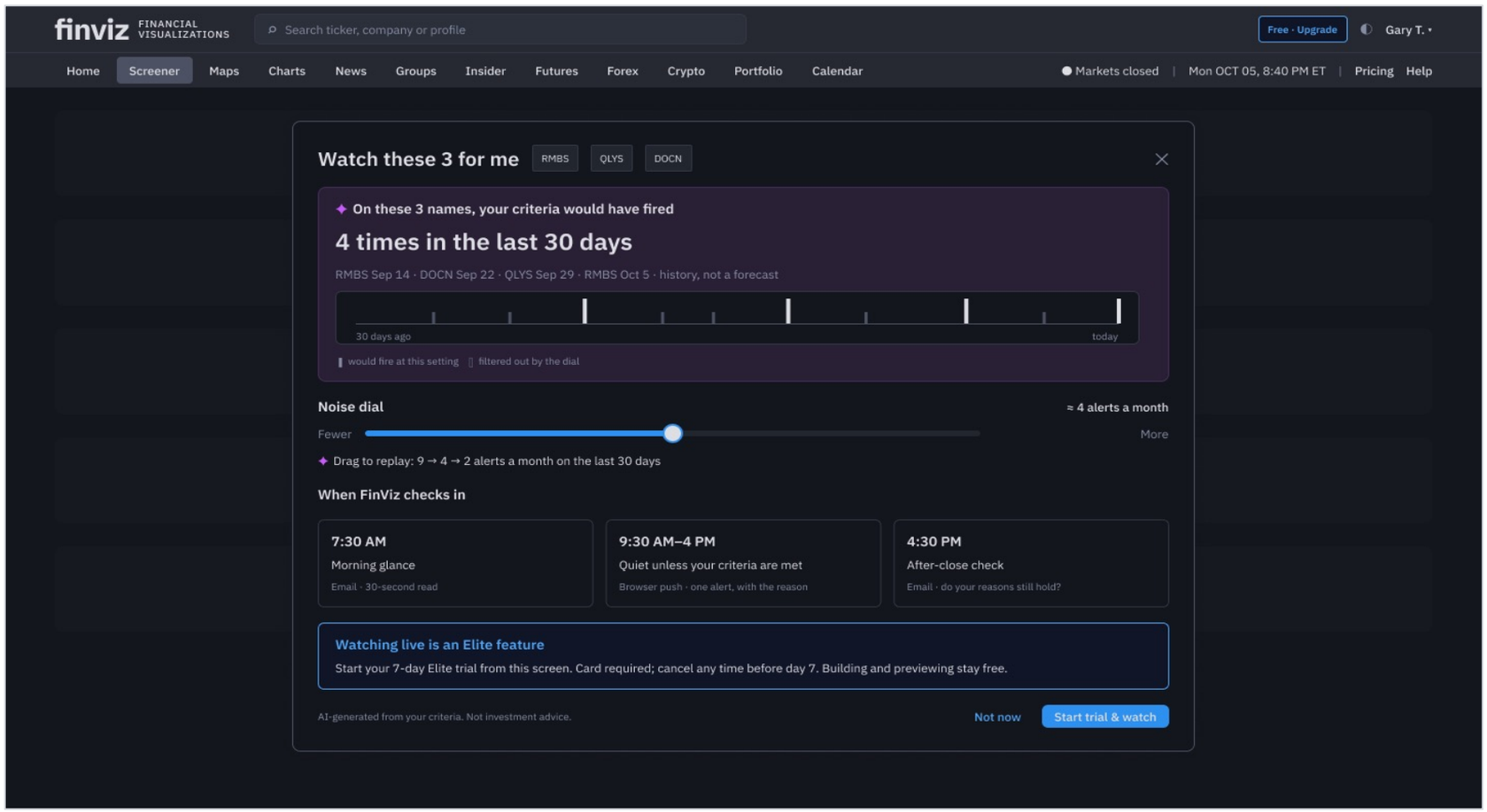
Decision point: he keeps or drops each chip (Tab / Esc)

Watch These For Me

Mon 8:40 PM. The one earned Elite moment.

THE DAY **Evening** › Overnight › Before work › During work › After the close

Before this: he checks his charts (steps 3–4) and pins 3 names with reasons (5).



DECISION POINT

Replay before commitment: his criteria “would have fired 4 times in the last 30 days”

The noise dial redraws history live as he drags it (9 → 4 → 2 a month)

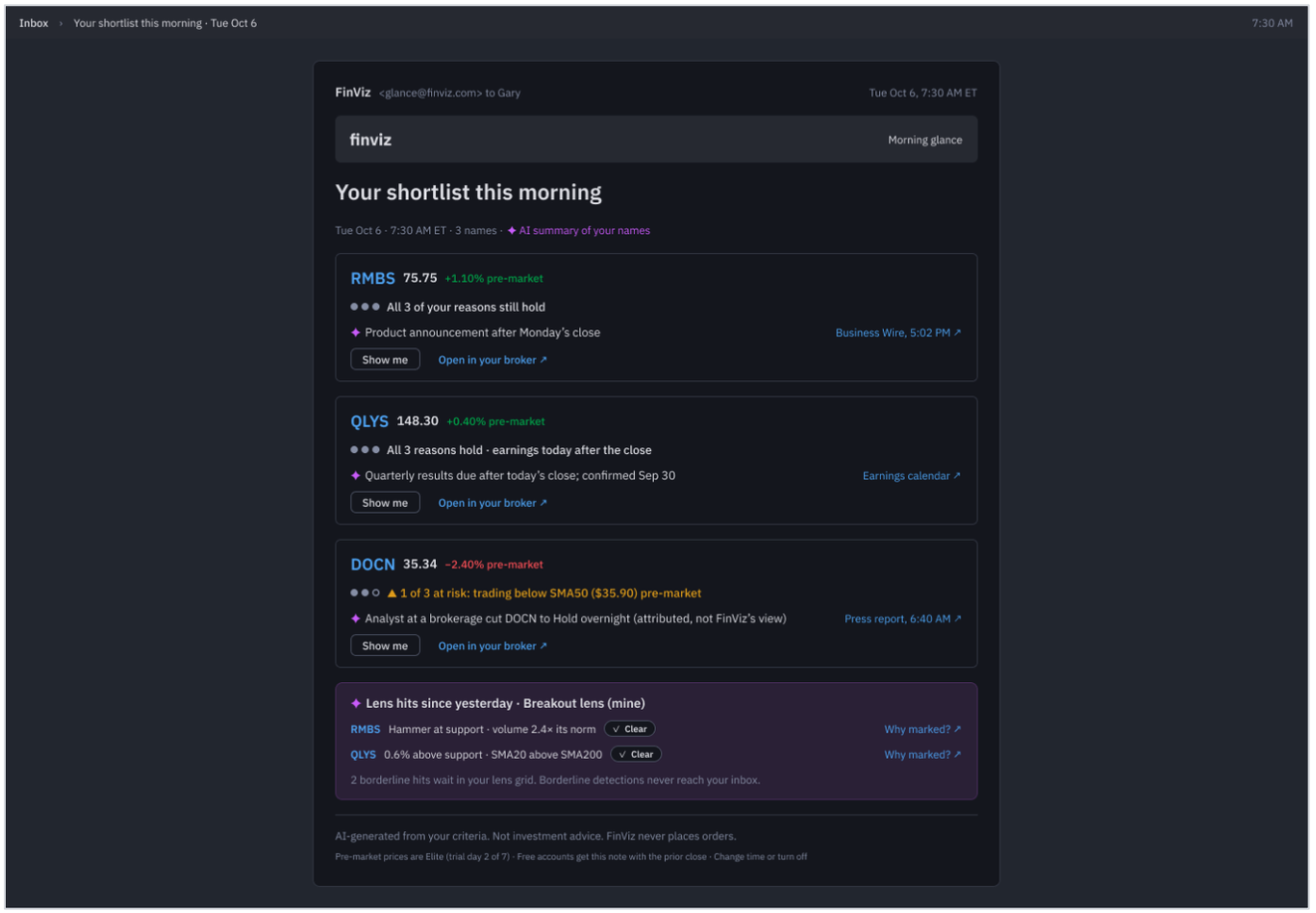
The 7-day Elite trial starts here, where the value is obvious, not at sign-up

Morning glance: one note before work

Tue Oct 6, 7:30 AM. An email, readable in 30 seconds.

THE DAY Evening › Overnight › **Before work** › During work › After the close

Overnight, a bounded agent re-checked his 3 names only; there is nothing to log in to.



AI BEHAVIOR

A bounded agent on his names only: sourced news, earnings and his reasons, re-checked

DOCN: 1 of 3 reasons at risk, with its source and time

Only clear lens hits reach the inbox; borderline ones wait in the grid

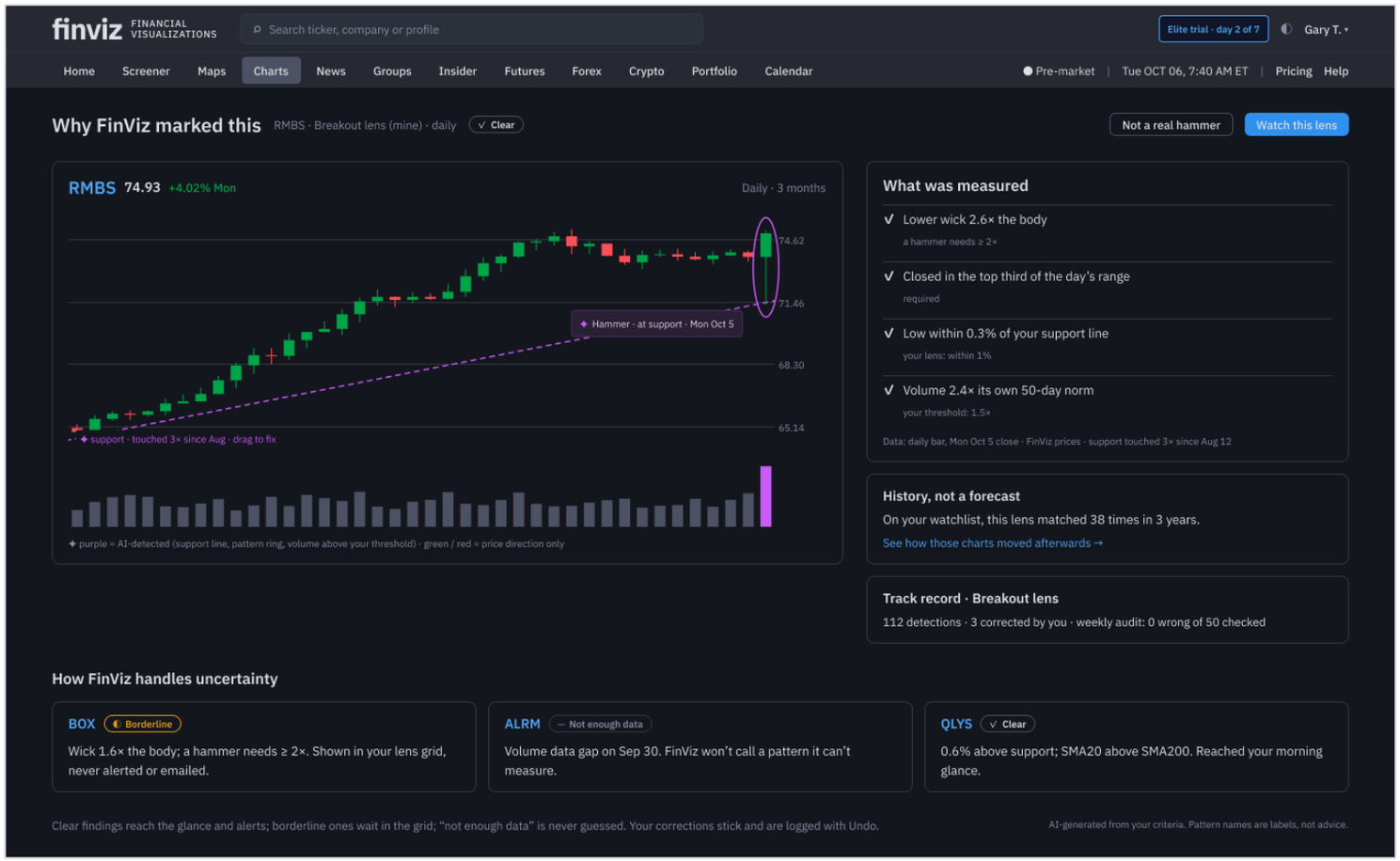
FINVIZ AI SCREENER · SOLUTION · STEP 8 OF 19

Chart Lens: why FinViz marked this

Tue 7:40 AM. Opened from “Why marked?” in the morning glance.

THE DAY Evening › Overnight › **Before work** › During work › After the close

Opened from “Why marked?” in the 7:30 AM morning glance (step 7).



AI BEHAVIOR

Measurements, not a confidence score: wick 2.6× body, at support, volume 2.4× its norm

Clear, borderline or not enough data; only clear findings reach his inbox

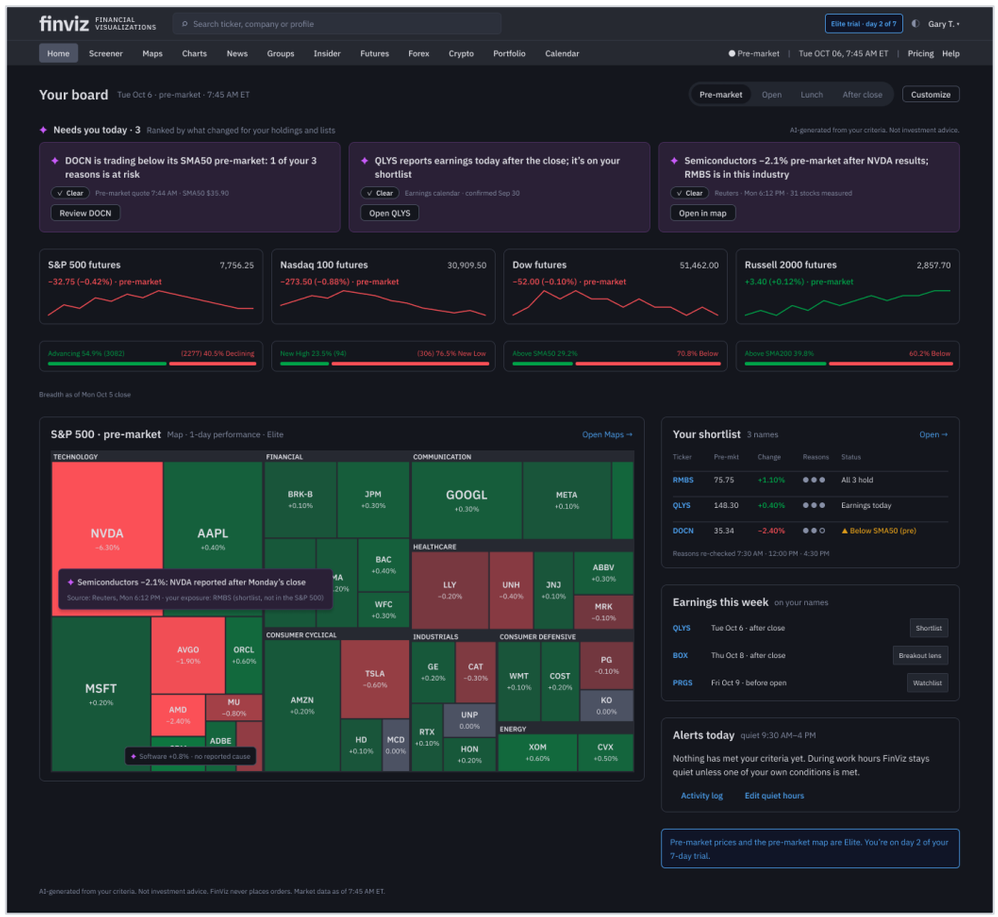
History with its sample size (38 matches in 3 years) and a visible track record

Insight Board, pre-market

Tue 7:45 AM. FinViz Home, upgraded.

THE DAY Evening › Overnight › **Before work** › During work › After the close

Then: he opens one finding to see its evidence and source (step 10).



AI BEHAVIOR

Three findings that need him today, each sourced and labelled Clear

The familiar parts stay: index row, breadth bars, S&P 500 map, now with AI notes

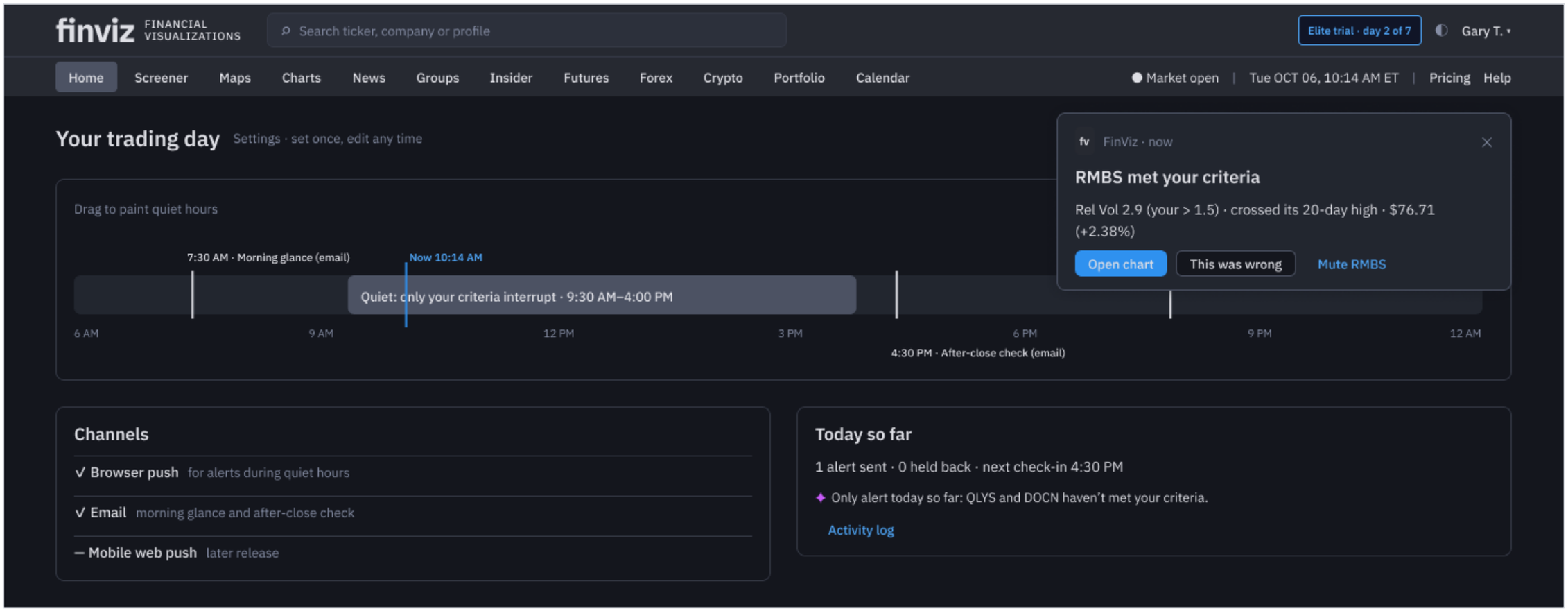
Pre-market prices on his own names are the Elite moment

Quiet hours, one alert

Tue 10:14 AM. At work; a browser push that leads with the reason.

THE DAY Evening › Overnight › Before work › **During work** › After the close

He painted quiet hours once (9:30 AM–4 PM); only his own criteria can interrupt.



DECISION POINT

Quiet 9:30–4 unless his own criteria are met

One push, reason first: Rel Vol 2.9 (your > 1.5), crossed its 20-day high

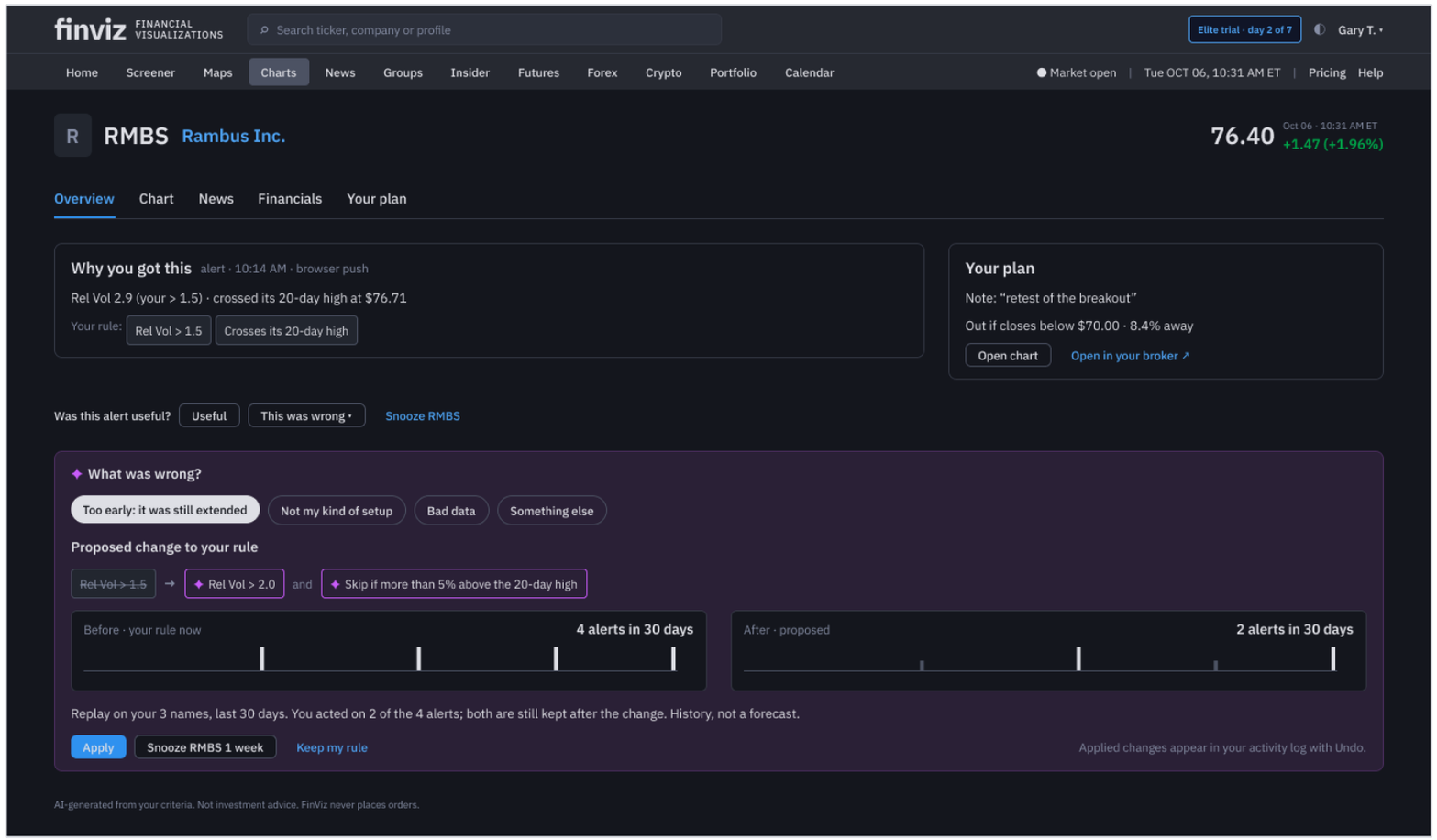
Three choices: open the chart, say it was wrong, or mute the name

Alert correction: “this was wrong” becomes a proposed fix

Tue 10:31 AM. The alert opened on the RMBS quote page.

THE DAY Evening › Overnight › Before work › **During work** › After the close

Straight from the 10:14 AM alert (step 11): he tapped “This was wrong”.



DECISION POINT

His reason (“too early”) becomes a specific change to his own rule

Before/after replay: 4 → 2 alerts in 30 days, both acted-on alerts kept

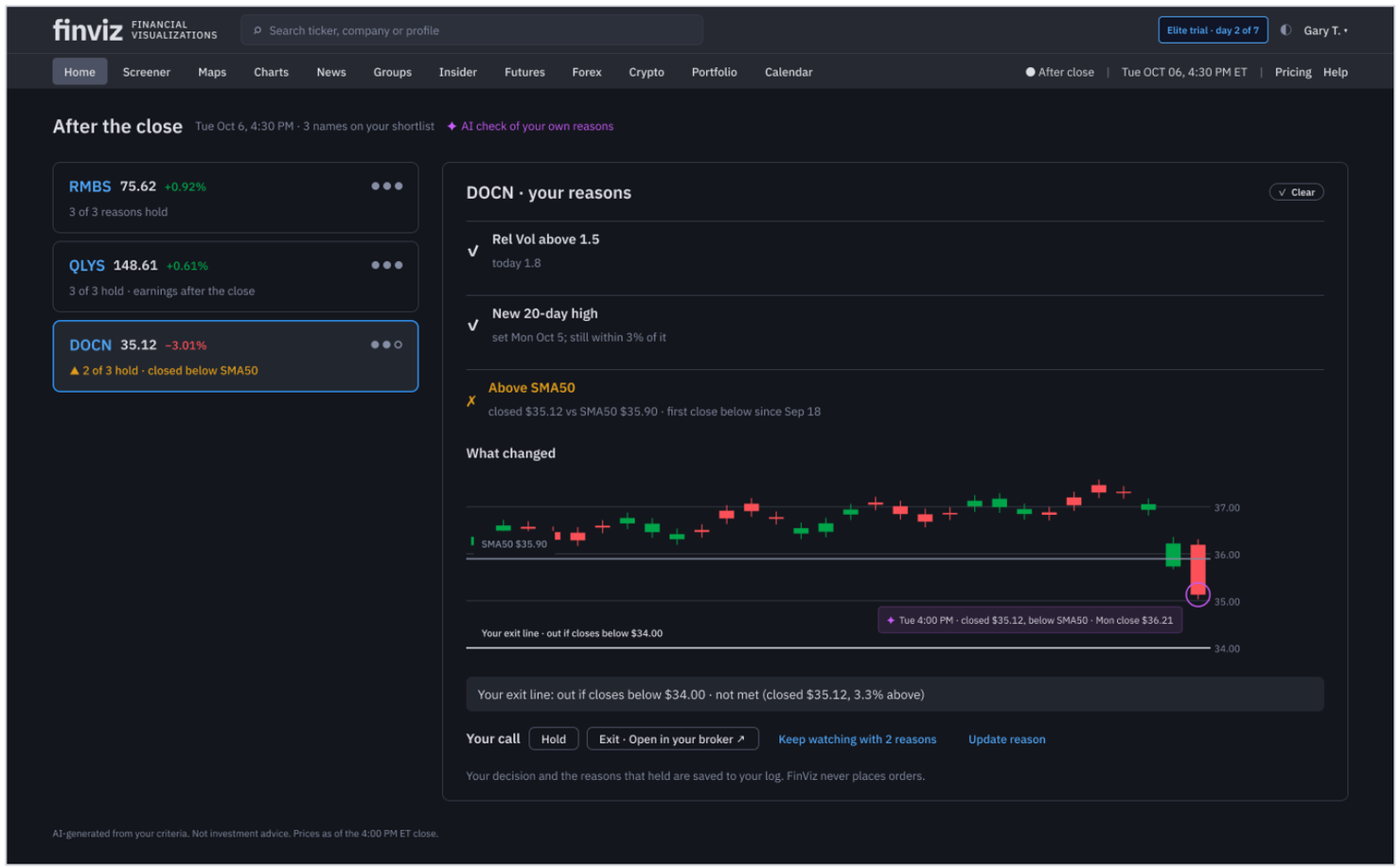
Nothing changes until he applies it; every change is logged with Undo

Reasons Still Hold?

Tue 4:30 PM. DOCN closes below its SMA50: a reason breaks.

THE DAY Evening › Overnight › Before work › During work › **After the close**

Before this: at lunch the board showed alerts sent and held back (step 13).



DECISION POINT

A checklist that ticks itself against today's close

What changed and when, on the chart; his exit line ($34.00) not met

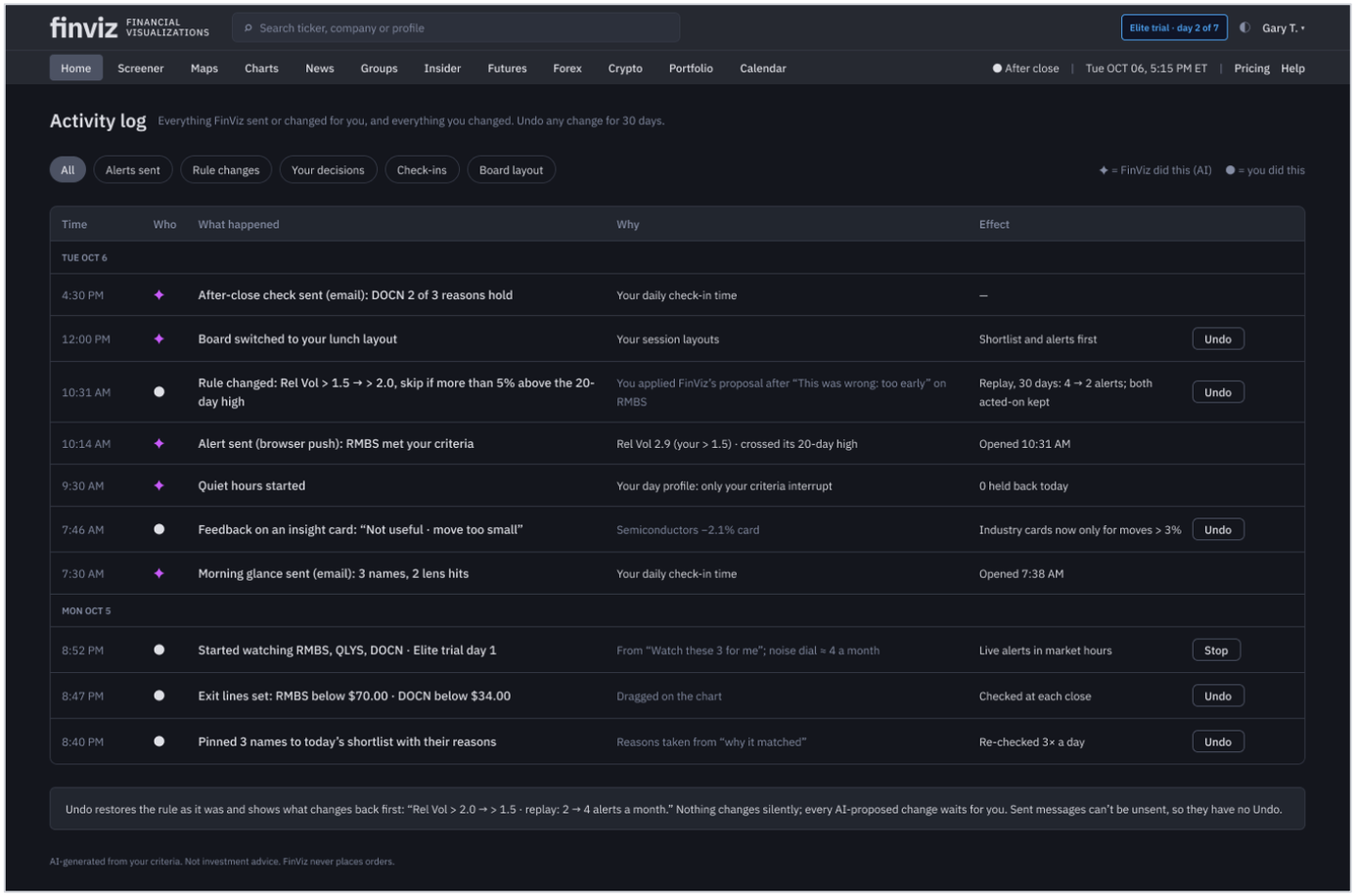
Hold or exit is his call, in his own broker; FinViz never places orders

Activity log: everything, with Undo

Tue 5:15 PM. Every send and change, who did it, and why.

THE DAY Evening › Overnight › Before work › During work › **After the close**

The day’s record: every alert FinViz sent and every rule that changed, by FinViz or by him.



AI BEHAVIOR

✦ marks what FinViz did; a dot marks what he did

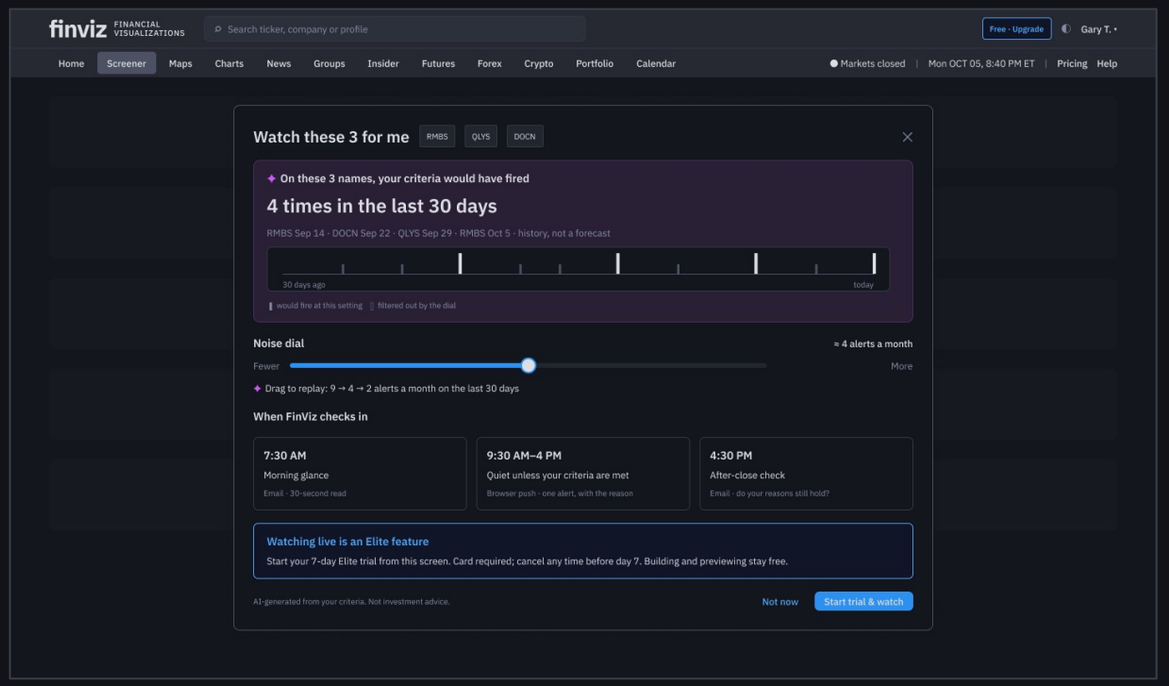
Every change shows its reason and effect, with Undo for 30 days

Nothing changes silently; sent messages can’t be unsent, so they have no Undo

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · PROTOTYPE

Click through the whole day yourself.

19 linked hi-fi screens in Figma, starting at step 1. Each screen moves forward through its real button: Save screen, Charts, Compare selected, Watch these 3 for me… through Save layout on Sunday.



[Open the Figma prototype →]

[Or start at the workflow map →]

ALSO AVAILABLE

An offline HTML version with the narrative for every step and a full link map: The-Trading-Day-Prototype.html.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · REASONING

Trade-offs and rejected alternatives

The section that matters most: why the AI behaves the way it does.

WE CHOSE	WE REJECTED	WHY
Examples → editable filter chips	A chat box as the main way in	Real tasks are ambiguous; chips can be inspected, edited and saved
Measurements; clear / borderline / abstain	A confidence % on each detection	A number implies precision we can't guarantee; measurements can be checked
Verify the trader's own reasons	AI buy/sell calls, "top picks", scores	Compliance and trust; attributed third-party views only, pending compliance review
One reason-first alert in quiet hours	A live stream of every signal	Alert fatigue kills the habit; replay shows the cost first
Propose rule changes; apply on accept	Silent auto-tuning	He keeps control; every change announced, with Undo
A bounded agent on his names only	An open-ended research agent	Limits cost, hallucination surface and privacy exposure
Neutral "Clear", amber "Borderline"	Green for "Clear"	Green means price up, nothing else
Desktop first	Mobile in release 1	The screener lives on desktop; mobile deferred, not dropped

ACCURACY VS CONTROL When the model is unsure, the product shows less and asks more. Borderline findings stay visible but never interrupt.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · REASONING

Eight design calls that changed the work

01

SEPT 23

Map today’s onboarding before designing

02

SEPT 23

Desktop only, for now

03

SEPT 23

One design for first-time and repeat users

04

SEPT 24

Remove real frictions with new AI models

05

SEPT 30

Optimize time to first success; no chat box first

06

SEPT 30

Set the advice line, pending compliance

07

SEPT 30

Lead with the swing trader’s trading day

08

OCT 1

Bring teammates’ screens in line with the rules

The two orange rules mark the calls that reset the project: time to first success, and leading with the trading day.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · REASONING

What each call solved (1 of 2)

DESIGN LEAD CALL	WHY IT WAS NEEDED	WHAT IT SOLVED
01 Map today's onboarding before designing	SEPT 23 The docs assumed there was no trial and that slow free quotes were a big pain	A live-site walk found the existing 7-day trial and 1-minute-delayed quotes; the trial now starts from the first saved screen
02 Desktop only, for now	SEPT 23 No native app; two form factors would split the effort	Every screen scoped to 1440px desktop; mobile deferred
03 One design for first-time and repeat users	SEPT 23 Onboarding gates fail repeat users, who keep meeting new filters and decisions	"Onboarding is not a phase": help fades per concept; no wizard, no tour
04 Remove real frictions with new AI models	SEPT 24 The first concepts were generic AI features	Every mechanic names the friction it removes and the AI advance it uses

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · REASONING

What each call solved (2 of 2)

DESIGN LEAD CALL	WHY IT WAS NEEDED	WHAT IT SOLVED
05 Optimize time to first success; no chat box first	SEPT 30 Text-to-filters assumed traders can state ambiguous intent precisely	Imports and examples lead; success must be timely, relevant and actionable
06 Set the advice line, pending compliance	SEPT 30 Buy or sell advice is a legal line	AI never originates advice; attributed analyst views behind a flag
07 Lead with the swing trader's trading day	SEPT 30 Three concepts competed; none followed the real routine	The Trading Day became the lead concept
08 Bring teammates' screens in line with the rules	OCT 1 Frames drafted orders, showed confidence % and fit scores	Every flow ends at the trader's decision and "Open in your broker"

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · REASONING

Scope, evidence, approval, undo: the agent trust pattern.

Scope

The overnight agent works on his names only, in one batch at 6 AM. It reports; it never acts.

Evidence

Every line cites a value or a source and its time: clear, borderline or “not enough data”, never a guess.

Approval

Corrections become proposed rule changes with a before/after replay. Nothing changes until he applies it.

Ledger and Undo

Every send and change is logged with who did it, why and when. Any of it can be undone.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · METHODOLOGY

AI drafts. The design lead decides.

1	2	3	4	5
Frame	Draft	Review	Decide	Propagate
DESIGN LEAD	AI AGENTS	LEAD + TEAM	DESIGN LEAD	AI AGENTS
Sets the question, audience, scope and rules: desktop only, no advice, purple means AI	Research, docs, FigJam boards and Figma screens, drafted against those rules	Fact checks on the live site; critique with the team; rule breaks caught	What to adopt, rename, cut or lead with, and why	Each decision applied across every doc, board and screen

Repeated in every phase: research → principles → concepts → screens. Rules set by the lead live in the project brief, so every AI draft starts from them.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · IMPLEMENTATION

Built mostly on what FinViz already runs, plus a few small services.

ALREADY IN FINVIZ

- Screener and its URL filter engine
- Rule-based pattern signals
- Elite alerts and the 7-day trial
- Earnings calendar and news feeds
- Portfolio and Maps

NEW SERVICES

- Translation: LLM + filter-schema validator
- Reasons engine: checks at 7:30, 12:00 and 4:30
- Replay service for alert previews
- Overnight agent: one batch at 6 AM
- Quiet-hours scheduler + activity log

INTEGRATION CHALLENGES

- LLM latency vs an instant screener: stream chips, cache common screens
- Free (delayed) vs Elite (real-time) data paths
- Overnight agent cost per user
- Compliance gate and feature flag for attributed views

Proposed, not built: a plan to agree with FinViz engineering. One token library (Figma variables matched to FinViz CSS variables), KPI events defined with analytics, compliance pre-review.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · WHAT WE SAW

FinViz has 89 filters and no AI in the screener. New users still get a tour.

0

AI features in the screener; AI appears only on the news

89

filter dropdowns, most in preset buckets

87/89

filters need Elite for an exact value

7 days

Elite trial, card required, offered at sign-up, before any value

A four-person design review (Sept 30, 31 points) changed the goal: time to a first success, an insight that is actionable, timely and relevant to the trader's own stocks. Then a habit.

Sources: live-site audit of finviz.com, Oct 4 2026; design review, Sept 30. Desk evidence, not yet confirmed with FinViz users.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · AFTER TESTING

Four tests are set, each with a bar to pass. Nothing is measured yet.

TEST	WHAT IT MEASURES	BAR TO PASS	RESULT
Show It eval 40 fixed requests on the live prototype	Right filters, invented codes stopped, asks when vague, refuses to predict	< 2% wrong translations	**PLANNED** Ready to run
Trader sessions 5 swing traders, think-aloud	Time to a first saved screen; trust; whether the replay is understood	Under 5 min · trust 5+ of 7 · 4 of 5 explain the replay	**PLANNED** Kit ready
Alert diary 2 weeks with alerts on	Alerts that lead to an action; alerts muted	Over 40% acted on · under 10% muted	**PLANNED** After sessions
Days to Elite A/B against today's sign-up trial	Days from sign-up to Elite	42 → 21 days	**PLANNED** Needs FinViz data

Each PLANNED result is replaced with the measured number when its test runs. Bars come from the KPI framework and the validation kit.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · LEARNINGS

What leading with AI taught me.

The bottleneck moves to judgment

Drafts take minutes. The lead’s value is framing, checking facts and deciding what to keep.

Write the rules down once

Rules in the project brief made every AI draft start compliant.

Check the live product, not the docs

One live-site walk overturned two assumptions.

Reconcile, don’t overwrite

Teammates’ screens kept their best ideas and lost only what broke the rules.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · NEXT STEPS

Before launch: what to validate next

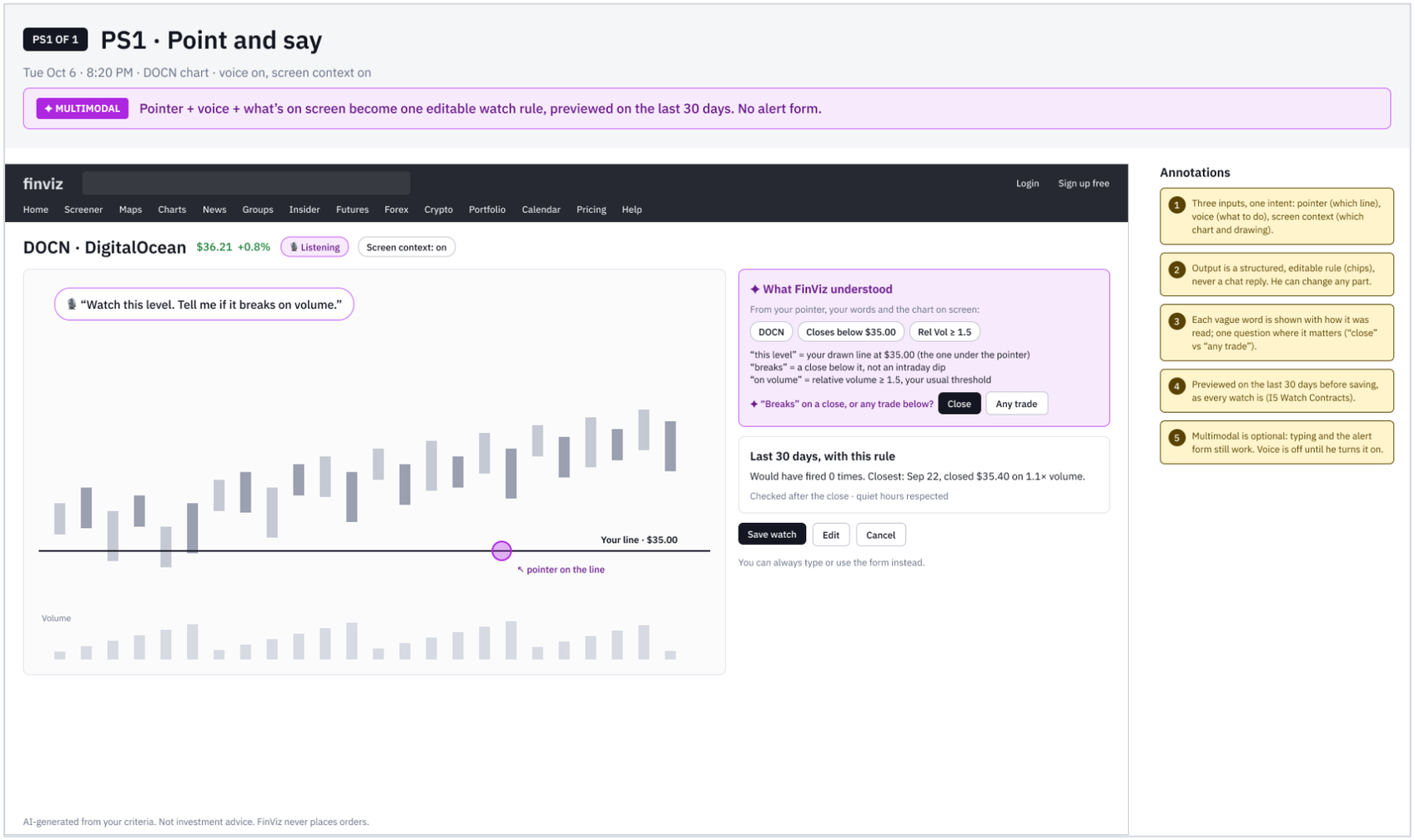
Nothing has launched, so these replace post-launch learnings: the riskiest assumptions, and how to test them.

RISKY ASSUMPTION	HOW WE TEST IT
Will traders trust AI-detected patterns?	Offline audit of 500 labeled charts; track the “not a real hammer” rate; test clear vs borderline wording.
Does free AI screen-building speed up Elite or replace it?	A/B the earned Elite moment (step 6) against today’s sign-up trial; measure days to Elite.
Is one alert a day the right amount?	2-week diary study: alert-to-action over 40%, muted under 10%.
Can the overnight agent pay for itself?	Cost per user per morning vs conversion lift; batch and cache by ticker.
Is the advice line clear enough for compliance?	Legal review of every AI string; attributed views stay behind a flag until cleared.

FINVIZ AI SCREENER · NEXT

Point and say: a watch without a form

Lo-fi concept (PS1). Gary points at the line he drew and says what to watch.



WHY IT'S NEW

Pointer + voice + screen become one editable rule; no alert form

Vague words shown as read; one question where it matters

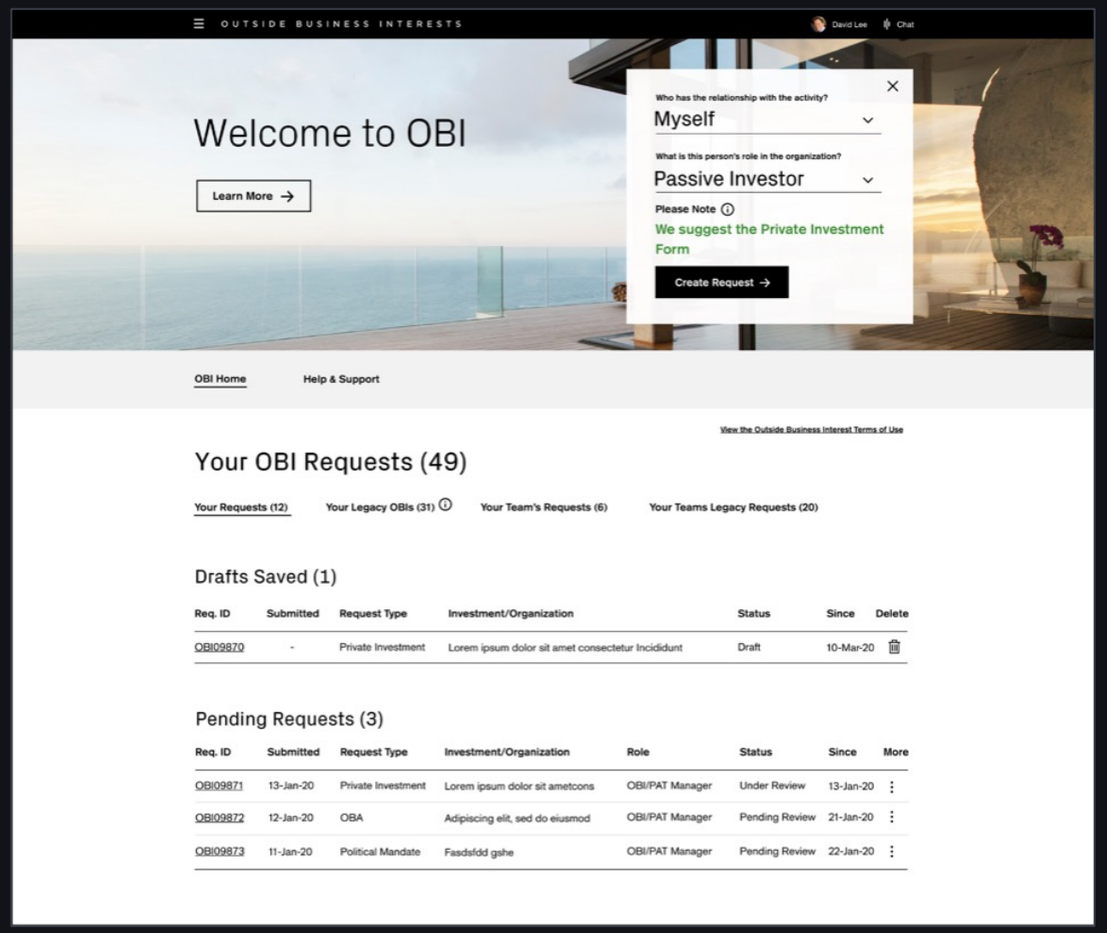
Previewed on 30 days before saving; voice off by default

CASE STUDY 02 · ENTERPRISE · DELIVERED

Credit Suisse

Outside Business Interests (OBI)

Saving money by reducing friction, educating employees and removing risk from pre-clearance for outside activities.



ROLE	Led the project team
TEAM	2 UX designers and a content designer
SCOPE	Discovery to delivery: 33 Agile sprints, usability testing every week
USERS	All employees and managers, reviewers, and Risk & Compliance managers

“It’s too limited in its functionality to be of use for an Approver. Too much time is wasted trying to do more complex tasks.”

A browser-based tool that gives employees pre-clearance for outside activities, reviewed by two lines of defense.

TARGET AUDIENCE

- Risk and Compliance managers
- All Credit Suisse employees
- All Credit Suisse managers

THE PROBLEMS

- Submission status tracking isn't clear
- Lines of responsibility aren't transparent
- No reporting
- Navigation is hard
- People don't know why and when to submit
- No mobile access for Risk & Compliance managers
- A confusing submission process, with no education

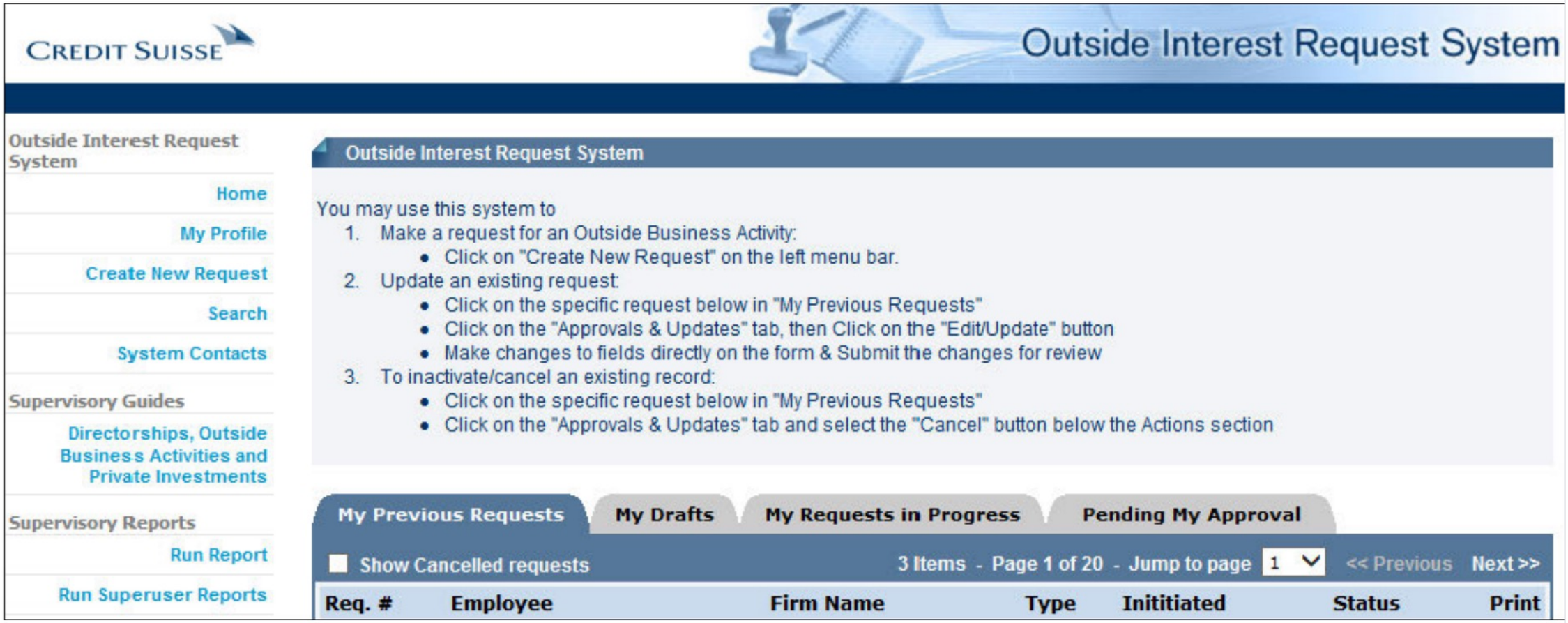
TEAM AND MY PART

- I led a project team of 2 UX designers and a content designer
- I managed discovery, including research, strategy and hands-on design
- I led every deliverable in Sketch and Figma, with Lean UX and usability testing, and presented to the client and stakeholders

CREDIT SUISSE OBI · DISCOVERY

Where we started: the original application

The tool employees used to request pre-clearance before the redesign.



Why redesign OBI?

475

returned submissions missing required information, every year

22 min

average time employees need to resubmit

58%

approval rating from Risk & Compliance managers

5.4%

drop-off on Outside Business Activities forms

6.1%

drop-off on Private Investments forms

61%

approval rating from employees

CREDIT SUISSE OBI · DISCOVERY

We set out to find real user needs, test the business's assumptions and generate new ideas.

METHODS

- Interviews with reviewers, Risk & Compliance managers and their managers
- Contextual interviews
- Persona development
- Research synthesis
- Design thinking exercises

PROBLEM STATEMENT

As part of the iComply ecosystem of Employee Compliance, users need an interactive, web-based pre-clearance application for outside activities, where requests flow through an integrated, pre-defined workflow for review by first-line Reviewers and second-line Risk & Compliance Managers.

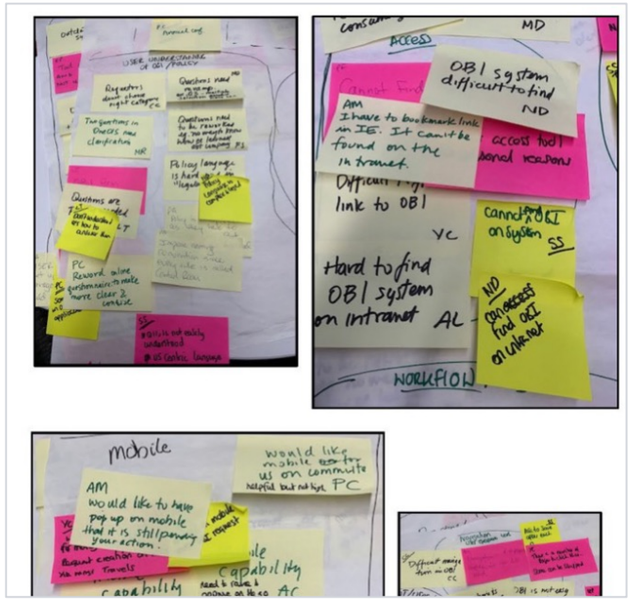
CREDIT SUISSE OBI · DISCOVERY

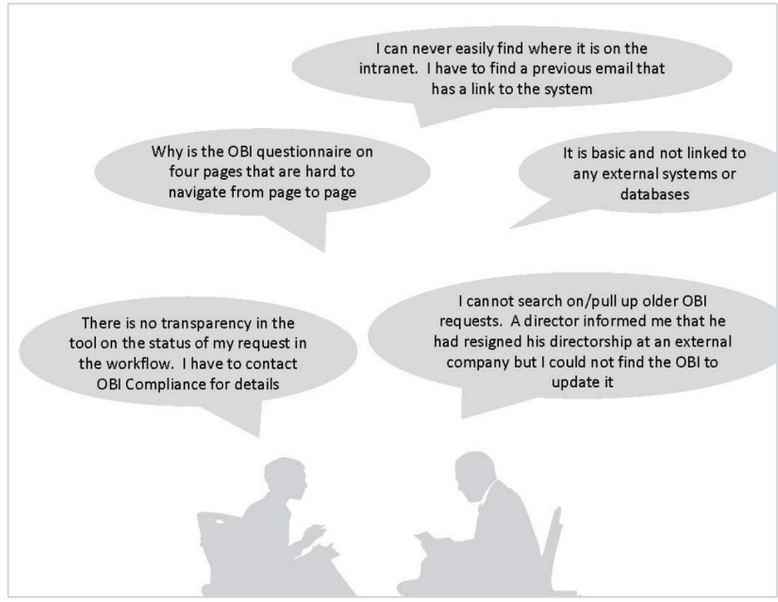
What we heard: major themes from the interviews

Reviewers, Risk & Compliance managers and their managers

MAJOR THEMES

- Integration with other systems on the platform
- Search
- Reporting
- Shadowing
- Everyone understanding the policies
- Mobile
- Clear navigation
- Clear workflow
- Status awareness

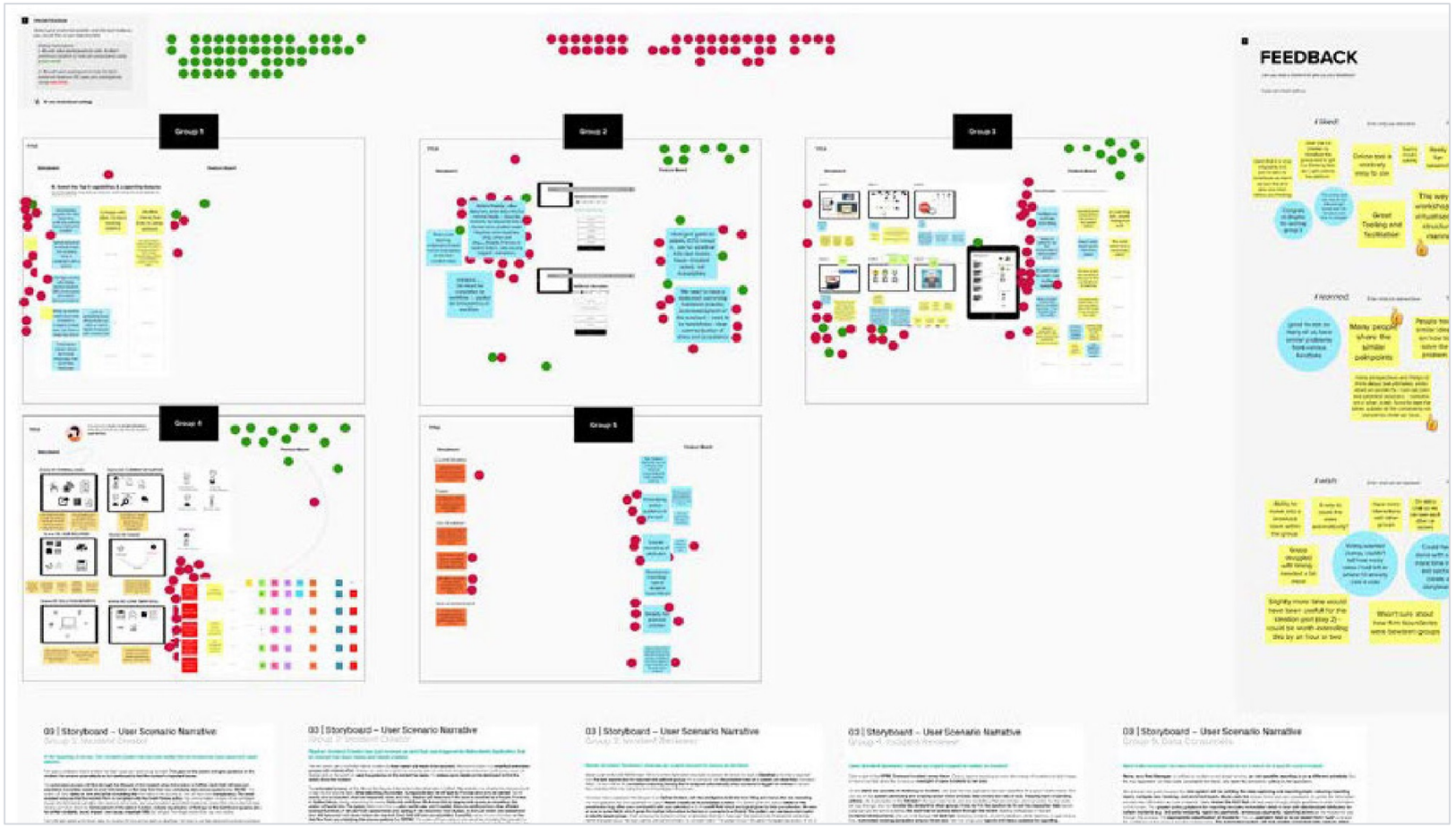




CREDIT SUISSE OBI · DISCOVERY

Design thinking: 5 concepts with 30 participants

Concepts for the dashboard, reporting and submission, for every type of end user



SESSION FORMAT

- Ice breaker
- What would the headlines say?
- How do we…?
- Concepts and interfaces
- Voting

CREDIT SUISSE OBI · STRATEGY

Pain points + business goals + UX strategy = feature set

PAIN POINTS

Integration with other systems on the platform

Navigation

Clear workflows

Status awareness

Lack of features

+

BUSINESS GOALS

Education

Functionality parity

Platform parity

Mobile

+

UX STRATEGY

Integrations with other systems on the platform

Everyone understanding the policies

Access for all in the platform

Mobile

Clear navigation

Clear workflows

=

FEATURE SET

Search

Reporting

Shadowing

Proxies

Queries

Mobile

CREDIT SUISSE OBI · DELIVERY

One dashboard for Submitters, Reviewers and Risk & Compliance Managers.

The dashboard was the main starting point for all three user types, so it got the most attention. It went through many iterations shaped by company goals, line-of-business goals, UX strategy, legal, risk and ADA requirements, and the design system.

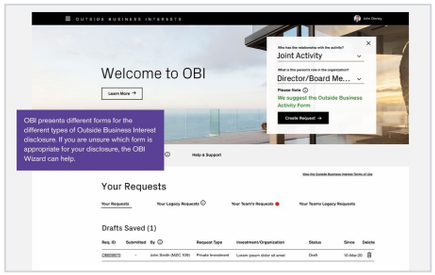
HOW WE DELIVERED

- Feature refinement and road map
- 33 Agile sprints
- Usability testing every week
- Demos and QA

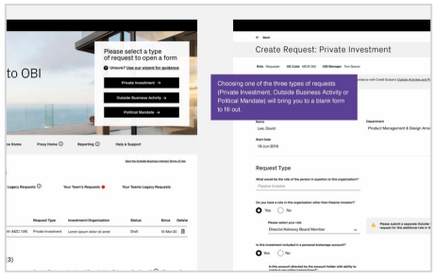
CREDIT SUISSE OBI · DELIVERY

The delivered app, one request end to end

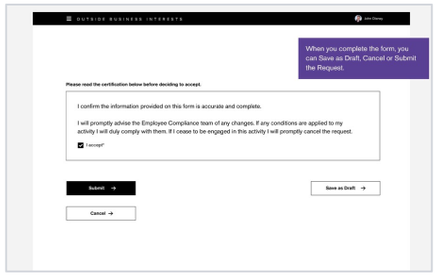
The employee submits, the manager reviews, Compliance decides. Screens from the OBI Training Guide.



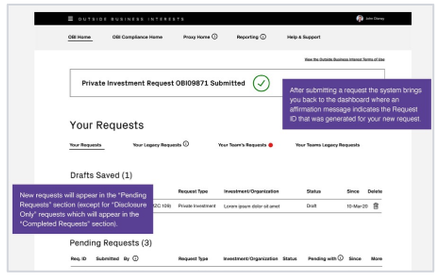
01 Welcome and wizard
Employee



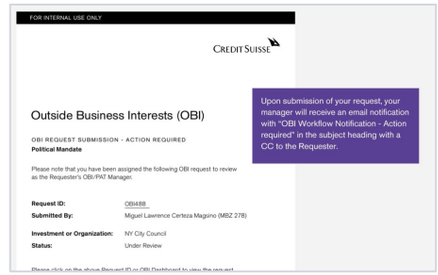
02 Create request
Employee



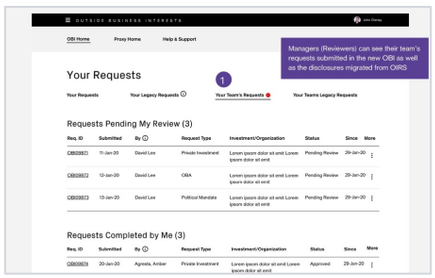
03 Certify and submit
Employee



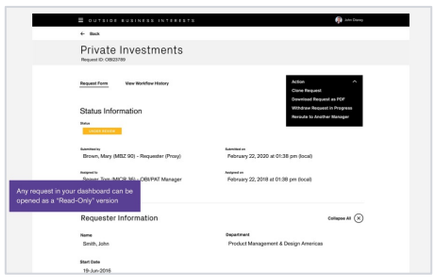
04 Submitted
Employee



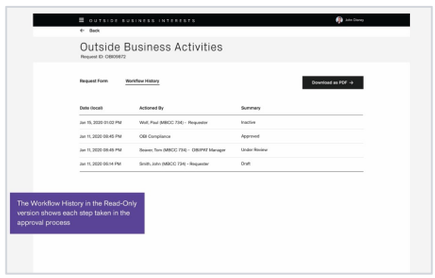
05 Manager notified
Manager



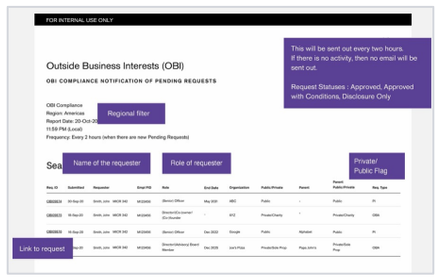
06 Pending my review
Manager



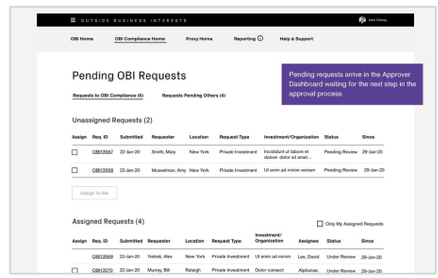
07 Read-only request
Manager



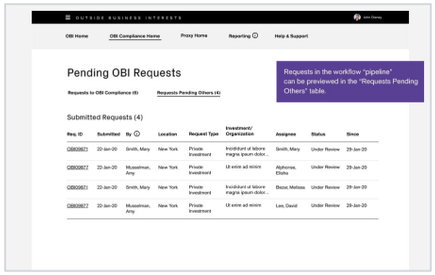
08 Workflow history
Manager



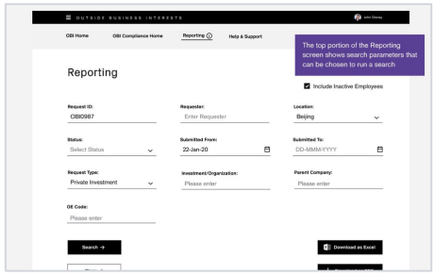
09 Compliance digest
Compliance



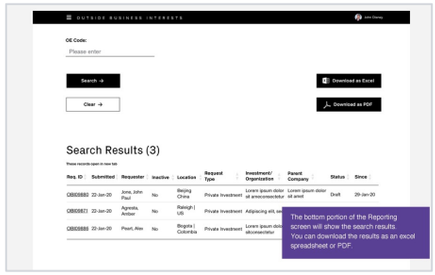
10 Pending queue
Compliance



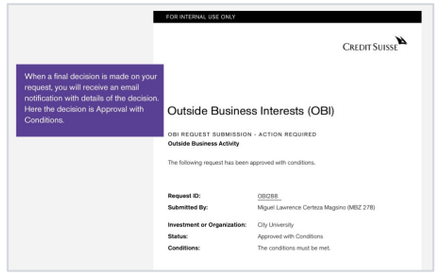
11 Pipeline
Compliance



12 Reporting search
Compliance



13 Reporting results
Compliance



14 Decision email
Employee

TRY IT

Open the prototype →

Starts at the welcome screen

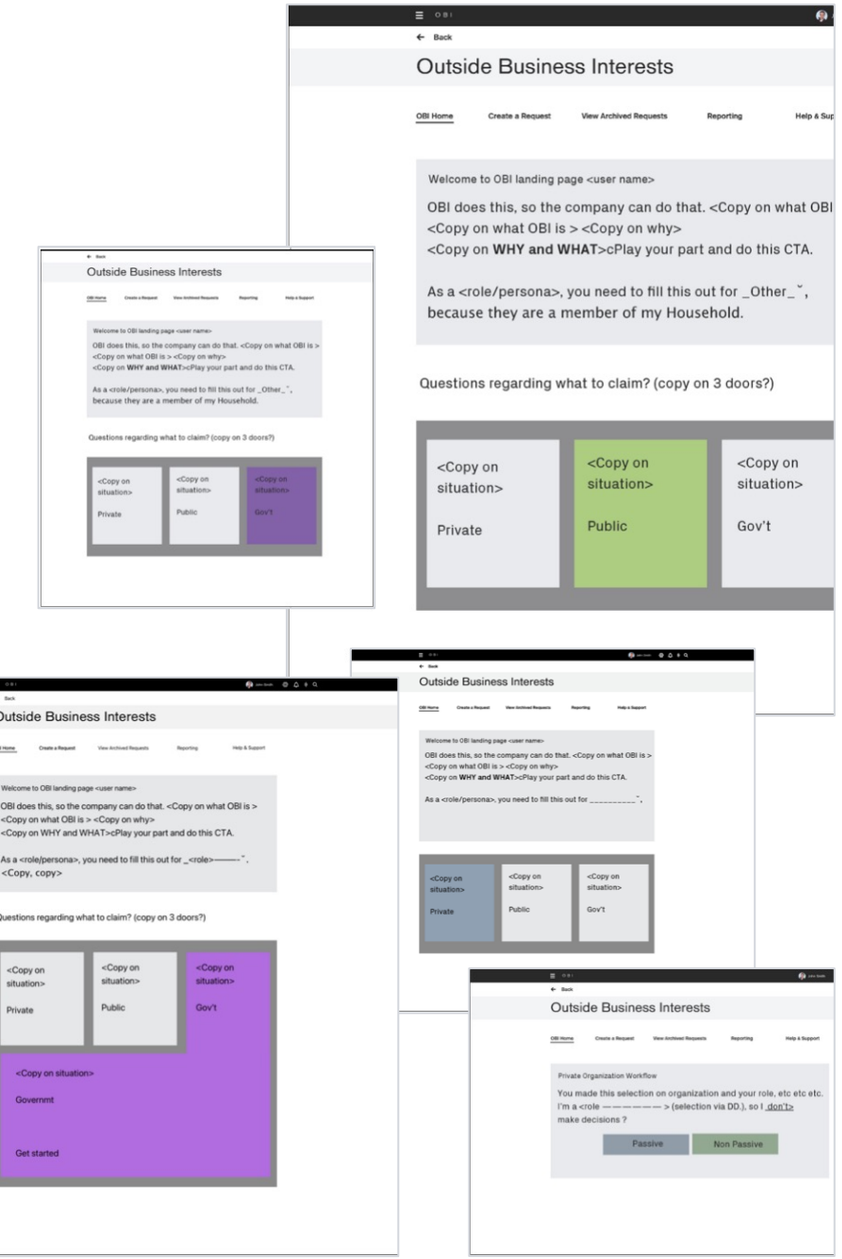
CREDIT SUISSE OBI · DESIGN

Experience design strategy

Based on POC 2 from the design thinking process, and thumbnail sketches.

WHAT WE LEARNED FROM DISCOVERY AND DESIGN THINKING

- Risk & Compliance managers need a dashboard to understand and filter request statuses
- Reporting and other major functions, with sharing and alerts to second-line managers
- Employees were often confused about which form they needed
- They needed education on why, how and when
- They needed to know what to expect when they came back
- One central place to see every submitted request



CREDIT SUISSE OBI · DESIGN

Dashboard design sprint: second iteration

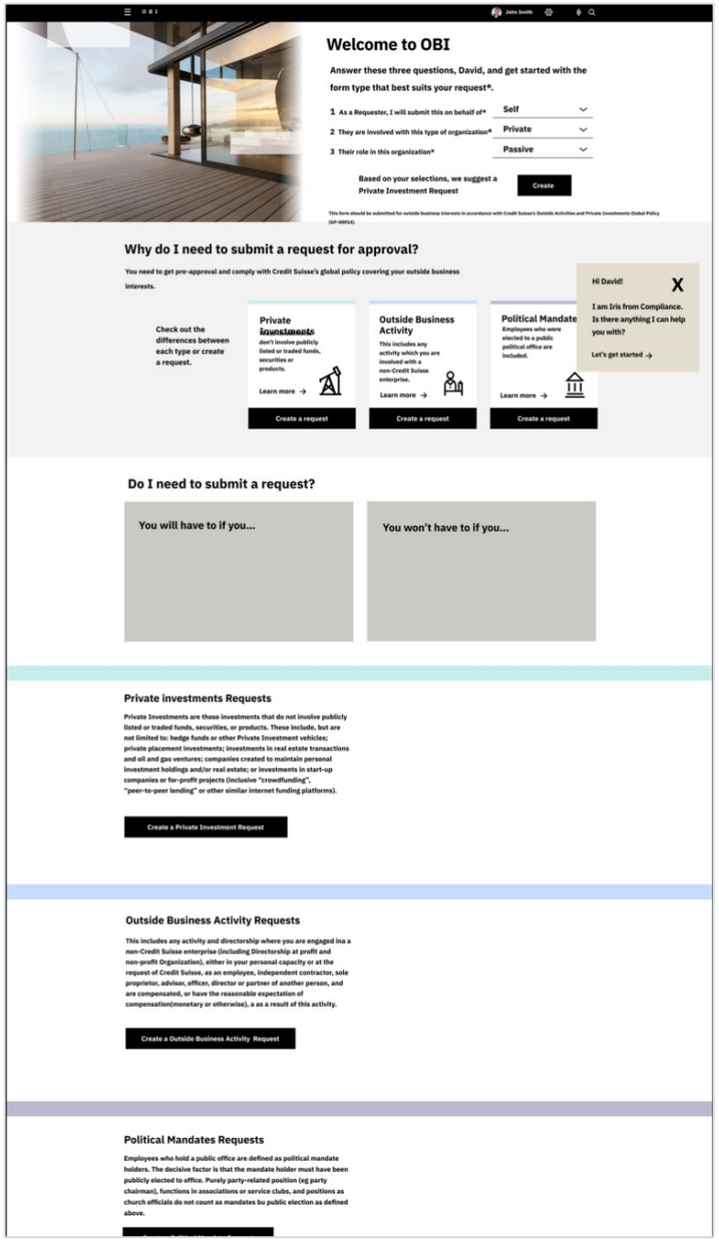
The first iterations put education front and center. Testing showed newer users needed it, but not all.

WHAT WE LEARNED IN TESTING

— Education was a priority for all users

— Users responded to friendlier copy that described the situations they might be in

— Content for Swiss users could be surfaced by user ID and location



CREDIT SUISSE OBI · DESIGN

Dashboard design sprint: final version

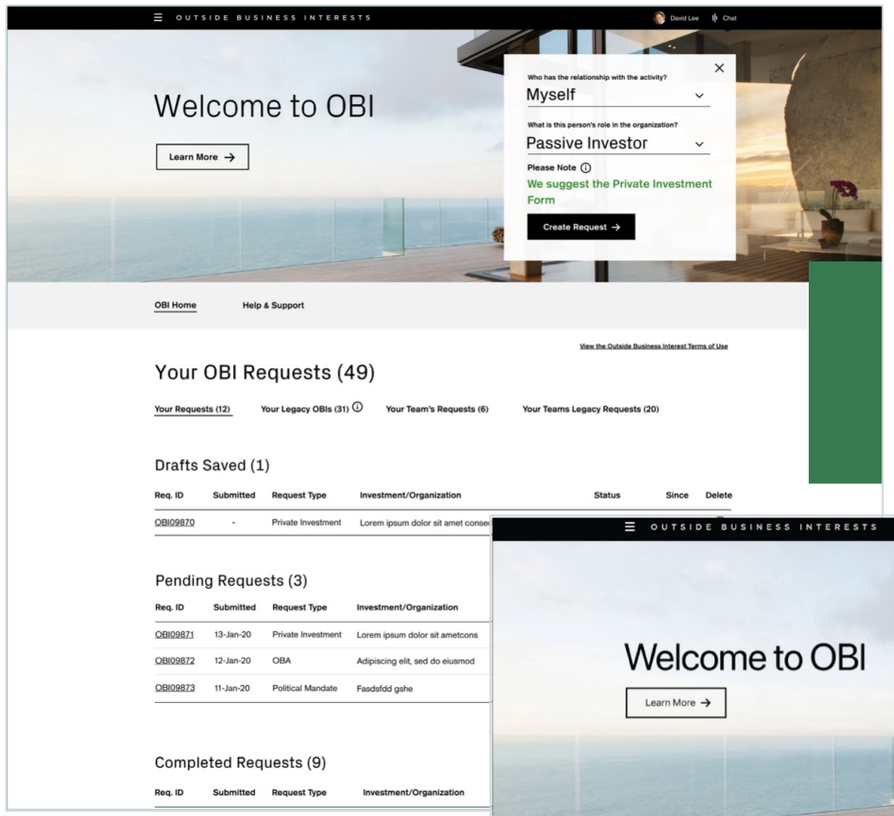
Submitters reach a wizard that asks only 2 questions to find the right form.

WHAT WE LEARNED

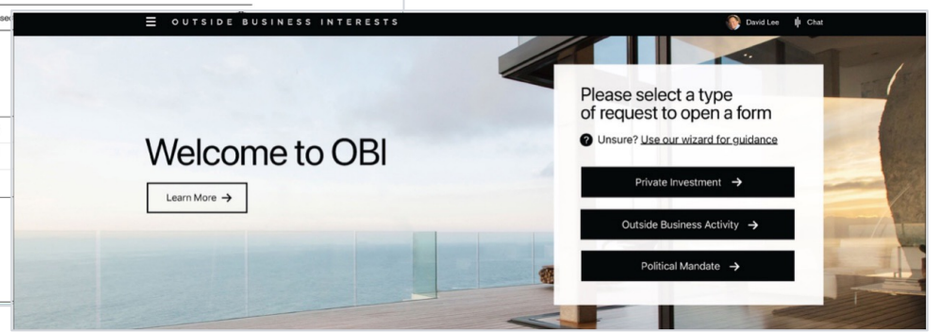
— Easy access to education

— A cleaner interface

— A quick way to start a request



Final Version



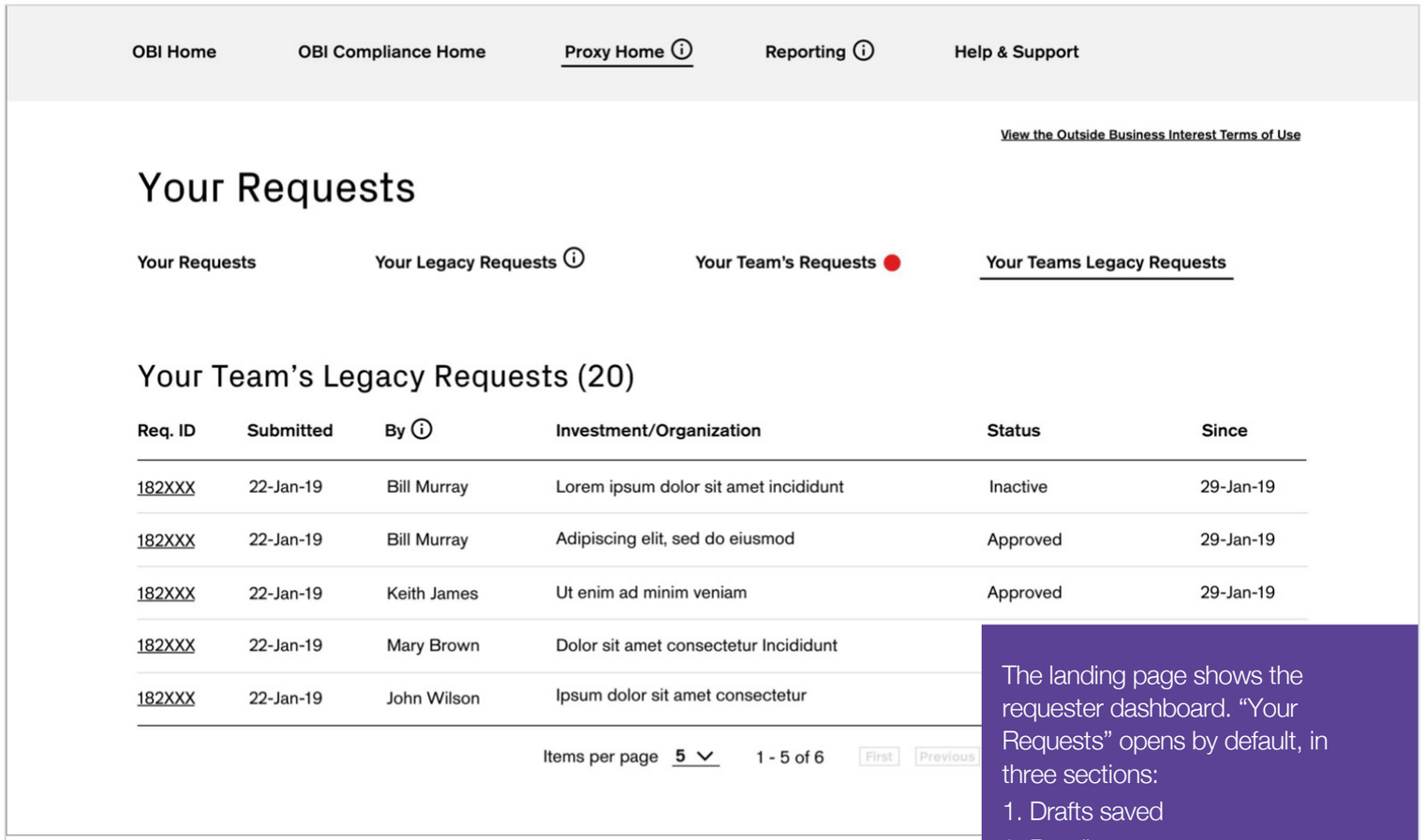
CREDIT SUISSE OBI · DESIGN

Landing page design sprint

Legacy requests from the previous system, OIRS, were migrated into OBI.

YOUR REQUESTS

- Opens by default on the requester dashboard
- Drafts saved
- Pending requests
- Completed requests



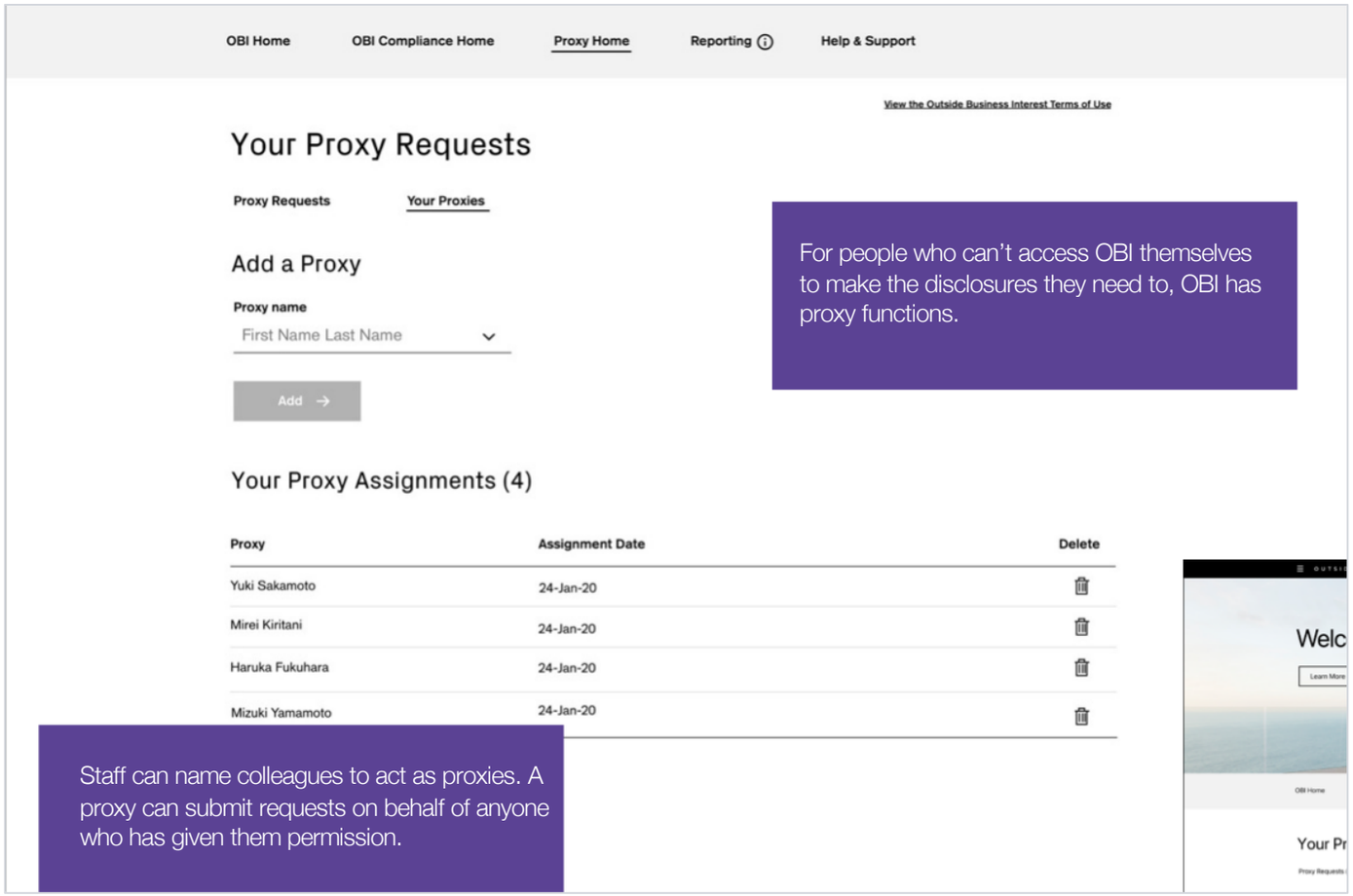
The landing page shows the requester dashboard. "Your Requests" opens by default, in three sections:

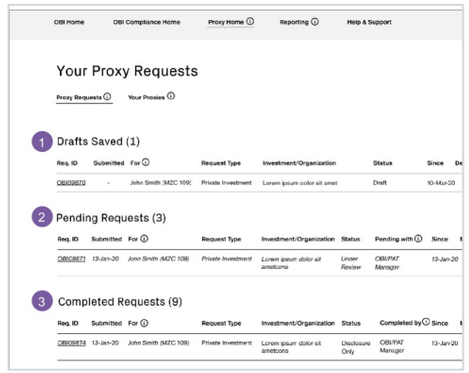
1. Drafts saved
2. Pending requests
3. Completed requests

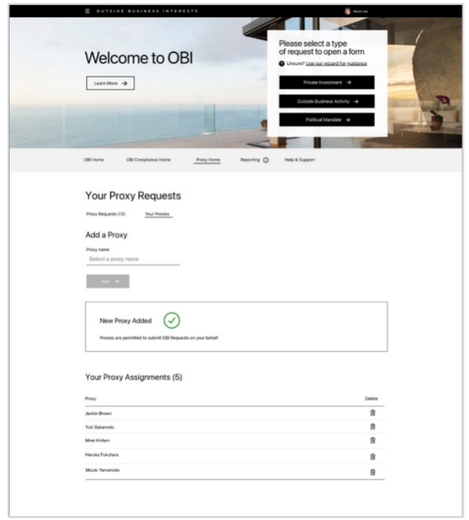
CREDIT SUISSE OBI · DESIGN

Proxy request design sprint

For people who can’t access OBI to make the disclosures they need to.







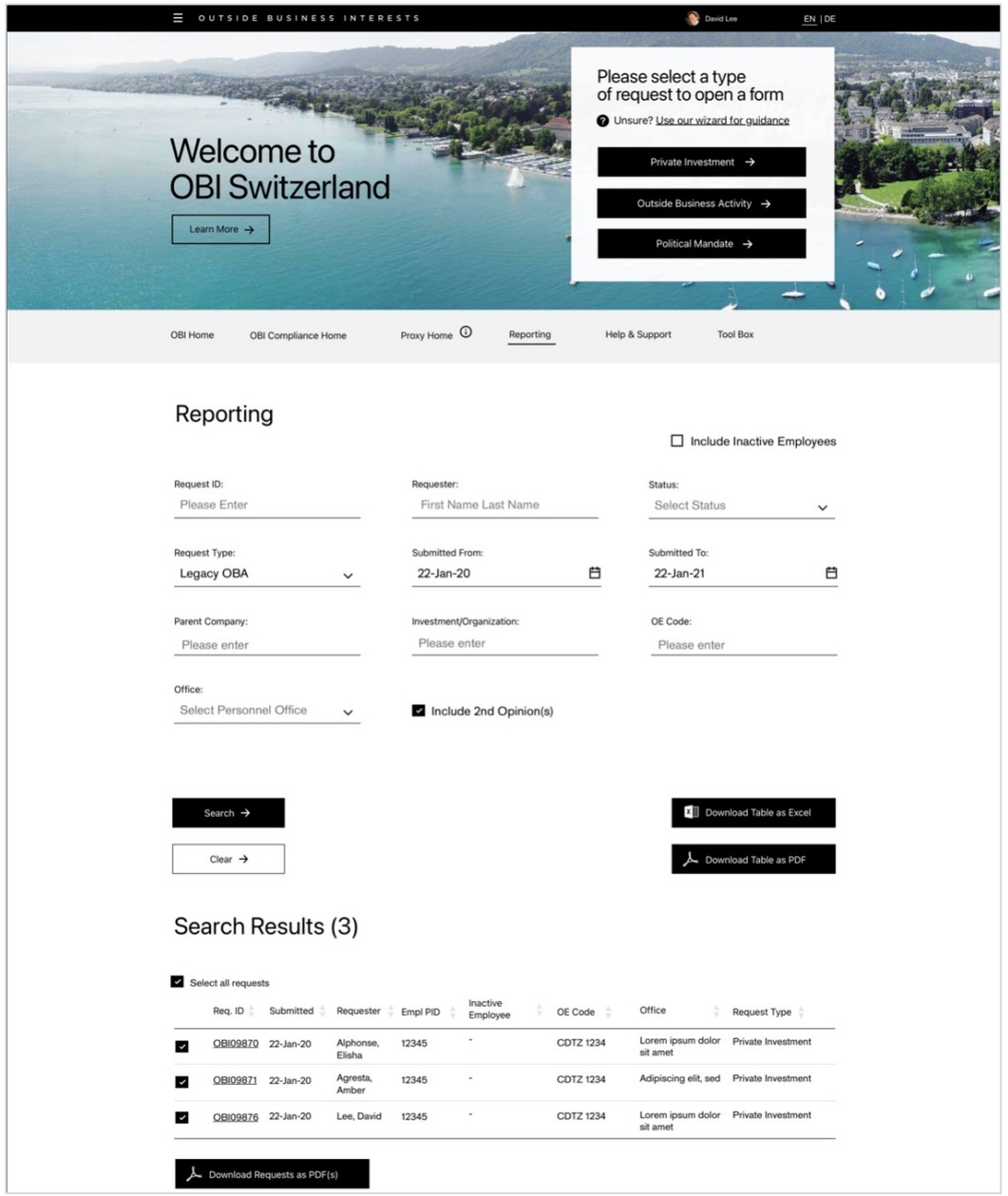
CREDIT SUISSE OBI · DESIGN

Reporting design sprint

Risk & Compliance managers find any request and export the results.

SEARCH BY

- Request ID and requester
- Status and type
- Submission dates
- Company and office
- Export to Excel or PDF



CREDIT SUISSE OBI · KEY CALLS

Four calls that shaped OBI.

A separate dashboard for submitters

Testing showed submitters needed their own starting point, with forms that reveal one step at a time.

Two questions pick the form

Employees didn’t know which form applied. A short wizard asks two questions and opens the right one.

Education written as scenarios

Every user group asked for education. Copy built around real situations tested best, after three iterations.

Tools for approvers too

Proxy submissions for people who can’t access OBI, and reporting by ID, status, office and date, exported to Excel or PDF.

CREDIT SUISSE OBI · OUTCOME

Delivered: one place to submit, review and report, with education built in.

WHAT SHIPPED

- A submitter dashboard with a 2-question wizard that opens the right form
- Your Requests: drafts, pending and completed, with legacy OIRS requests migrated
- Proxy submissions for people who can’t access OBI themselves
- Reporting by ID, requester, status, type, dates, company and office, exported to Excel or PDF

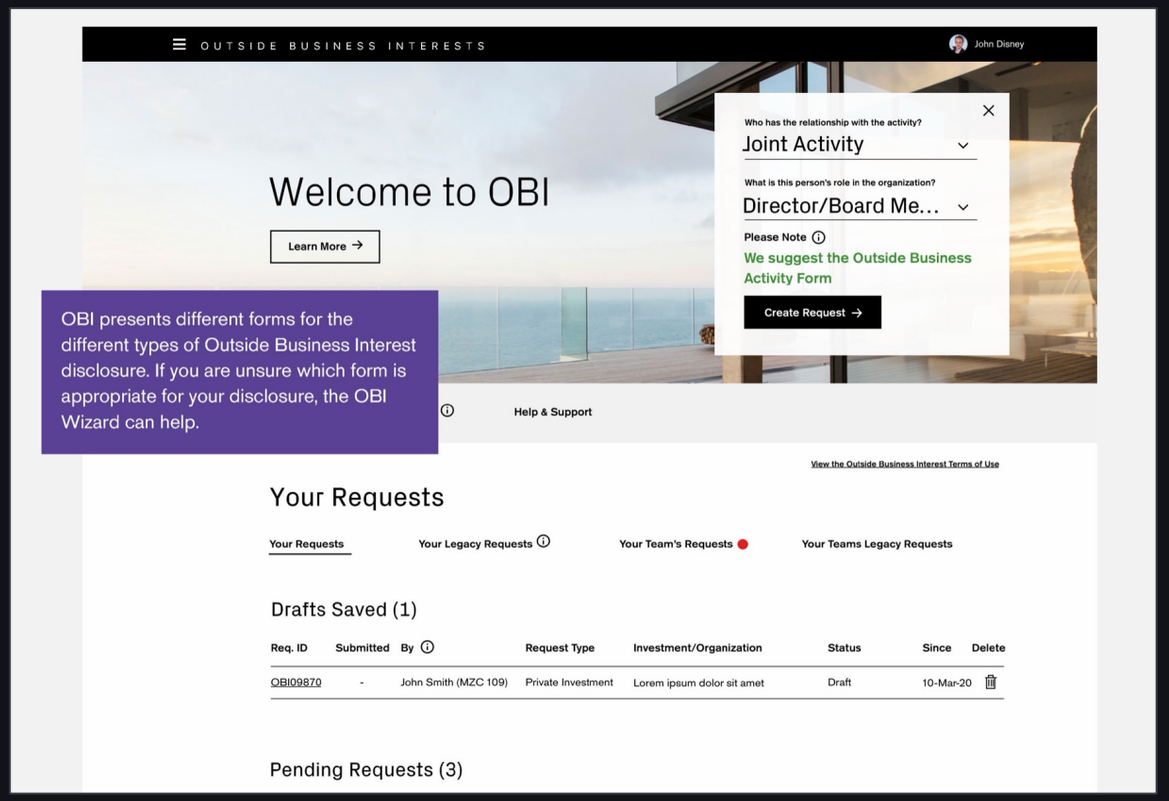
WHAT TESTING TAUGHT US

- Education matters to every user, but only newer users need it front and center
- Copy that describes real situations works better than policy language
- A cleaner interface and a quick start beat more options on the dashboard

CREDIT SUISSE OBI · PROTOTYPE

Follow 1 request through the delivered app.

14 screens from the OBI Training Guide, linked in order: the employee submits, the manager reviews, Compliance decides, and the employee hears back.



Open the OBI prototype →

Or start at the workflow map →

ALSO AVAILABLE

An offline version with the narrative for every step and a full link map: OBI-Request-Prototype.html.

CASE STUDY 03 · CONSUMER MOBILE · DELIVERED

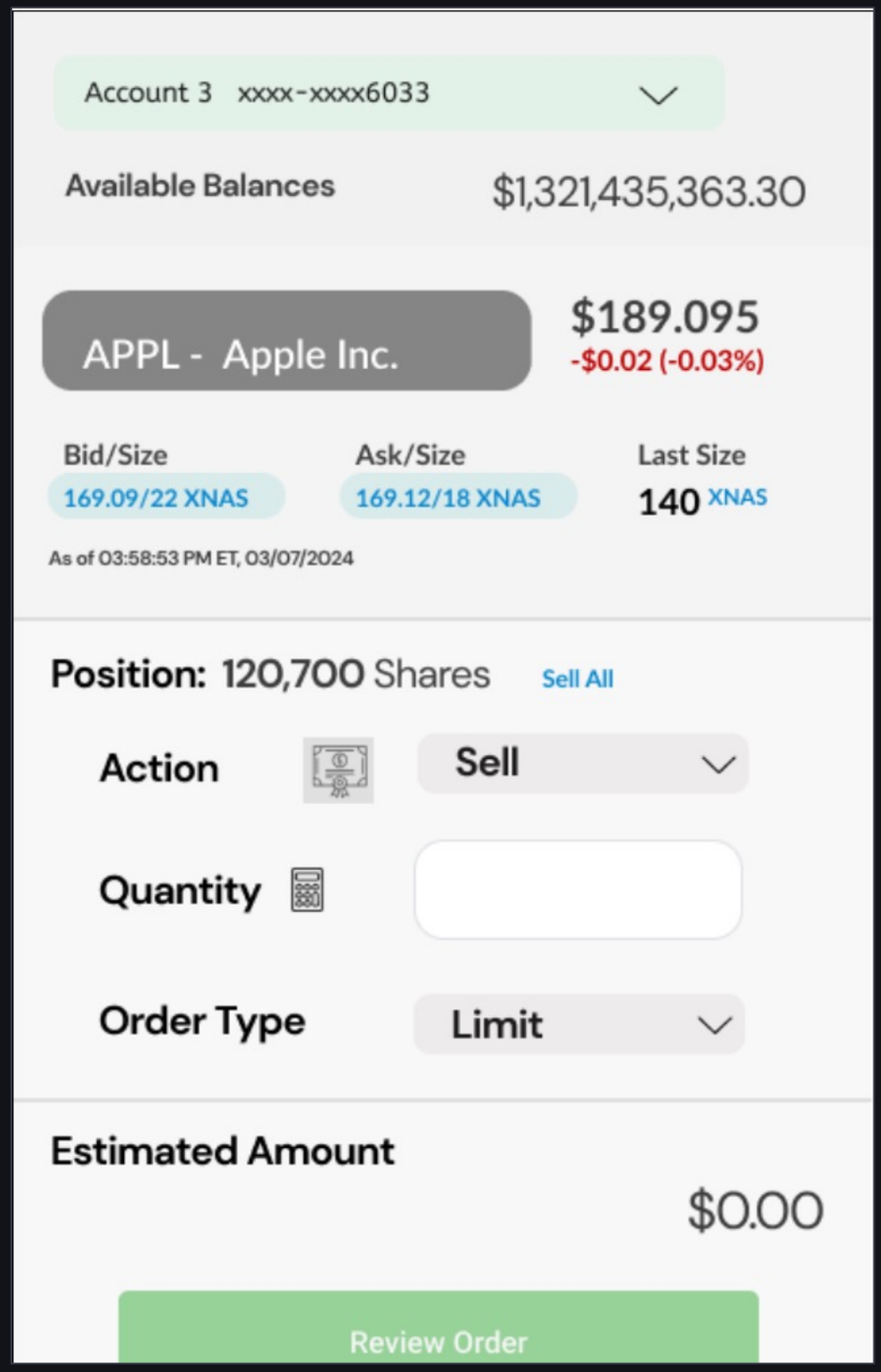
Wells Fargo

Integrated Trade Ticket

Increasing revenue by letting investors trade by share quantity or dollar amount, in one simpler mobile ticket.

ROLE	Led the project team
TEAM	2 UX designers
SCOPE	Discovery, competitive analysis, 3 tested iterations, 6 Agile sprints
USERS	Experienced and novice self-directed traders

“It’s a confusing interface, the app’s interface is non-intuitive, making it difficult to navigate and find specific functions or features.”



WELLS FARGO TRADE TICKET · INTRODUCTION

One trade ticket that lets investors trade in shares or dollars, with fewer errors and less effort.

TARGET AUDIENCE

- Experienced consumer traders
- Novice consumer traders

THE PROBLEMS

- Wealth & Investment Management investors can't trade in both shares and dollars
- The mobile trading process needs simplifying
- A confusing interface
- Limited functionality
- Technical issues and no real-time updates
- Poor customer support

TEAM AND MY PART

- I led a project team of 2 UX designers
- I managed discovery, including research, strategy and hands-on design, supported by AI applications
- I led every deliverable in Figma, with Lean UX and usability testing, and presented to the client and stakeholders

Why redesign the trade ticket?

18.3%

of users ask to trade in both shares and dollars

8.2 min for a new user to complete their first trade

1.4% error rate on submissions

6.1% drop-off on trades in the mobile app

“The app lacks advanced features like drawing tools or technical indicators. Customer support options are limited, with no chat support available.”

WELLS FARGO TRADE TICKET · DISCOVERY

We set out to find real user needs, test the business's assumptions and generate new ideas.

METHODS

- Interviews with external users, internal stakeholders and SMEs
- Experienced and novice traders
- Persona development
- Google design thinking exercises
- Competitive analysis

PROBLEM STATEMENT

As the most important part of the trading experience, experienced and novice users need an integrated trade ticket that simplifies trading, reduces errors and improves efficiency, while letting them trade in shares or dollar amounts.

WELLS FARGO TRADE TICKET · DISCOVERY

“…so non-intuitive, it makes it hard to navigate, find specific functions and just make a quick trade.”

PAIN POINTS WE HEARD IN INTERVIEWS

01 **Can’t trade in both shares and dollars on mobile**

02 **Several interfaces aren’t intuitive**

03 Need more of the right trade detail

04 Flexibility needs to improve

05 More trading options

06 Speed

07 Mobile native

WELLS FARGO TRADE TICKET · STRATEGY

Pain points + business goals + UX strategy = feature set

PAIN POINTS

Can’t trade in both shares and dollars

Interfaces aren’t intuitive

Need more of the right trade detail

Flexibility

More trading options

Transaction speed

Mobile native

+

BUSINESS GOALS

Speed

Education

Platform parity

Integrated systems

Data

+

UX STRATEGY

Simplified interface

Dynamic functionality

Trade speed

Real-time updates

=

FEATURE SET

Order entry

Execution management

Real-time monitoring

Risk management

Post-trade processing

Integration with other systems

Shares vs. dollars

Analytics and reporting

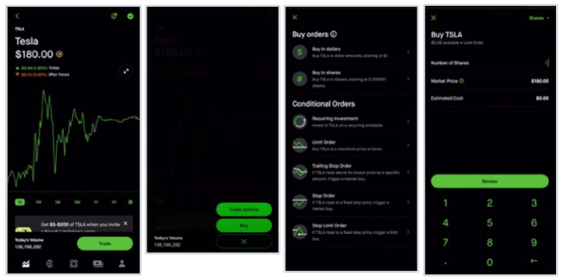
WELLS FARGO TRADE TICKET · DISCOVERY

Competitive analysis

How the leading trading apps handle shares, dollars and the ticket itself

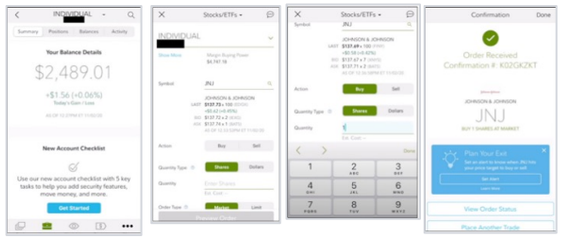
Robinhood

Whole and fractional shares in dollar amounts. A simple switch between shares and dollars, tickets with every detail, and instant trade notifications.



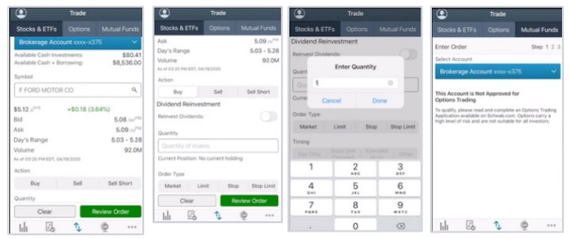
Charles Schwab

Fractional shares from $5 with Stock Slices. Clear, complete trade tickets and an intuitive design.



Fidelity

Shares or dollars, with fractional shares across stocks and ETFs. Detailed tickets with execution time, and easy navigation.



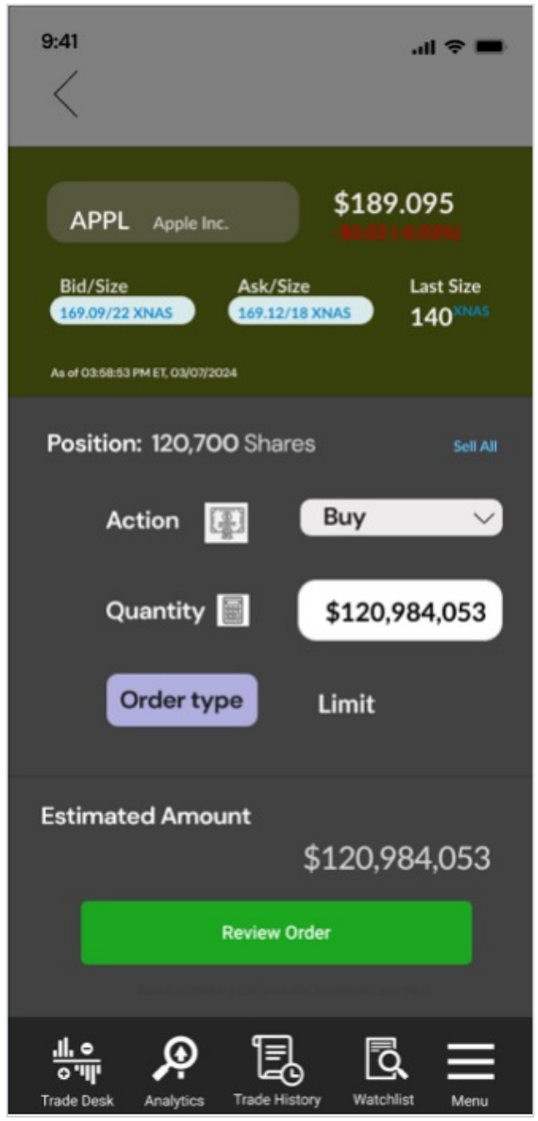
WELLS FARGO TRADE TICKET · DESIGN

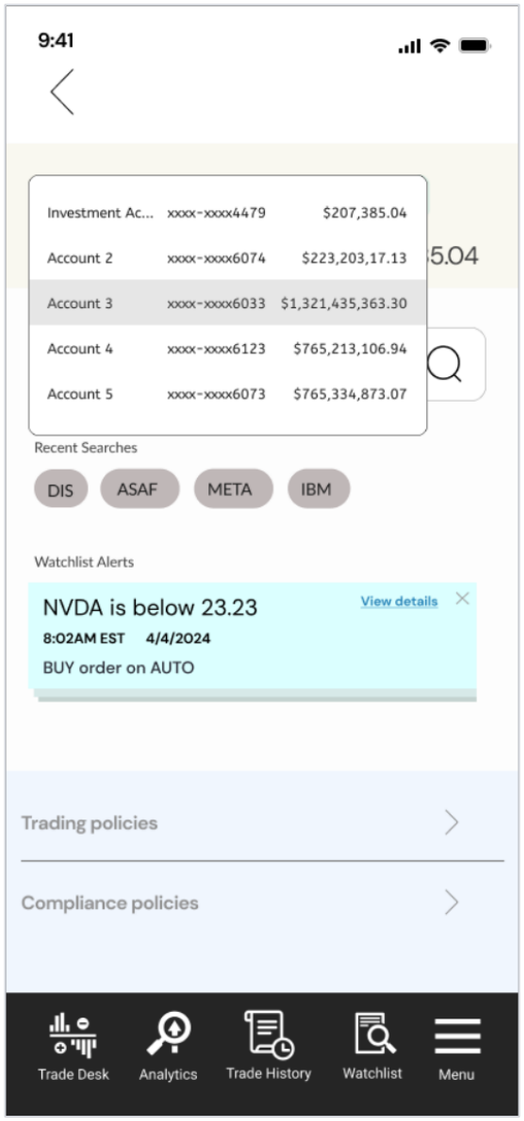
Trade ticket design sprint: discovery

WHAT WE LEARNED FROM DISCOVERY AND DESIGN THINKING

— Account switching would serve most experienced traders and 60% of novice users, and fit the new mobile-native navigation

— Dark mode is important





WELLS FARGO TRADE TICKET · DESIGN

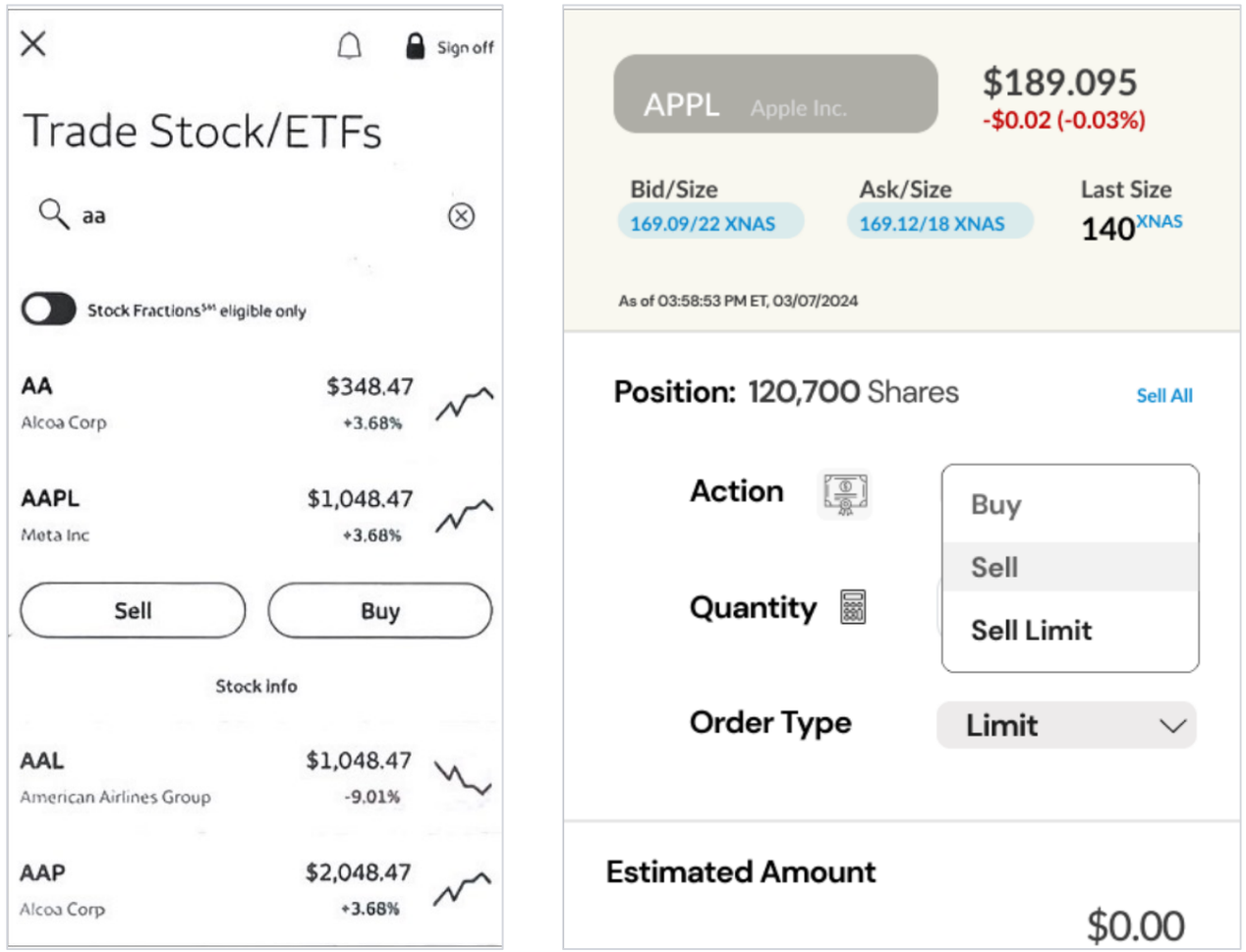
First iteration: start from what they hold

If a user holds the asset, they go straight into a ticket to buy or sell.

THE IDEA

- The asset is already held, so the user lands straight in the funnel
- One toggle switches between dollars and shares
- A predictive interface: only the choices that apply, never too many

First iteration



WELLS FARGO TRADE TICKET · DESIGN

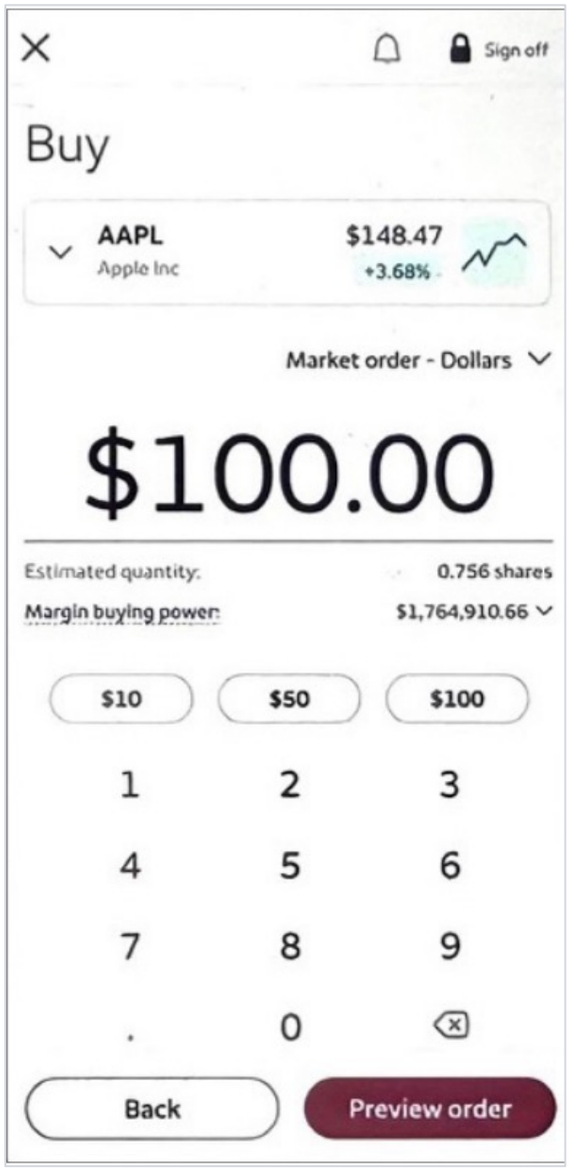
Second and third iterations

A flexible ticket with detail on the stock and on the holding itself.

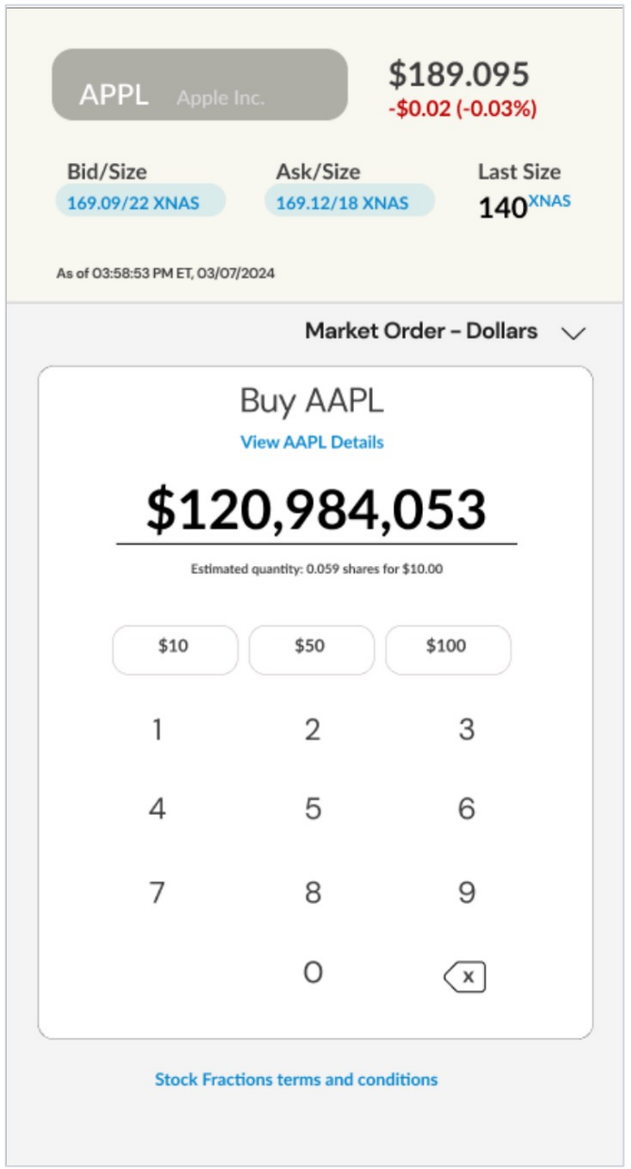
WHAT WE LEARNED IN TESTING

- Education was a priority for all users, but shouldn't distract or slow them down
- Trading in quick amounts is good
- Feedback on the share amount is valuable too
- A custom keyboard was tried in several iterations, then replaced by the system keyboard

Second iteration



Third iteration



WELLS FARGO TRADE TICKET · DESIGN

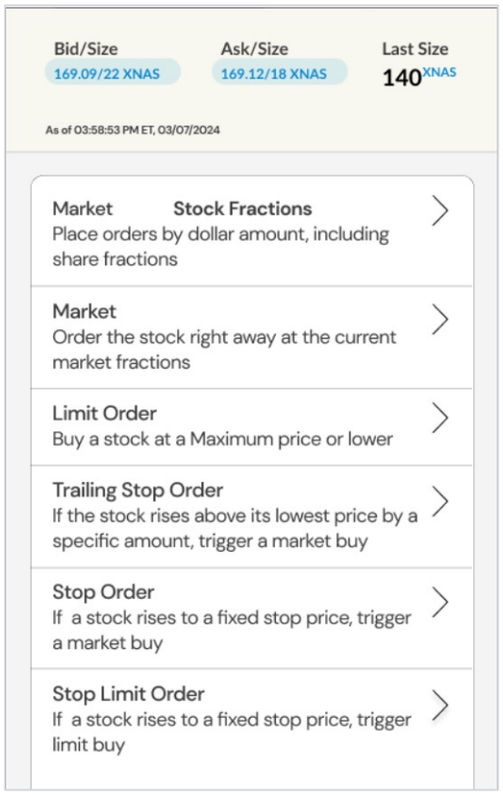
Testing two versions: list or tabs

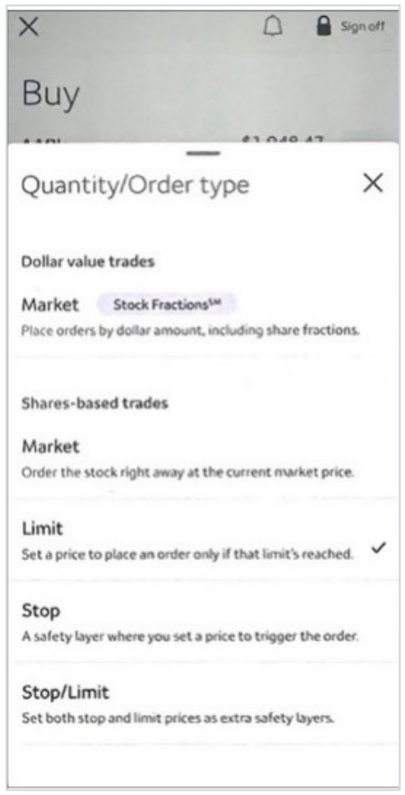
Every order type stays available, whether trading by shares or dollars.

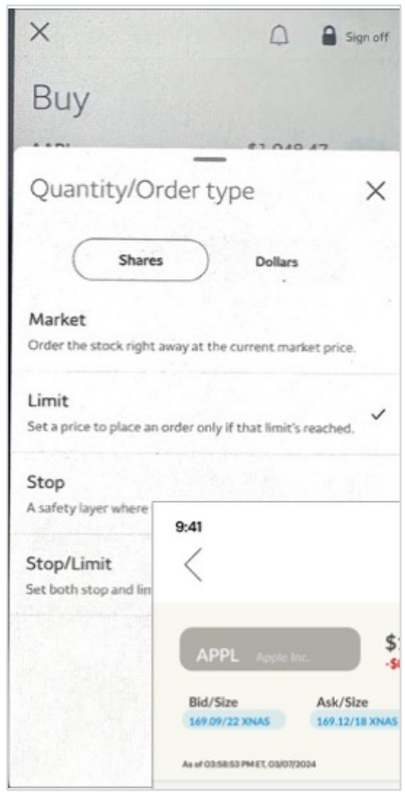
WHAT WE LEARNED IN TESTING

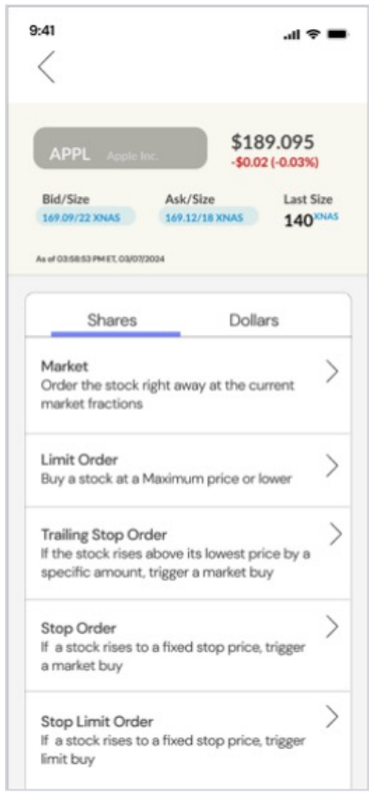
- People preferred the list view to tabs
- The icon next to “Action” scored high
- Quantity and order sheets that appear only when needed made sense to many

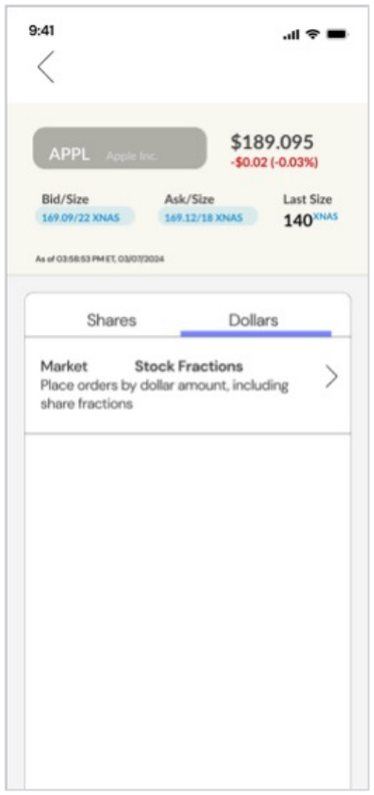
Test version 1











WELLS FARGO TRADE TICKET · DESIGN

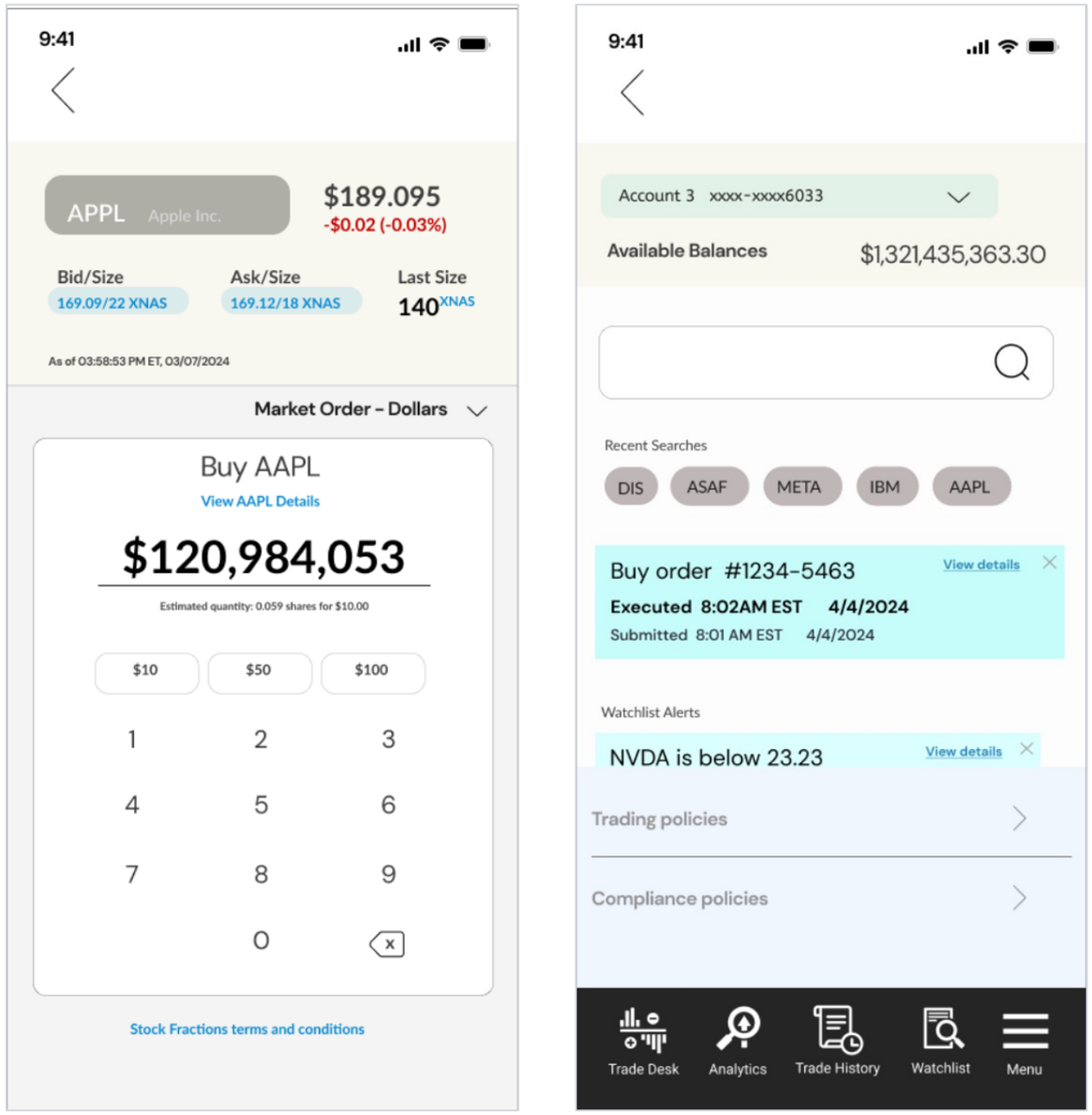
Final delivered solution

Every field stays editable if the user needs to change the order.

WHAT WE LEARNED IN TESTING

- Order types vary
- Color and status changes show where an order is
- Seeing the status right away is vital
- A cleaner interface
- Quick transactions
- Watchlist alerts you can act on

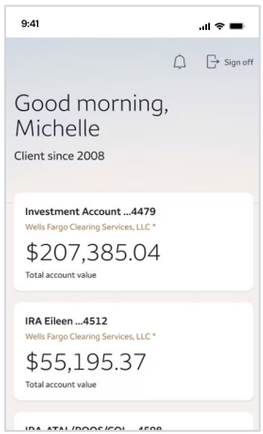
Final delivered solution



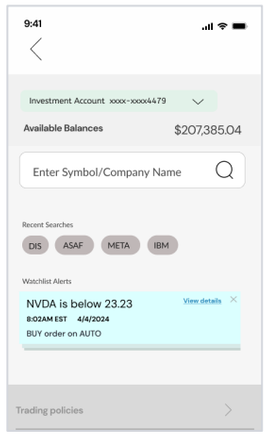
WELLS FARGO TRADE TICKET · DELIVERY

One buy order, on the phone

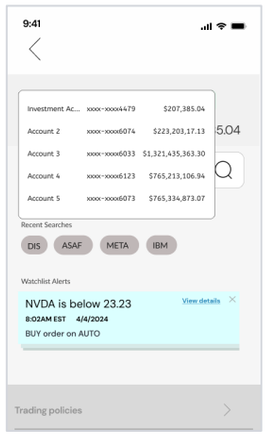
Account, stock, Buy, a dollar amount on the keypad, order type, review in shares, submit, executed.



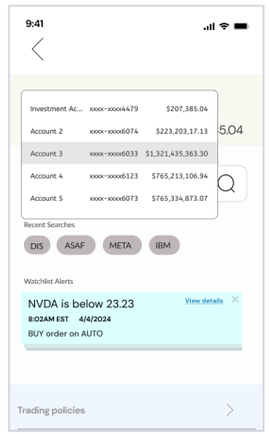
01 Accounts home
Pick



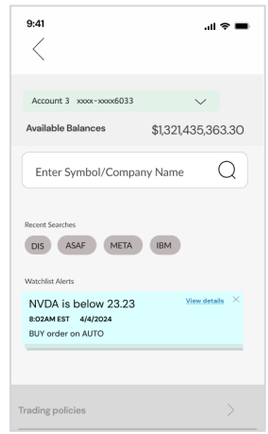
02 The ticket
Pick



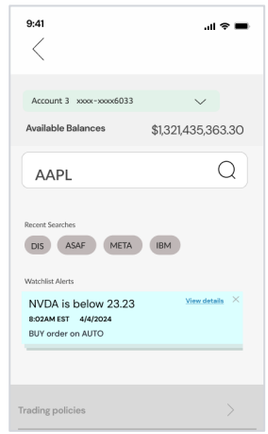
03 Account menu
Pick



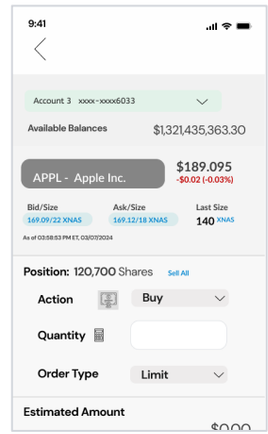
04 Account 3
Pick



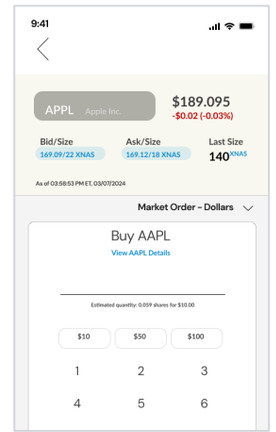
05 Search
Pick



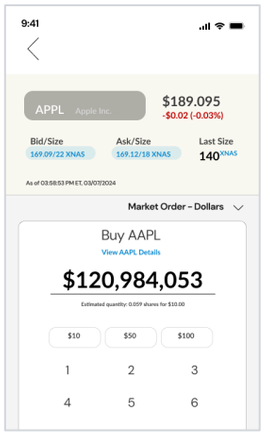
06 AAPL
Pick



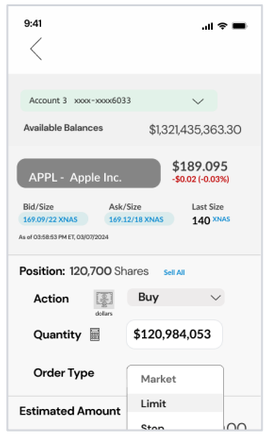
07 Position, then Buy
Build



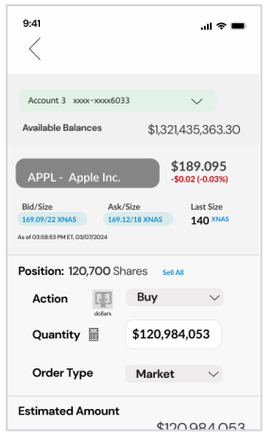
08 Keypad
Build



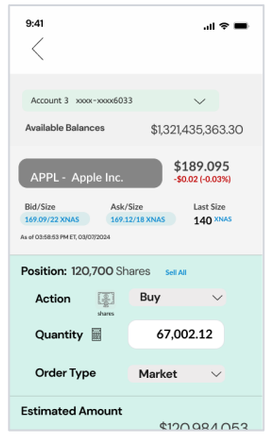
09 Dollar amount
Build



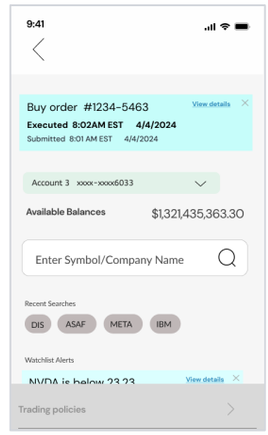
10 Order type
Build



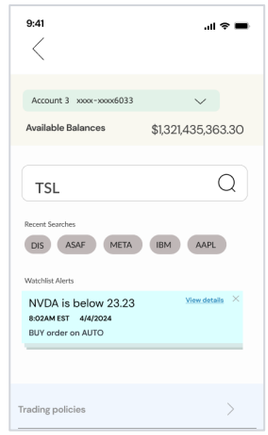
11 Review Order
Review



12 In shares, submit
Review



13 Executed
Status



14 Next trade
Status

TRY IT

[Open the prototype →]

Starts at the accounts home

WELLS FARGO TRADE TICKET · KEY CALLS

Four calls that shaped the trade ticket.

Shares or dollars in one ticket

One toggle switches between trading by share quantity and by dollar amount, instead of two flows.

Start from what they hold

If a user already holds the asset, they go straight into the ticket with their position shown.

Lists over tabs; fields on demand

Testers preferred a list view to tabs. Quantity and order sheets appear only when they apply.

Status at a glance

Order status changes color as it moves. Testers said seeing the status right away was vital.

WELLS FARGO TRADE TICKET · OUTCOME

Delivered: one ticket for shares or dollars, tested in three rounds.

WHAT SHIPPED

- A single ticket with a shares / dollars toggle
- Held assets go straight into a ticket to buy or sell
- A list view, with quantity and order sheets that appear only when needed
- Order status that changes color as it moves, and every field editable

WHAT TESTING TAUGHT US

- Education matters, but it must never slow a trade down
- Quick amounts and feedback on the share amount build confidence
- Seeing the status right away is vital
- The system keyboard beat a custom one

WELLS FARGO TRADE TICKET · PROTOTYPE

Place one order, in dollars or shares.

14 hi-fi screens of the mobile ticket, linked as in the Figma prototype: pick the account and stock, choose Buy, type a dollar amount, pick the order type, review it in shares, submit, and see it executed.

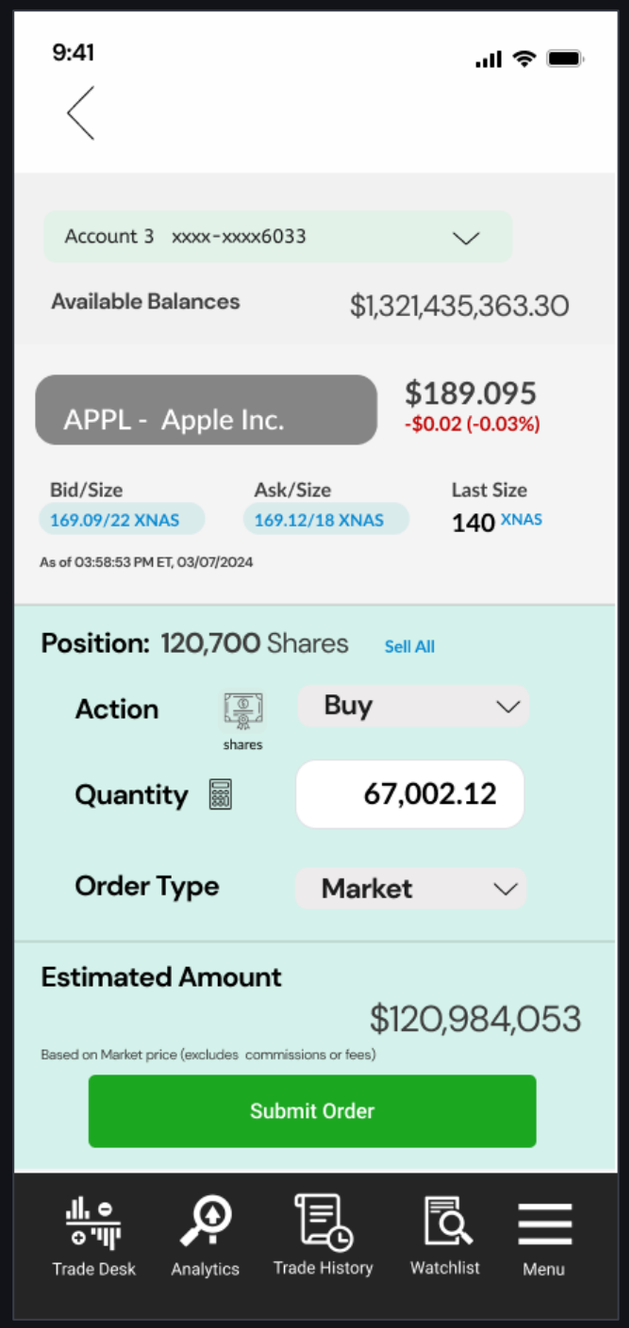
Open the trade ticket prototype →

Or start at the workflow map →

ALSO AVAILABLE

An offline version with the narrative for every step and a full link map: Trade-Ticket-Prototype.html.

Or open the original Figma design file →



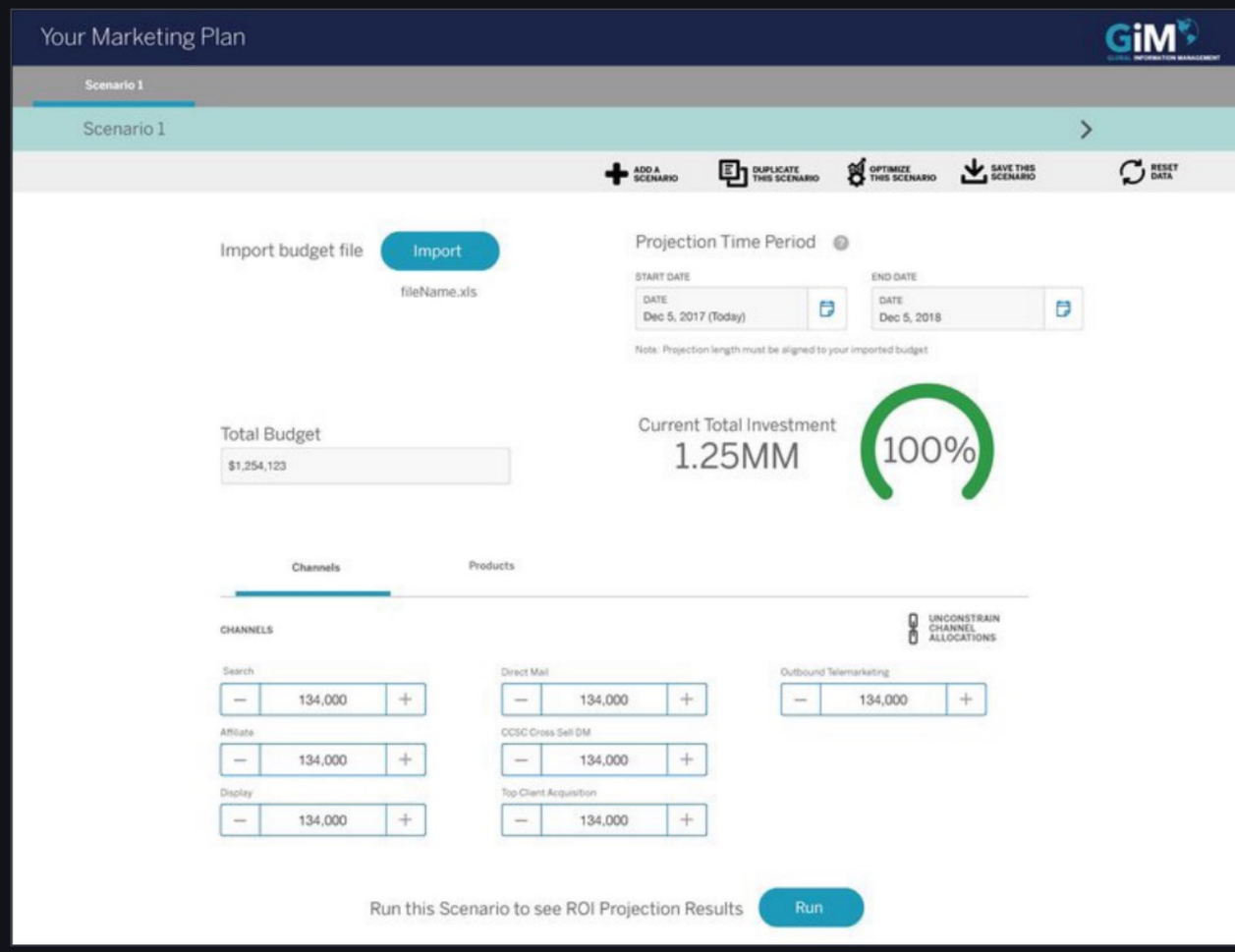
CASE STUDY 04 · B2B DESKTOP · DELIVERED

American Express

MOCA

Increasing revenue by helping advertisers and marketers decide their advertising budgets with AMEX sales partners.

ROLE	Led discovery and all design deliverables
TEAM	Partnered with AMEX data scientists, who built the projection and optimization engines
SCOPE	Wizard, scenario builder and data visualizer for a desktop app
RESULTS	Partner approval 58% → 88%; average client budget $1.34M → $1.8M



"Comparing budgets and then optimizing it would allow me to have the confidence to increase the budget."

A desktop app that projects a marketer's budget and compares built and optimized scenarios.

TARGET AUDIENCE

- American Express sales managers
- American Express sales advisors

THE PROBLEMS

- Sales partners had no effective tool for clients to budget their AMEX advertising dollars
- No way to compare scenarios
- No way to understand how well an investment works
- Need for a more customizable, predictive app using nascent AI technology

TEAM AND MY PART

- I partnered with AMEX data scientists, who built the projection and optimization engines; I designed how partners build, compare and trust scenarios
- I managed discovery, including research, strategy and hands-on design
- I led every deliverable in Sketch and Figma, with Lean UX and usability testing

AMEX MOCA · WHY

Why design MOCA?

$1.34M

average client budget, before MOCA

Before MOCA: $1.34M

After launch: $1.8M (see Results)

58% approval from internal business partners

12 min average time for partners to complete a budget

5.4% drop-off on the current budget process

AMEX MOCA · DISCOVERY

We set out to find real user needs, test the business's assumptions and generate new ideas.

METHODS

- Interviews with internal stakeholders, SMEs and users
- Sales managers and sales advisors
- Contextual interviews
- Persona development
- Co-design sessions with data scientists

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Internal business partners have no tool to help their clients budget AMEX advertising dollars effectively. Users need an application to allocate marketing budgets across the AMEX product lines.

AMEX MOCA · STRATEGY

Pain points + business goals + UX strategy = feature set

PAIN POINTS	+ BUSINESS GOALS	+ UX STRATEGY	= FEATURE SET
Scenario builder	Education	Walk-through wizard	Walk-through wizard
Data visualizer	Platform parity	Scenario builder	Scenario builder
Comparison	Integrated systems	Data visualizer	Data visualizer
Importing data sets from Excel	Data	Import data sets	Comparison
Changing each allocation by channel or product		Channel and product allocation	Import data sets
		Optimization budget tool	Channel and product allocation
			Optimization budget tool
			Integration with internal systems

AMEX MOCA · DISCOVERY

The journey, distilled into 3 steps

1

Walk-through wizard

Guides users through the budget projection: import data, set dates, adjust each allocation by channel and product.

2

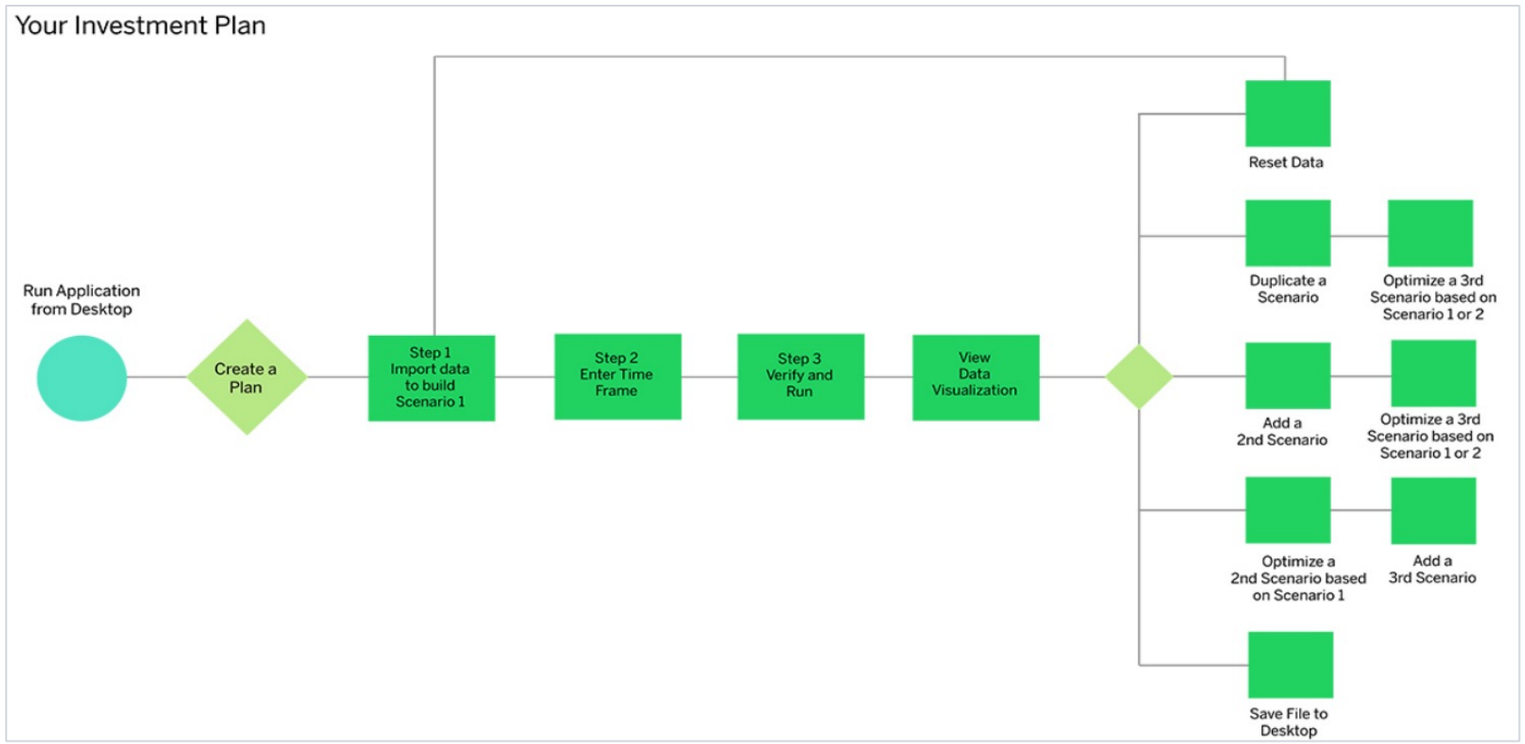
Scenario builder

Build separate scenarios, compare them, and optimize a selected budget using the tool's business intelligence and data.

3

Data visualizer

Visualizations show how each plan breaks down and how the plans compare.



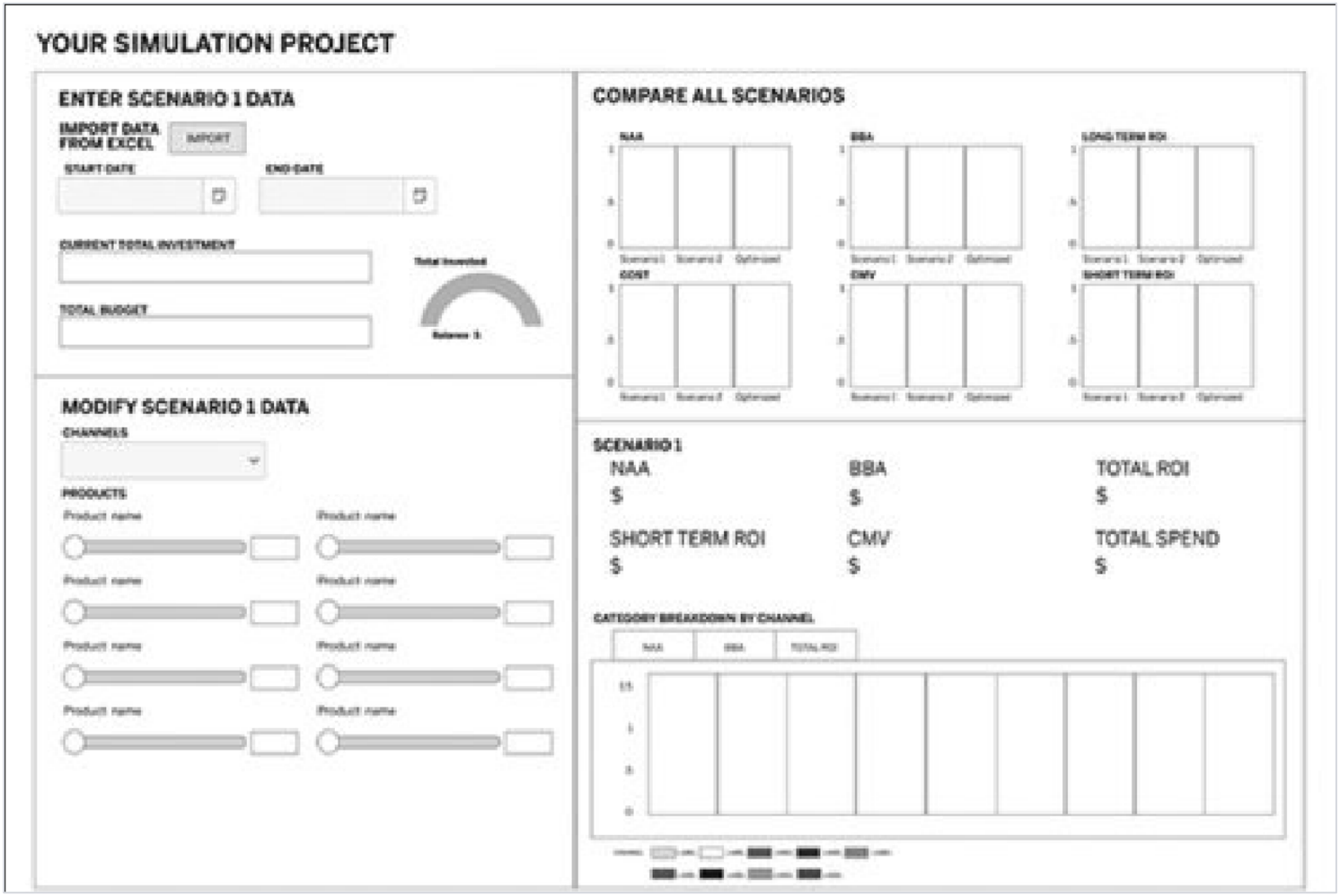
AMEX MOCA · DESIGN

Experience design sprint: start from a past budget

WHAT WE LEARNED FROM DISCOVERY

— Users wanted to import one budget and keep it as a template for the next

— So a new budget can start from an imported one, by duplicating it



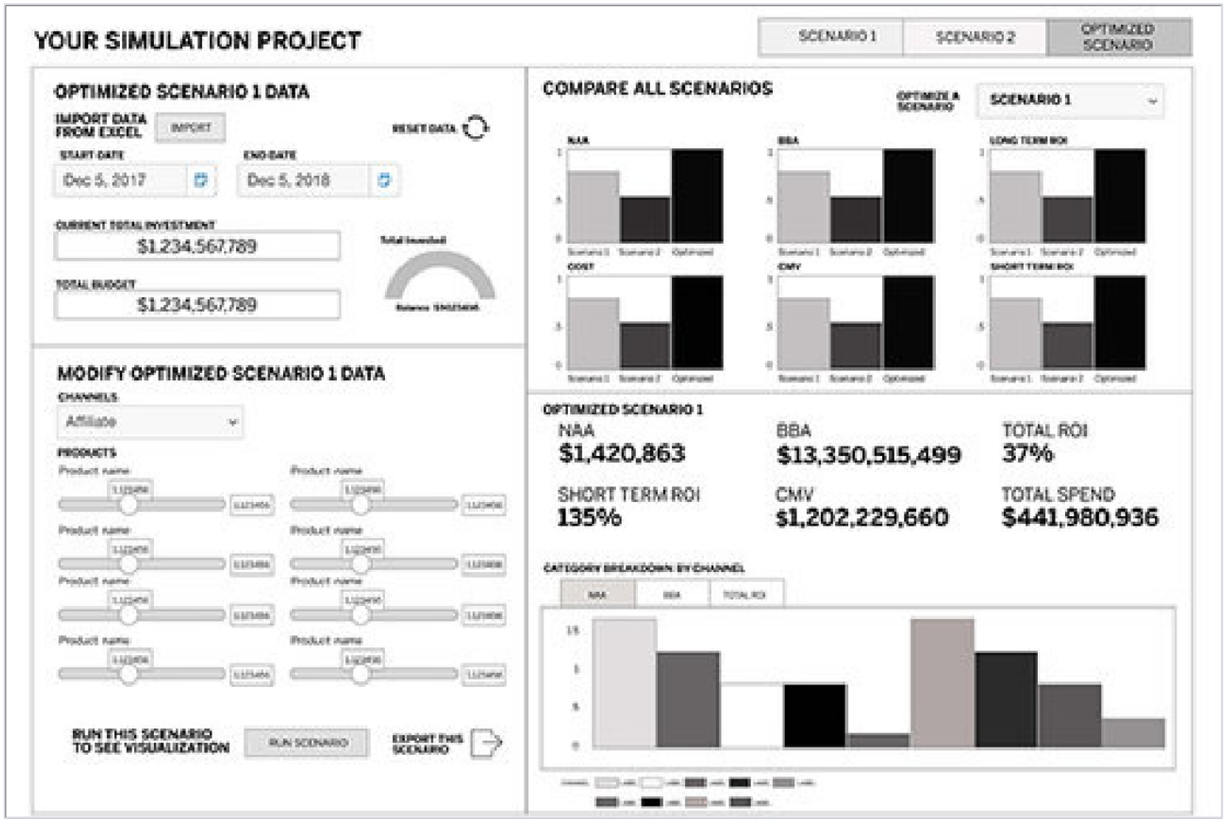
AMEX MOCA · DESIGN

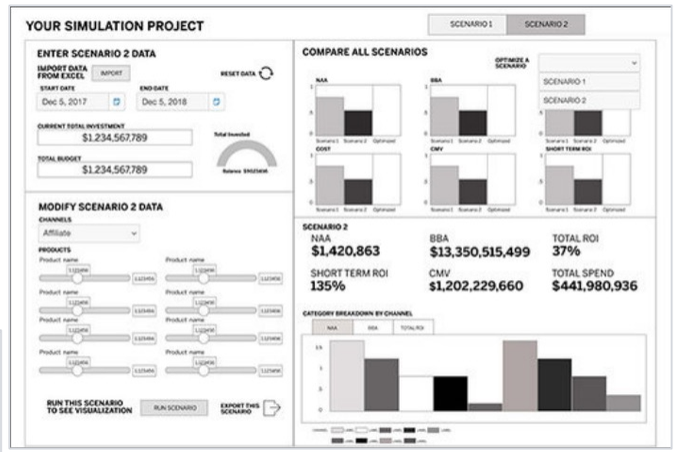
Unexpected challenge: the rest of the desktop

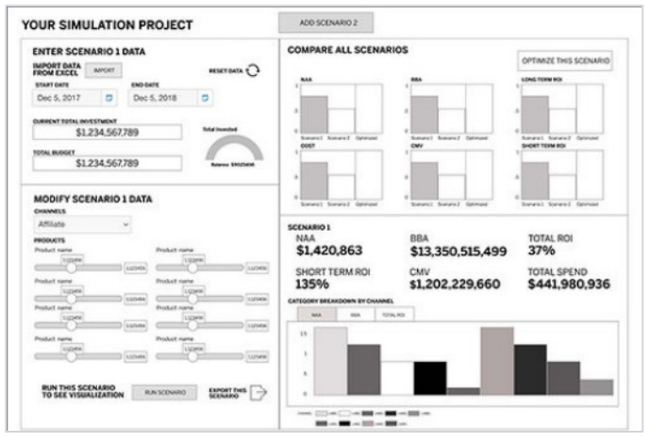
THE CHALLENGE

— As a desktop app, MOCA had to account for the other applications on the desktop

— And how it would connect to them through APIs







AMEX MOCA · DESIGN

Partners want to compare budget scenarios, down to each channel and product.

Users want to see, through data visualizations, how scenarios differ. For a deeper understanding of their allocations, they want to adjust each channel and the products inside it.

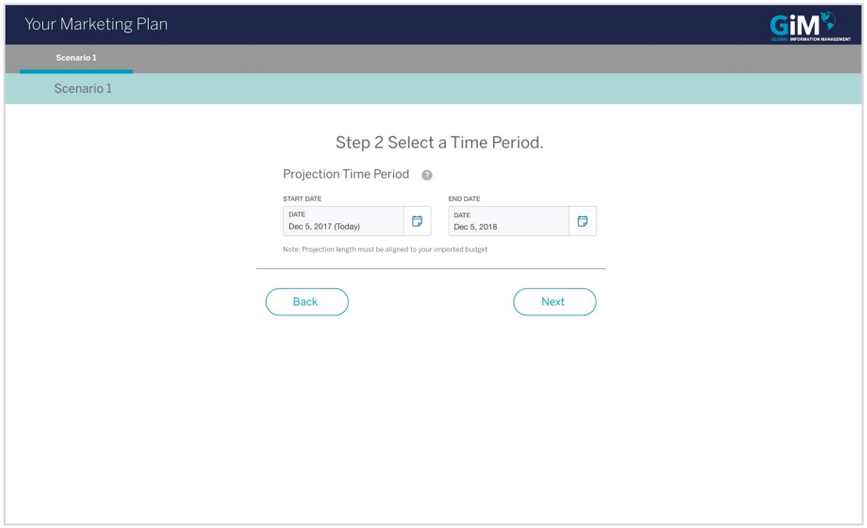
AMEX MOCA · DESIGN

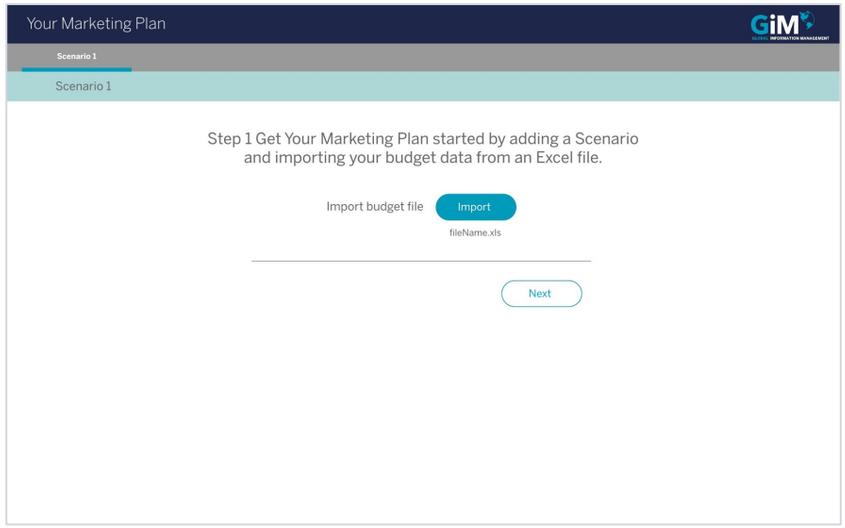
Wizard design sprint

A short, efficient wizard for budget details and time frame.

WHAT WE LEARNED FROM RESEARCH

- Partners use the tool only once every 6–12 months, so many needed more structured guidance
- First-time users wanted a friction-free way to start

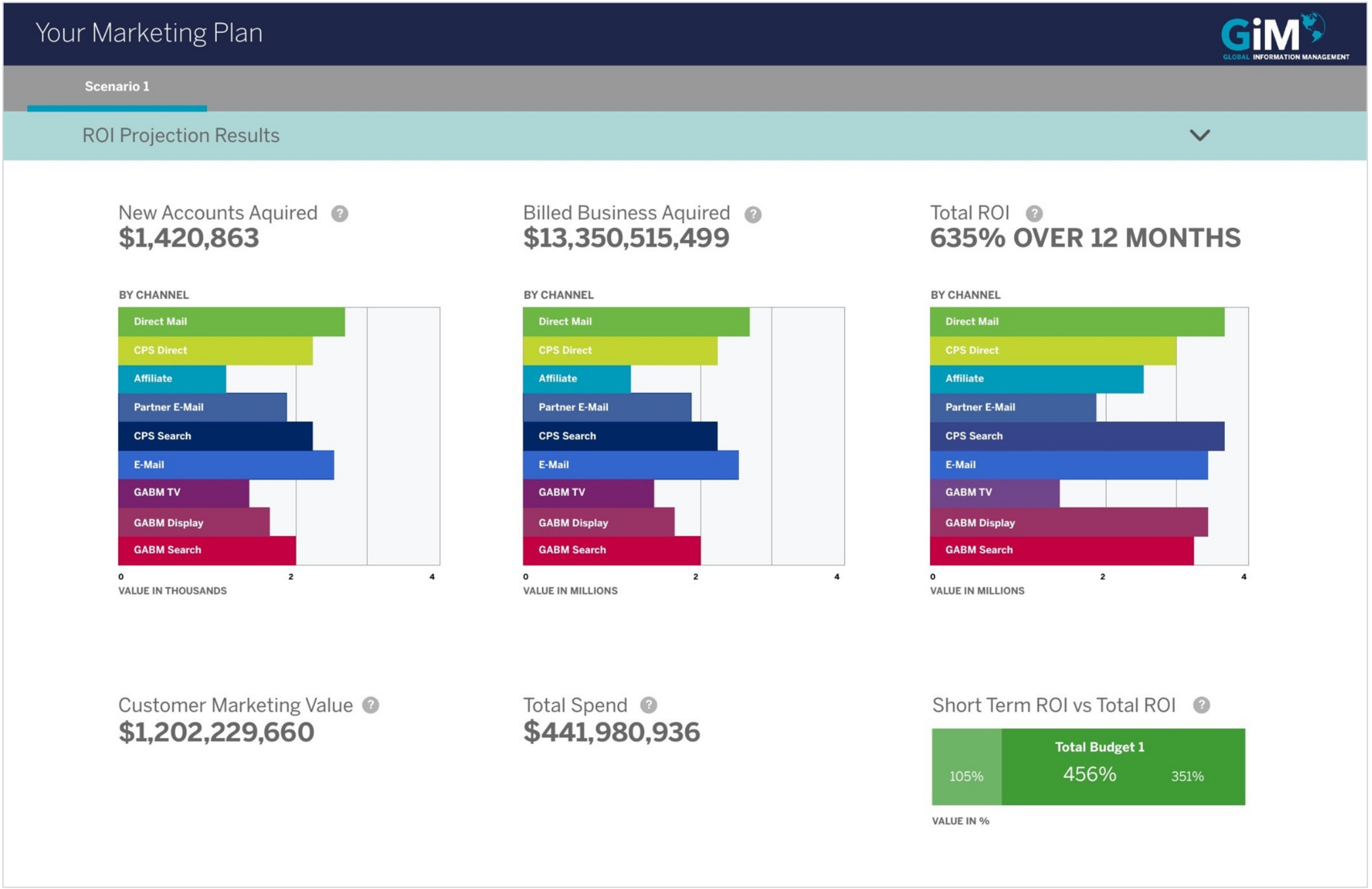




AMEX MOCA · DESIGN

Scenario comparison design sprint

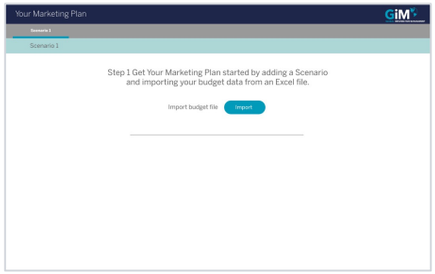
Testers called the channel breakdown vital, and a game changer.



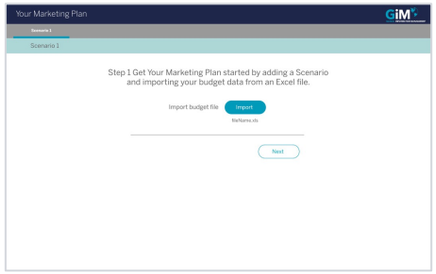
AMEX MOCA · DELIVERY

One client budget, end to end

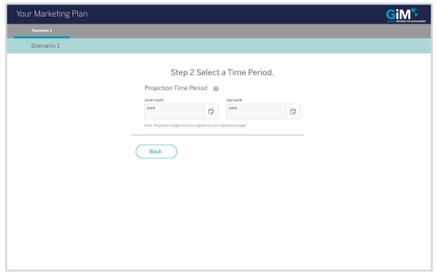
Import, the three-step wizard, the ROI projection, then scenarios, the optimizer and the comparison.



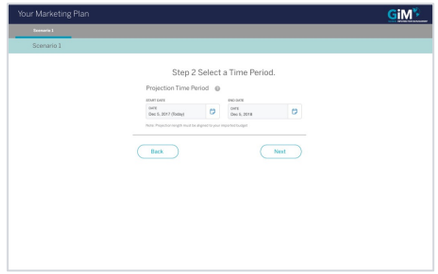
01 Import the budget
Wizard · step 1



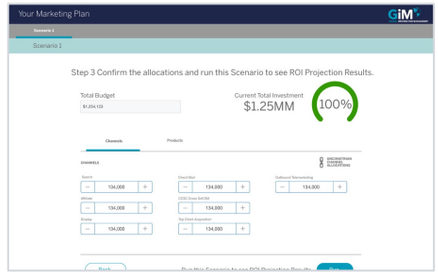
02 File imported
Wizard · step 1



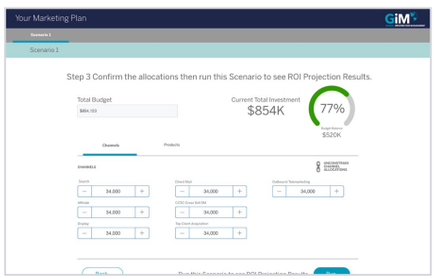
03 Time period
Wizard · step 2



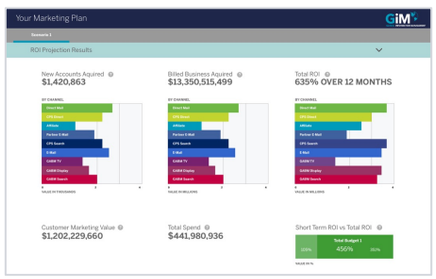
04 Dates set
Wizard · step 2



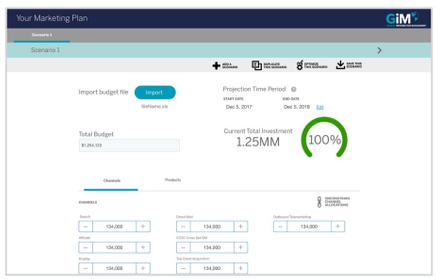
05 Allocations
Wizard · step 3



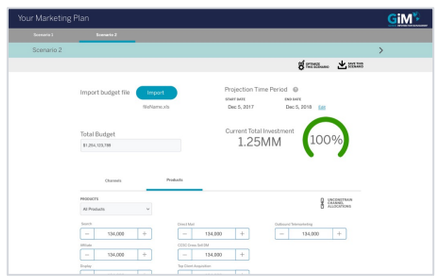
06 Shift and watch the gauge
Wizard · step 3



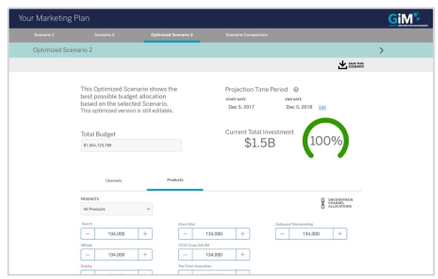
07 ROI projection
Results



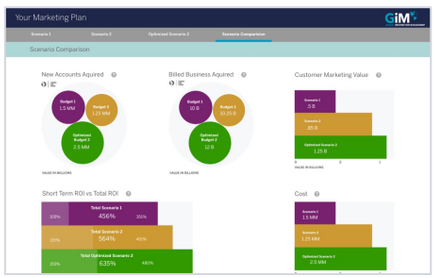
08 Scenario workspace
Scenarios



09 Second scenario
Scenarios



10 Optimized, still editable
Scenarios



11 Compare all three
Comparison

TRY IT

Open the prototype →

Starts at the import step

AMEX MOCA · KEY CALLS

Four calls that shaped MOCA.

A wizard, because use is rare

Partners plan once every 6–12 months, so a guided wizard walks them through each parameter.

Start from last year’s budget

Users import a budget and duplicate it as the template for the next one.

Allocate down to channel and product

Allocations go down to product line or channel, so partners see which part of the budget works.

Compare scenarios side by side

Scenarios are compared visually with switchable chart types; testers called the channel breakdown a game changer.

AMEX MOCA · RESULTS

Partner approval rose from 58% to 88%, and budgets grew.

88%

approval from internal business partners

Before MOCA: 58%

After: 88% (+30 pts)

$1.8M

average client budget

Up from $1.34M · +34%

3.4%

drop-off on the budget process

Down from 5.4%

10 min

to complete a budget

Down from 12 min

5 min

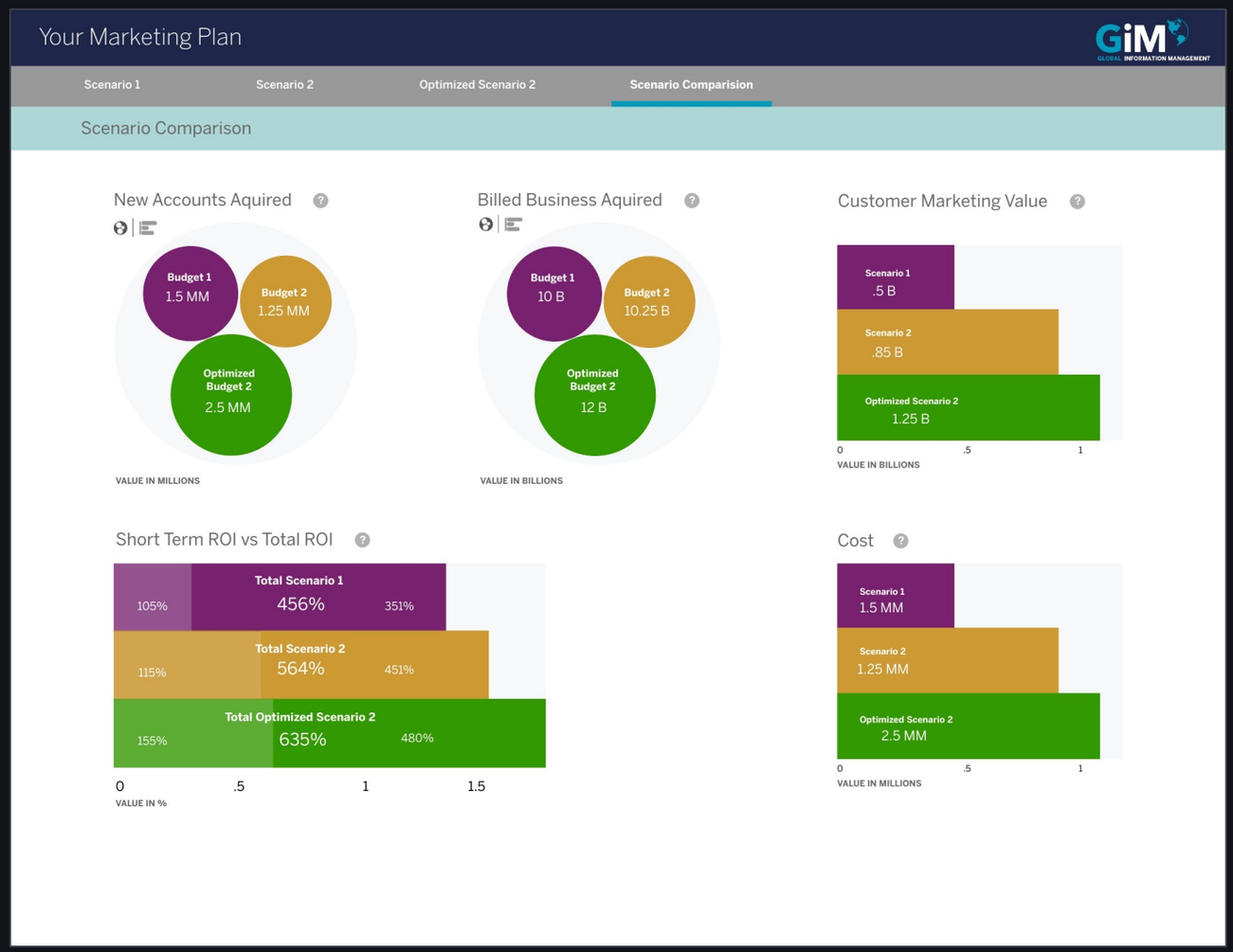
to compare budget scenarios

A new capability

AMEX MOCA · PROTOTYPE

Build, project and compare a client budget.

11 hi-fi screens linked in order: import the client's budget, set the period, shape the allocations, see the ROI projection, then add, optimize and compare scenarios.



Open the MOCA prototype →

Or start at the workflow map →

ALSO AVAILABLE

An offline version with the narrative for every step and a full link map: MOCA-Budget-Prototype.html.

CASE STUDY 05 · AI PRODUCT · PROTOTYPE

Meridian Navigator

AI-assisted trading prototype

Retail investors juggle research, orders, and monitoring across separate tools. Does AI insight beside the trade help them decide?

ROLE	Lead UX designer
TEAM	Solo lead, with AI agents for drafting
SCOPE	Five screens, two eight-step trade flows, agent concepts, design system
STATUS	Prototype. Mock data. Tests are set; none has run yet

Portfolio prototype. Mock data only. Hypotheses until validated.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · OVERVIEW

Five screens, one trade, one place for AI

THE FIVE SCREENS, EACH ANSWERING ONE QUESTION

Dashboard	What do I own today?
Insight	What moved, and why?
Prospect	What might fit my plan?
Guard	What needs my attention?
Adapt	Should my mix change?

Scope: five screens, two trade flows of eight steps each. Mock data only.

PRODUCT

An AI layer on a trading app, next to the order flow.

PROBLEM

Research, order entry, position watching, and rebalancing sit in different places. The hold-or-exit call gets made in the user's head.

AI SOLUTION

Summaries with their source, alerts ranked by severity, and plans the user reviews one step at a time.

MY ROLE

Lead UX designer: framed the problem, set the AI rules and five innovation concepts, designed the trade, AI and workflow flows, built the design system, and produced the prototype.

What I did, how, why, with whom, and what came of it

WHAT I DID

Framed the problem and scope. Set the AI rules and the five innovation concepts, each tied to a breakdown. Designed the trade, AI and workflow flows. Built the Figma design system. Produced the SwiftUI prototype.

HOW I DID IT

Frame, hypothesize, map flows, design every state, prototype, then test. Testing is planned, not yet run.

WHY I DID IT

Insight, Prospect, Guard, and Adapt show what the trade needs without making the call. Each decision has a stated trade-off.

WHO WAS INVOLVED

Solo lead designer. AI agents helped with drafting; every call is mine. Personas are drafts for validation, not user research yet.

WHAT CAME OF IT

Five screens, two eight-step trade flows, five concepts and one workflow for testing, a design system shared with the code, and wireframes for states, agent, and full experience.

RESULT

Not yet measured. The planned measures are listed in the methodology section, with targets set before any test.

Context and constraints

What the prototype has to prove, and what it cannot yet.

BUSINESS CHALLENGE

Show one complete loop, from noticing a change to placing an order, in a prototype stakeholders can test.

STAKEHOLDERS

Active traders, busy investors, and first-time investors.

CONSTRAINTS

Mock data and a 0.8-second mock delay. No real market feed, brokerage connection, or authentication backend at this stage.

ADVICE LINE

The AI does not originate buy or sell advice. Trade wording needs compliance review before it ships.

The user problem and the AI problem, defined separately

USER PROBLEM

Research, order entry, watching positions, and rebalancing live in different places. The hold-or-exit call gets made in the user’s head.

AI PROBLEM

Summarize what moved and why, with the source. Rank alerts by how much they need attention. Propose a rebalance the user can review.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · USERS

Three draft personas to validate before we rely on them

DRAFT PERSONA · MAYA

Active self-directed trader. Trades several times a week from her phone.

Goal: get in and out quickly; spot momentum early.

Pain: research is scattered; order entry takes too many taps.

DRAFT PERSONA · DANIEL

Busy professional investor. Invests a fixed amount each month and checks his portfolio weekly.

Goal: grow long-term savings without big mistakes.

Pain: no time to research; unsure when to rebalance.

DRAFT PERSONA · PRIYA

First-time investor. Wants to start small and learn while she invests.

Goal: learn by doing; avoid a wrong trade.

Pain: jargon; fear of ordering the wrong amount.

Hypotheses from the FigJam board. Interviews come before any decision rests on them.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · THE SOLUTION

One trade in eight steps, by share quantity or dollar amount

1. Trade setup

2. Choose action

3. Enter quantity or amount

4. Confirm quantity or amount

5. Choose order type

6. Review and approve

7. Submission outcome

8. Return to dashboard

The dollar flow runs the same eight steps, with Enter Dollar Amount and Confirm Dollar Amount in place of the share steps.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · STATES

Designing for the states that mock data hides

The dashboard in four states. The other four screens follow the same pattern.

STATE	WHAT THE USER SEES
Empty	No holdings yet. One clear next step.
Loading	Skeleton cards hold the layout while data loads.
Error	Says what failed, and offers a retry.
Offline	Says the data is from the last update, with its time.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · REASONING

Four calls, and what each one cost

WE CHOSE	WE REJECTED	WHY, AND THE TRADE-OFF
Share and dollar entry in one ticket	One entry model only	Unclear which model new investors prefer. Trade-off: two flows to maintain; open question for testing.
A mock API with a 0.8-second delay	A live backend now	Tests flows and loading states without a backend. Trade-off: real timing, errors, and data limits stay untested.
Adapt proposes steps the user can review	A batch the user approves or dismisses	It is the screen’s job. Trade-off: trade wording needs compliance review; it may become explanation only.
Five tabs, one home screen	Trading as a separate app area	A scannable set of areas, with trading one tap away. Trade-off: AI screens compete with trade entry; test it.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · AGENT EXPERIENCE

Where the AI experience breaks down today

Five problems, from the current prototype and the design review. Mock data throughout.

1 · OUTPUTS WITHOUT REASONING

Insight shows sentiment with no source, date, or data behind it.

2 · ALL OR NOTHING

Adapt offers one batch of proposed steps. The user can approve or dismiss the batch, nothing else.

3 · NO LEARNING LOOP

Dismissing or correcting an insight does not change future output.

4 · ADVICE LINE IN CONFLICT

The design rule says the AI never originates buy or sell advice. Adapt wording does. Compliance review is open.

5 · CONTEXT LOST BETWEEN SCREENS

Moving from an insight to an order drops the reason, so the user enters it again.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · AGENT EXPERIENCE

Five concepts, each answering one breakdown

Concepts for testing. Proposals, not built. Each one follows the AI rules.

DECISION JOURNAL

Breakdowns 3 and 5. The user writes one line of their reason when acting. Guard later checks whether the reason still holds.

SCENARIO SANDBOX

Breakdowns 1 and 4. Each insight lists what would change it. The user adjusts an input and sees the view update, with sources.

PLAN EDITOR

Breakdown 2. The user edits each proposed step, and the allocation preview recalculates after each change.

ATTENTION BUDGET

Breakdown 3. The user sets a daily budget of interruptions. Critical alerts always pass; the rest go to a digest.

AUTONOMY LEDGER

Breakdowns 2 and 4. Each goal shows its level and limits. Every action is logged and can be undone within 48 hours.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · AGENT EXPERIENCE

The workflow: from insight to a reasoned decision

Each step names the concept behind it. Nothing runs without approval.

1 · INSIGHT

Shows its source, date, and data. No confidence percentage.

2 · CONDITION

The user sets what would change the view (Scenario Sandbox).

3 · PROPOSED STEPS

The agent drafts steps; the user edits each one (Plan Editor).

4 · APPROVE WITHIN LIMITS

The user approves. Act is opt-in, with limits beside it (Autonomy Ledger).

5 · REASON, RE-CHECKED

The user writes why they acted. Guard re-checks it later (Decision Journal).

Each step shows its source. Changes can be reversed within 48 hours. The AI proposes; the user decides.

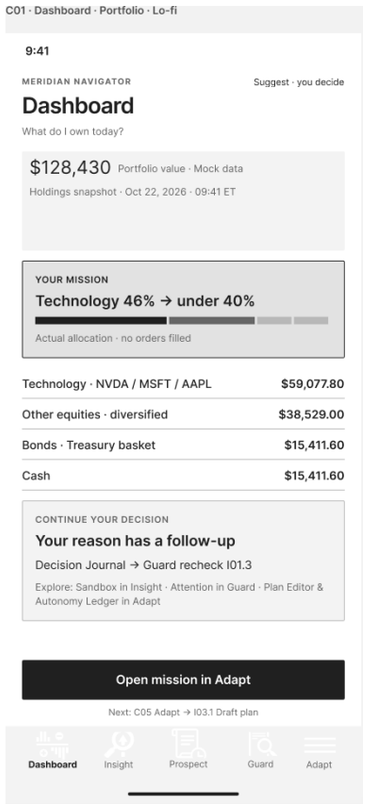
The AI advancements, from breakdown to test

Each row links a breakdown to the concept that answers it, the workflow step where it shows, and what is drawn today.

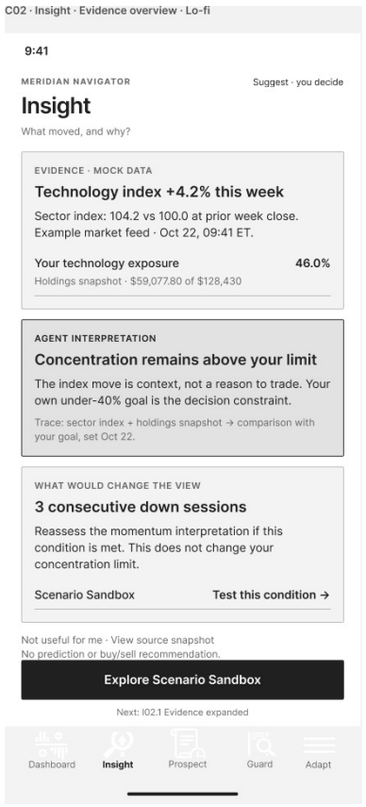
THE BREAKDOWN	THE ADVANCEMENT	WHERE IT SHOWS IN THE WORKFLOW	STATUS
1 · Outputs without reasoning	Scenario Sandbox	Steps 1 and 2: source on each insight; the condition the user sets	Insight with source drawn; sandbox not drawn
2 · All or nothing	Plan Editor and Autonomy Ledger	Steps 3 and 4: each proposed step is editable; Act is opt-in	Adapt plan drawn; ledger not drawn
3 · No learning loop	Decision Journal and Attention Budget	Step 5: the reason is kept and re-checked	Not drawn
4 · Advice line in conflict	Proposed-step wording and the Autonomy Ledger limits	Steps 3 and 4: wording and limits on every screen	Wording fix on the board; compliance review open
5 · Context lost between screens	Decision Journal	Step 5: the reason travels with the order	Full experience drawn; reason field not drawn

Lo-fi screens: the five AI screens, first pass

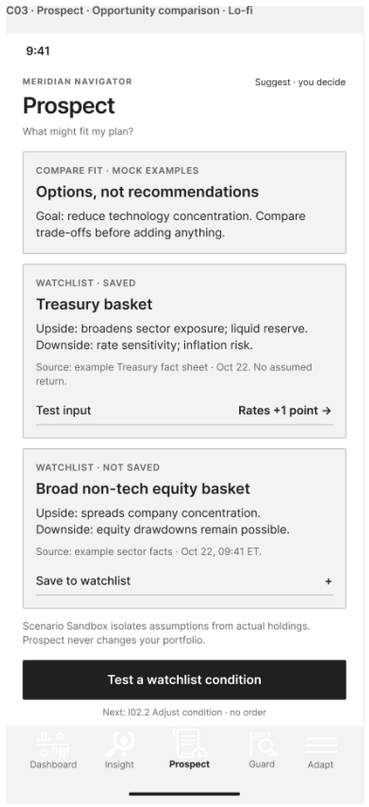
Dashboard, Insight, Prospect, Guard, and Adapt. Structure first; no visual decisions yet.



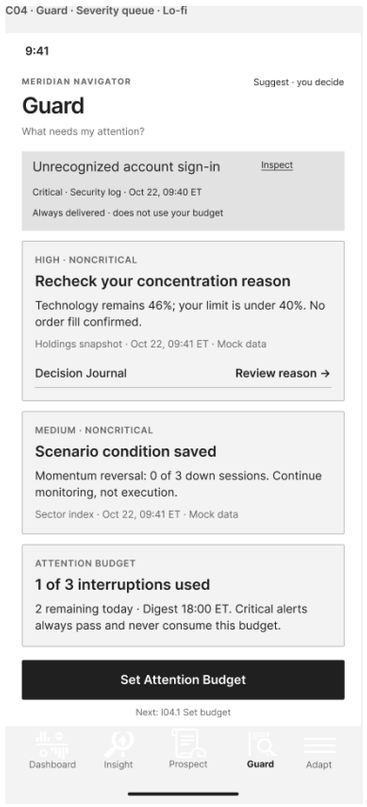
DASHBOARD



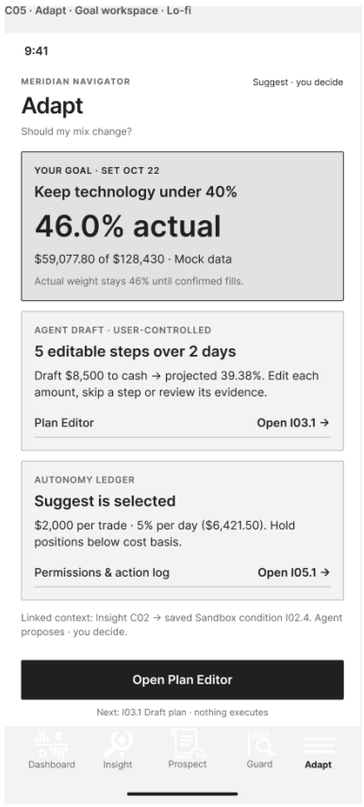
INSIGHT



PROSPECT



GUARD



ADAPT

THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

Five AI screens could drift apart if each were styled alone. The structure had to agree first.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

Light, sketch-level screens for each one. Evidence and approval points are visible before any visual decision.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

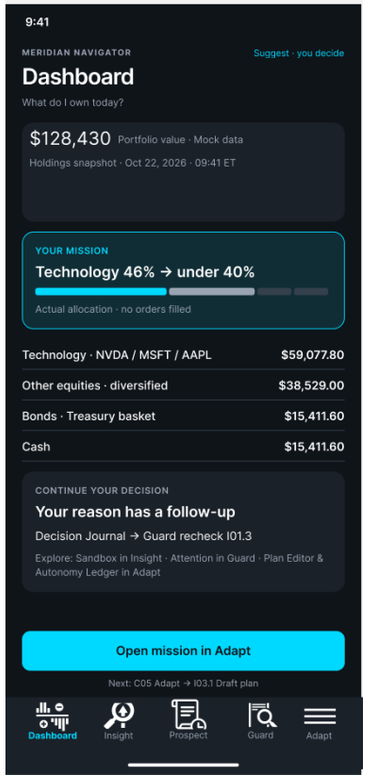
I set the screen structure first, so the five screens shared one logic before the styling.

Portfolio prototype. Mock data. Hypotheses until validated. Proposed-step language only.

Hi-fi screens: the same five, in the design system

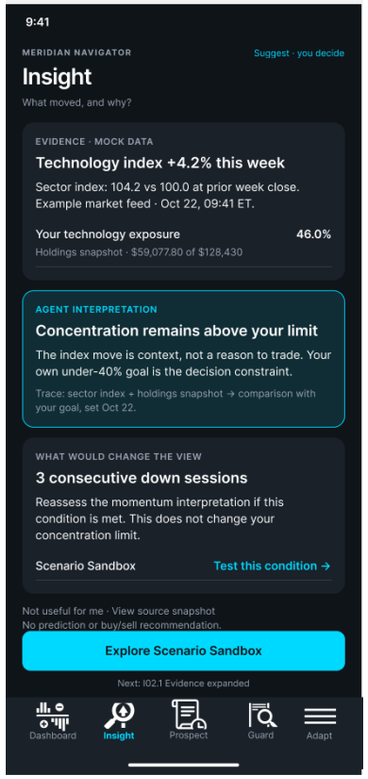
The same screens with design-system tokens: dark surfaces, the action colour, icon-and-word status.

C01 · Dashboard · Portfolio · Hi-fi



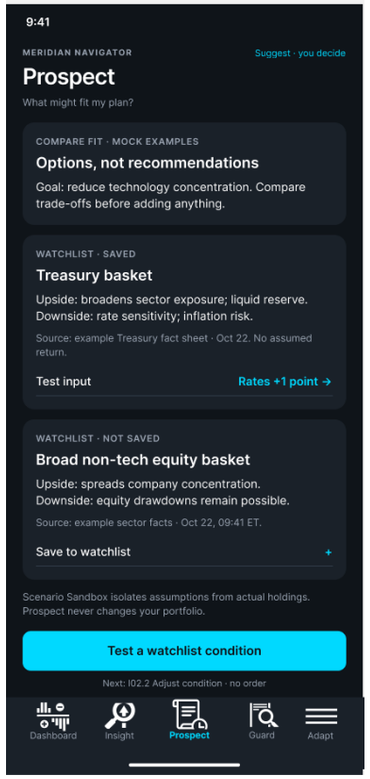
DASHBOARD

C02 · Insight · Evidence overview · Hi-fi



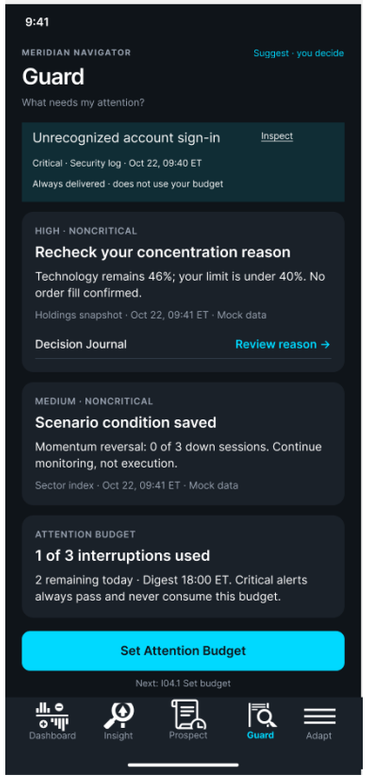
INSIGHT

C03 · Prospect · Opportunity comparison · Hi-fi



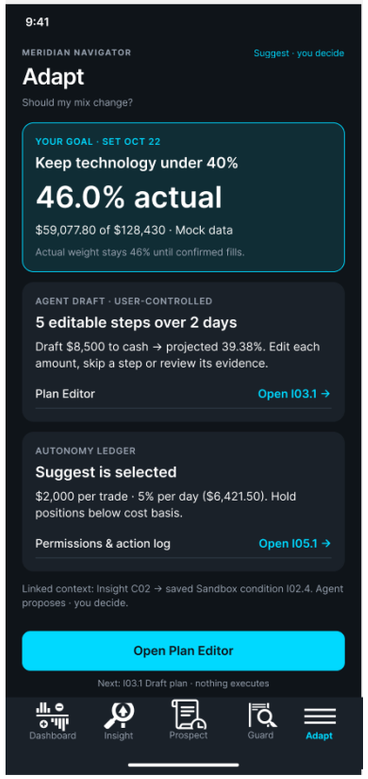
PROSPECT

C04 · Guard · Severity queue · Hi-fi



GUARD

C05 · Adapt · Goal workspace · Hi-fi



ADAPT

THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

Structure that works in light sketches still has to read at speed: contrast, density, and status.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

The same five screens in the design system, with proposed-step wording and a source on every insight.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

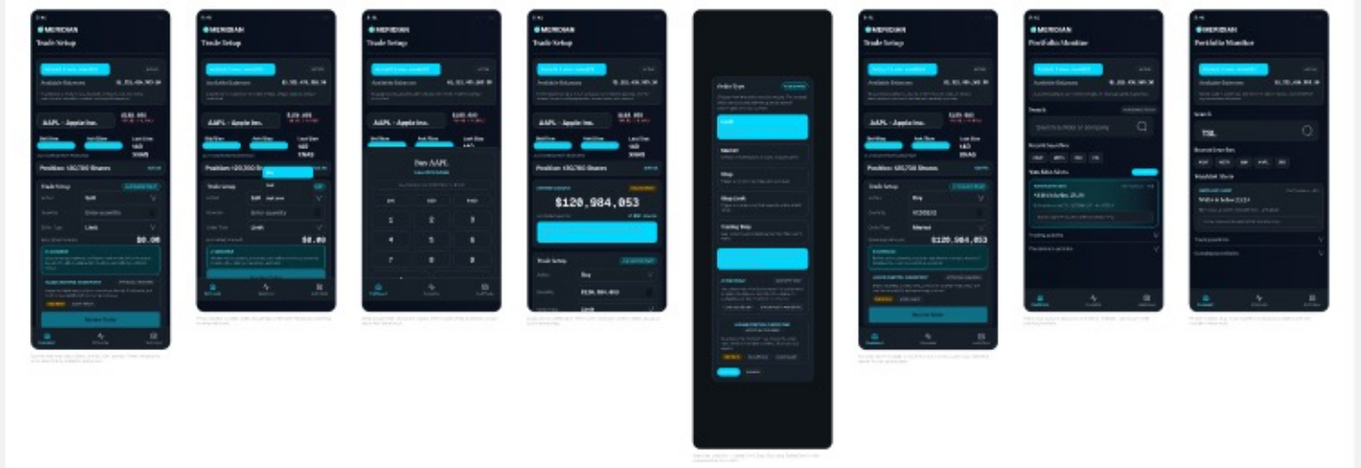
Each hi-fi screen is checked against the design rules, so the advice line and the sources hold on screen.

Portfolio prototype. Mock data. Hypotheses until validated. Proposed-step language only.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · AGENT EXPERIENCE

Agentic support, inside the trade flow

Representative hi-fi screens. The agent proposes; the user approves each step.



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

An agent that acts inside a trade flow needs visible limits and approval on every step, or it cannot be trusted.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

Proposed steps sit beside the order, each with its source. Approval, undo, and limits are on the screen, not in a later release.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I designed agentic support as part of the trade flow itself, so the same pattern can extend to every new AI surface.

Portfolio prototype. Mock data. Hypotheses until validated. Proposed-step language only.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · AGENT EXPERIENCE

Concept board: five innovations, one loop

Each card names the breakdown it answers. Concepts for testing; proposals, not built.

Decision Journal

BREAKDOWNS 3 AND 5

Writes the reason; Guard re-checks it

Scenario Sandbox

BREAKDOWNS 1 AND 4

Shows what would change a view

Plan Editor

BREAKDOWN 2

Edits each proposed step

Attention Budget

BREAKDOWN 3

Sets a daily alert budget

Autonomy Ledger

BREAKDOWNS 2 AND 4

Levels, limits, and a 48-hour undo

The loop: insight → condition → proposed steps → approval within limits → reason, re-checked → back to insight.

Portfolio prototype. Mock data. Hypotheses until validated. Proposed-step language only.

Agentic support scales in three levels, each with limits

The user sets the level for each goal. Act is off by default.

Observe

The agent watches and reports. Nothing is proposed.

Suggest

The agent proposes steps with sources. The user decides each one.

Act within limits

The agent acts inside limits the user set. Every action is logged and can be undone within 48 hours.

GUARDRAILS

Critical alerts always pass.

The advice line holds: proposed-step wording only.

Limits belong to the user, not the model.

WHY IT SCALES

The same three levels apply to every goal and every new agent surface.

How agentic support scales across the product

One token source, one component registry, and one set of AI rules, shared by every surface.

Tokens

One source for colour, type, and spacing, shared by Figma and Swift.

→

Components

Existing, Extended, or New. New components go through review first.

→

Screens

Five screens, each with empty, loading, error, and offline states.

→

Agent surfaces

Any new AI feature reuses the same levels, limits, and proposed-step wording.

THE AGENTIC STORY

AI features are built from these parts, not one-off screens. Each new agent surface reuses the rules, so the product scales without losing the user's control.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I designed the system that lets agentic support be built at scale, and I wrote its rules before the screens.

Portfolio prototype. Mock data. Hypotheses until validated. Proposed-step language only.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · ADAPT

Adapt as a plan, not a batch

Set a goal, review the plan, then approve each step. Nothing runs without approval.

SET A GOAL

The user states a target. The agent drafts a plan.

PLAN PREVIEW

Each proposed step shows its effect on the allocation.

STEP REVIEW

Each step shows its reason and source. The user approves, edits, or skips it.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · METHODOLOGY

How the AI behaves, and how we will test it

AI BEHAVIOR · DESIGNED, MOCK DATA

Insight: sentiment summaries, with the screen as the source.

Prospect: opportunity cards with upside and downside.

Guard: alerts ranked by severity; mark as read.

Adapt: before and after allocation, and a reviewable list of proposed steps.

VALIDATION · PLANNED

Five-person think-aloud on the share and dollar flows.

Comprehension check on the labels for Insight, Prospect, Guard, and Adapt.

Card sort on the five tabs.

Compliance review of trade and AI copy.

What we would measure (planned, not run)

Hypotheses to test before any claim about the agent. None of these has data yet.

MEASURE	QUESTION IT ANSWERS
Time from insight to decision	Does evidence on the card shorten the decision?
Edit and reject rate on proposed steps	Do users trust the plan enough to approve it as drafted?
Reversal rate of agent actions	Does acting within limits create regret, or stay trusted?
Learned rules kept or reversed	Do users value the learning loop, or switch it off?

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · IMPLEMENTATION

Built on SwiftUI, with tokens shared with Figma

WHAT IS BUILT

MVVM: one ViewModel per screen.

MockAPIService with realistic data and a delay.

DesignTokens.swift: colors, type, and spacing.

AuthManager: Face ID and Touch ID, with Keychain storage.

Figma library mirrors the same tokens.

NEXT TO BUILD · PROPOSED

Real market data and quotes behind the mock service.

Brokerage connection for order placement.

Session and authentication with a real backend.

Audit log for trade and AI actions.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · RESULTS

What exists today, and what we still need to measure

5

core iOS screens, each with a ViewModel

8

steps in each trade flow, share and dollar

3

interactive prototypes published, plus this case study

3

wireframe pages: states, agent, and full experience

OUTCOMES · NOT YET MEASURED

Time to complete a trade, task success, the share of users who open an AI screen in week one, and a usability score. Targets are planned and will be set with stakeholders before the first test.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · LEARNINGS AND NEXT STEPS

What building this taught me, and what comes next

LEARNINGS

One token source for Figma and Swift keeps the two in step.

Settle AI boundaries before more screens. Proposed-step wording needs compliance review first.

Mock data hides timing and error states, so design them explicitly.

Keep working documents in one place: the FigJam board.

NEXT STEPS

Validate the three personas with five to eight interviews.

Usability-test the share and dollar flows.

Review the three wireframe pages with stakeholders.

Resolve the open questions on the FigJam board.

Set metric targets with stakeholders.

Complete compliance review before the screens go further.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · PROTOTYPE

Click through the flows yourself

WHAT TO CLICK

Start at the Dashboard. Open Insight, then start a share trade and follow it through to the outcome.

Then open Adapt and set a goal. Each proposed step can be edited before approval.

WHERE IT LIVES

Figma wireframes, pages 06, 07, and 08: states, agent flows, and the full experience.

Working documents: the FigJam board.

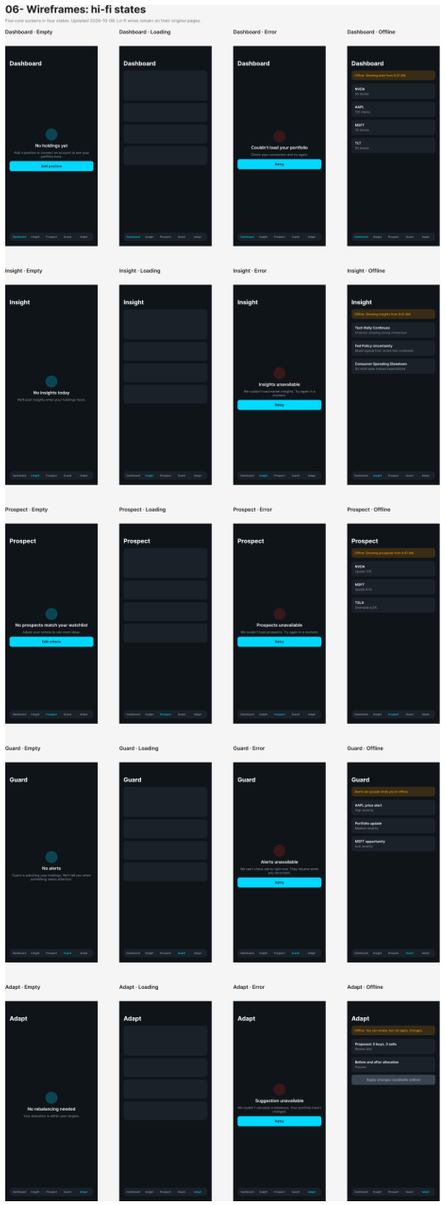
MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · DATA

Designed for mock data, and labelled as mock everywhere

No live data is connected. Every value is labelled.

DATA	USED FOR	SOURCE IN THIS PROTOTYPE
Quotes and holdings	Dashboard, trade ticket	Mock service, with a 0.8-second delay
Insight summaries	Sentiment and the source line	Mock content with a dated source line
Opportunities	Prospect cards with upside and downside	Mock cards
Alerts	Guard ranking and severity	Mock alerts
Trade submission	Outcome screen	Mock order result

Every state designed before the screens



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

Mock data shows only the happy path. A user who meets an empty or failed screen with no guidance stops trusting the app.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

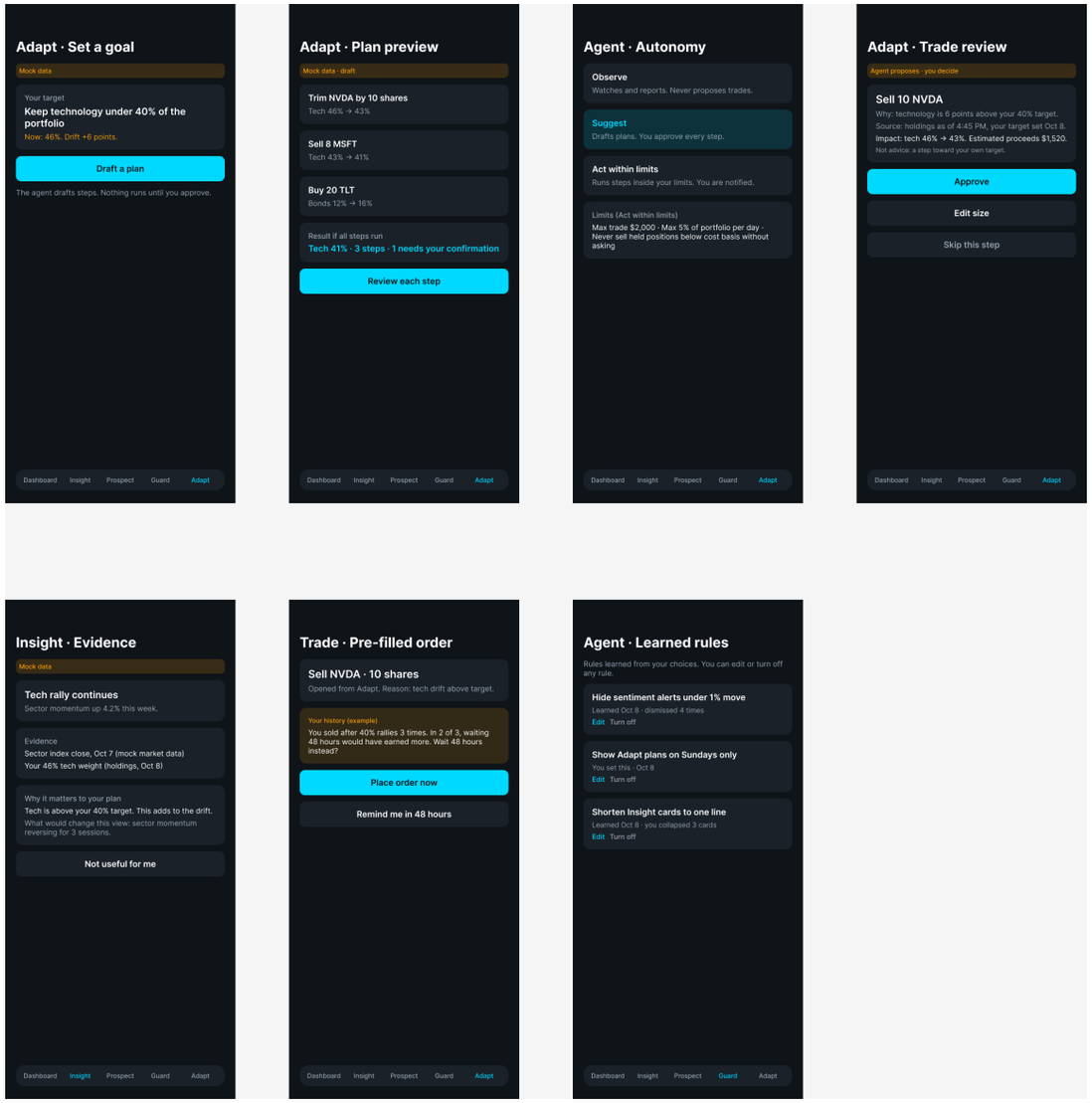
Every screen designs five states before the build: empty, loading, error, offline, and the reviewed path. This is design-system rule 10.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I set the states as the review standard, and reviewers judged the hard cases, not only the happy path.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · WIREFRAMES

The agent, drawn as bounded steps



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

All or nothing (breakdown 2). An agent that acts whole or not at all forces the user to trust it blindly or reject it.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

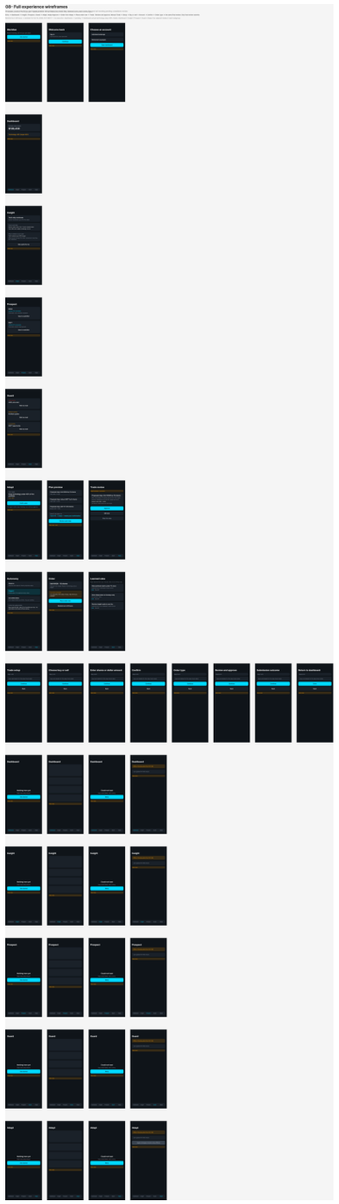
Adapt shows a goal, a plan preview, and step review. Each step is a proposed step with its source and its undo. Nothing runs without approval. This is the Plan Editor concept, drawn.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I drew the AI rules onto the screens before the prototype, so reviewers tested the rules in place, not in a document.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · WIREFRAMES

The whole experience, end to end



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

Context lost between screens (breakdown 5). Approval, undo, and the learning loop each sit on a different screen, so no one sees the whole decision.

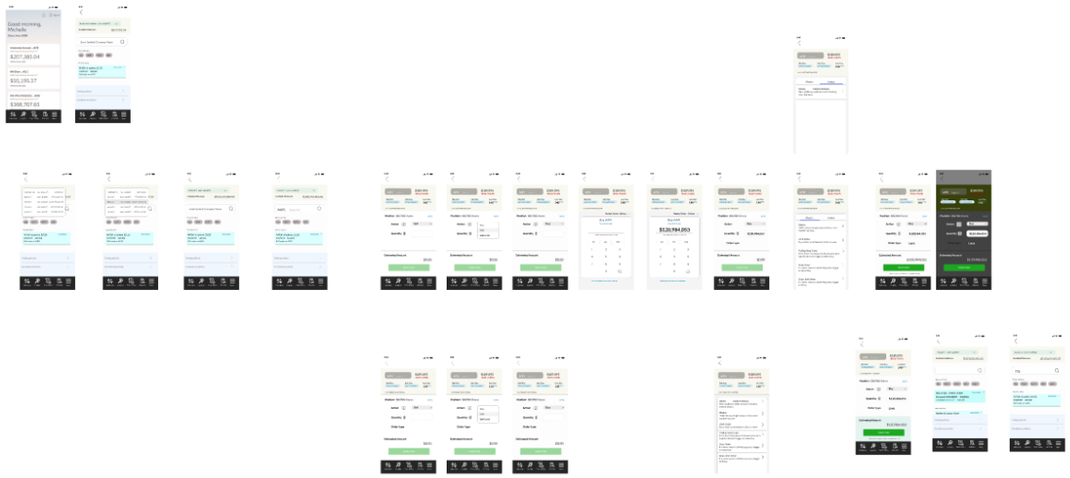
THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

One set of frames: entry, the five tabs, Adapt, the trade flow, the learning loop, and the states. Each trade-off is visible where the decision is made.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I designed the whole experience, not separate screens, and checked that the parts agree. Reviewers see one story.

Lo-fi first: the trade flow before the look



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

The trade flow had to hold together first: steps, choices, and where approval sits. Light, sketch-level screens tested that structure.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

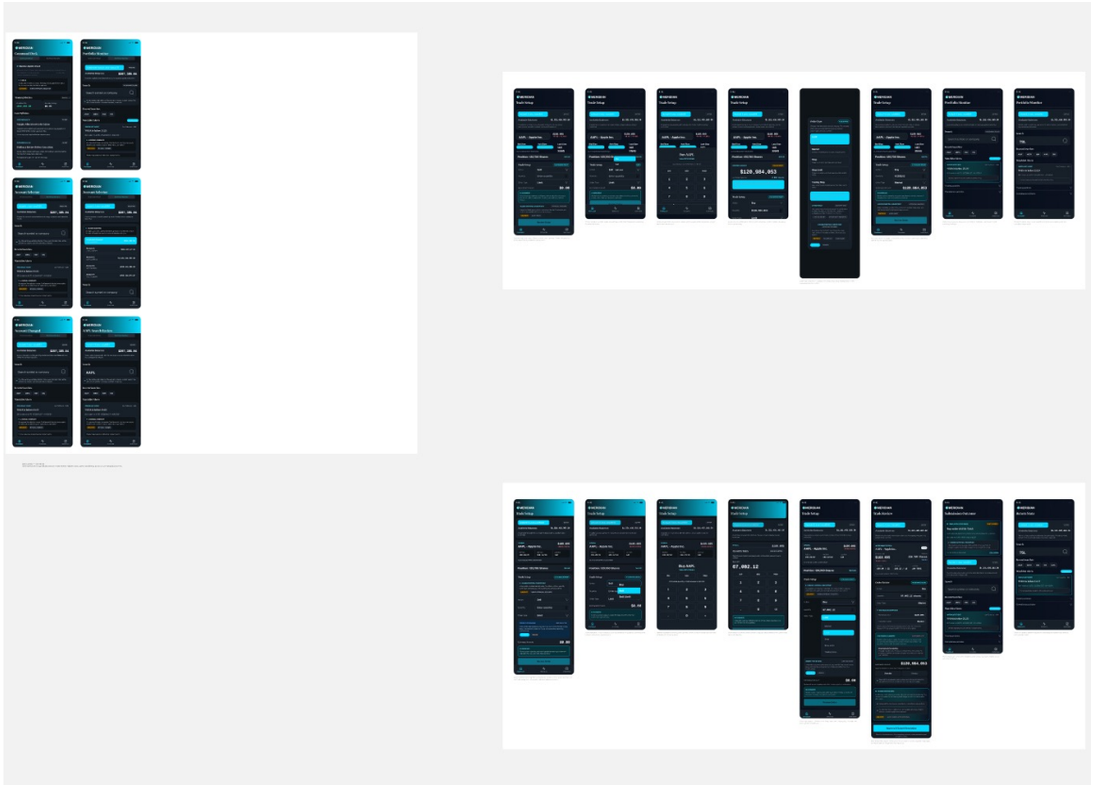
No colour or type decisions yet. Home, order entry, and review were shown with the approval point visible on each step.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I settled the structure before the styling, so the team reviewed the flow itself, not the look.

Portfolio prototype. Mock data. Hypotheses until validated. Proposed-step language only.

Hi-fi: the same flow in the design system



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

A structure that works on paper can still fail on screen: contrast, density, and the advice wording all need checking.

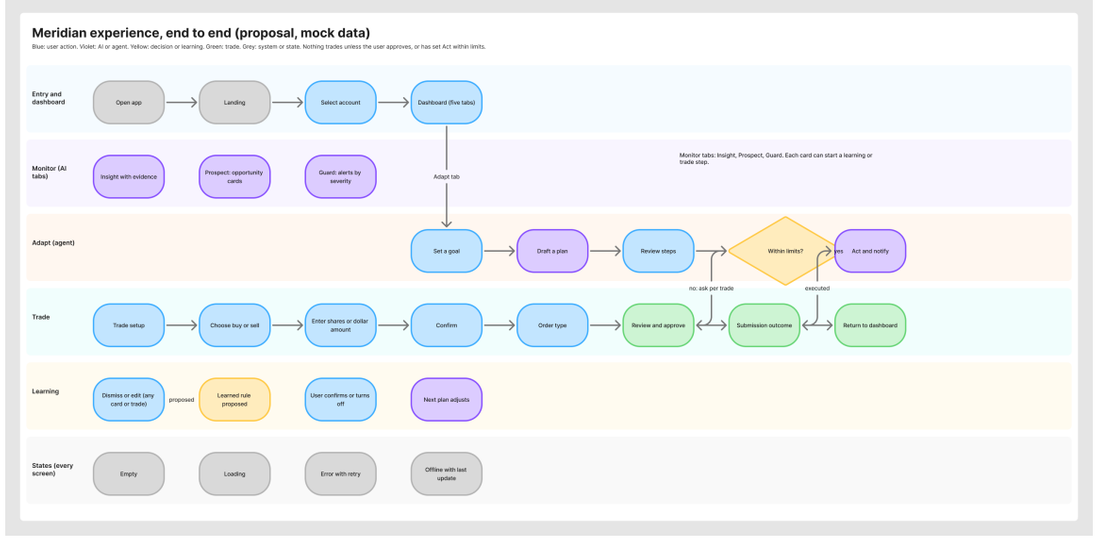
THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

The same flows in the design system: dark surfaces, the action colour, icon-and-word status, and proposed-step wording.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

Every hi-fi screen was checked against the design rules, so each one shows its source and status.

One FigJam board as the working record



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

No learning loop (breakdown 3). Decisions and their reasons disappear into chat and slides, so the agent cannot learn from them.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

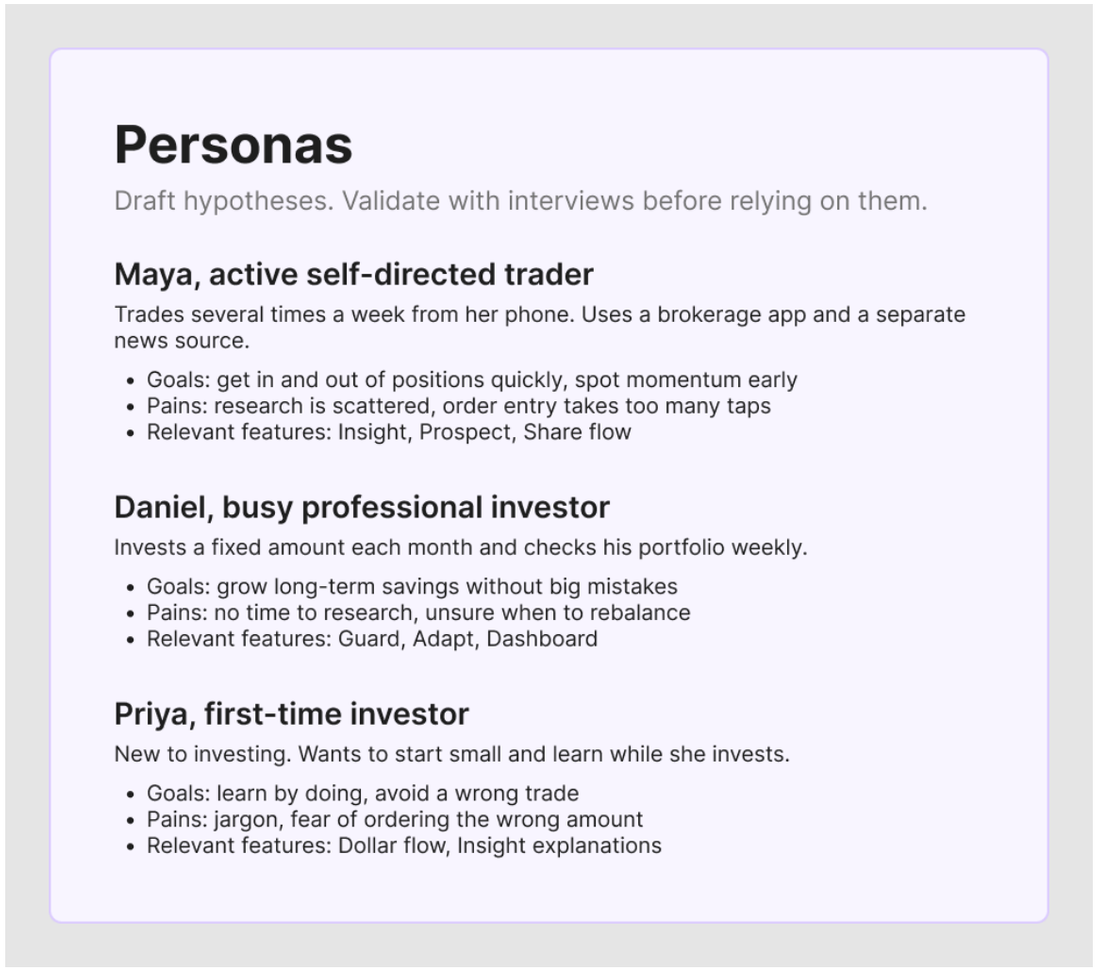
Decisions, reasons, and open questions live on one board, each linked to the breakdown it answers. This is the record the Decision Journal concept builds on.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I ran the design in the open, so the team could challenge each call and its trade-off. The record shows who decided what.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · WORKING DOCUMENTS

Personas, drafted to be validated



Personas

Draft hypotheses. Validate with interviews before relying on them.

Maya, active self-directed trader

Trades several times a week from her phone. Uses a brokerage app and a separate news source.

- Goals: get in and out of positions quickly, spot momentum early
- Pains: research is scattered, order entry takes too many taps
- Relevant features: Insight, Prospect, Share flow

Daniel, busy professional investor

Invests a fixed amount each month and checks his portfolio weekly.

- Goals: grow long-term savings without big mistakes
- Pains: no time to research, unsure when to rebalance
- Relevant features: Guard, Adapt, Dashboard

Priya, first-time investor

New to investing. Wants to start small and learn while she invests.

- Goals: learn by doing, avoid a wrong trade
- Pains: jargon, fear of ordering the wrong amount
- Relevant features: Dollar flow, Insight explanations

THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

Flows built for users nobody has met. Without evidence, the team designs for its own assumptions.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

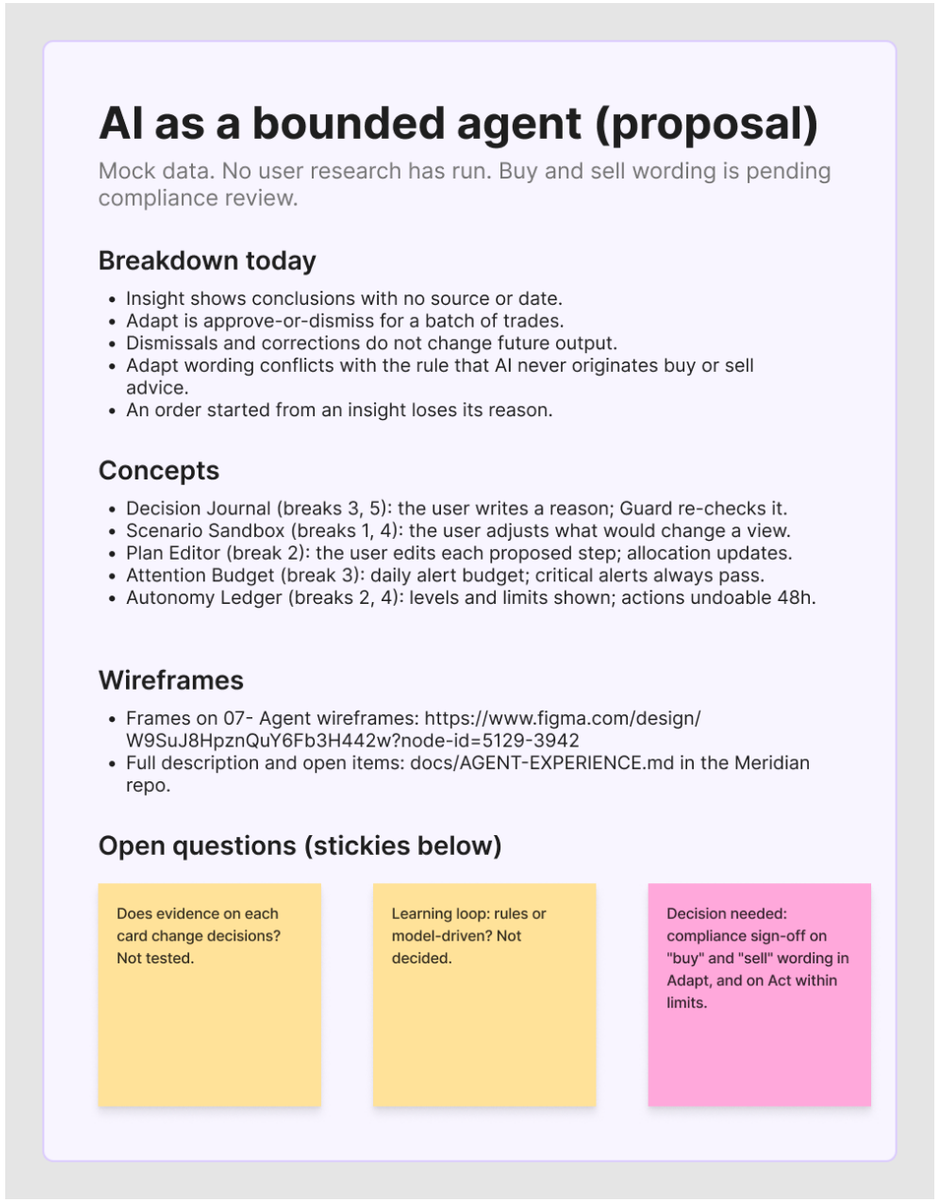
Three draft personas, each labelled untested, with the features they use. They decide which flows get designed first, and stay hypotheses until five to eight interviews confirm them.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I separated what we know from what we assume, and labelled each one, so the next decision rests on evidence, not confidence.

MERIDIAN NAVIGATOR · WORKING DOCUMENTS

The agent experience, reasoned on the board



AI as a bounded agent (proposal)

Mock data. No user research has run. Buy and sell wording is pending compliance review.

Breakdown today

- Insight shows conclusions with no source or date.
- Adapt is approve-or-dismiss for a batch of trades.
- Dismissals and corrections do not change future output.
- Adapt wording conflicts with the rule that AI never originates buy or sell advice.
- An order started from an insight loses its reason.

Concepts

- Decision Journal (breaks 3, 5): the user writes a reason; Guard re-checks it.
- Scenario Sandbox (breaks 1, 4): the user adjusts what would change a view.
- Plan Editor (break 2): the user edits each proposed step; allocation updates.
- Attention Budget (break 3): daily alert budget; critical alerts always pass.
- Autonomy Ledger (breaks 2, 4): levels and limits shown; actions undoable 48h.

Wireframes

- Frames on 07- Agent wireframes: https://www.figma.com/design/W9SuJ8HpznQuY6Fb3H442w?node-id=5129-3942
- Full description and open items: docs/AGENT-EXPERIENCE.md in the Meridian repo.

Open questions (stickies below)

Does evidence on each card change decisions? Not tested.

Learning loop: rules or model-driven? Not decided.

Decision needed: compliance sign-off on "buy" and "sell" wording in Adapt, and on Act within limits.

THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

Advice in conflict (breakdown 4). Agent wording drifts toward buy and sell, and the advice line breaks. Trade wording belongs in compliance review.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

The breakdowns and the concepts sit together. Each concept is traced to the breakdown it answers, and states which side it takes on autonomy against trust.

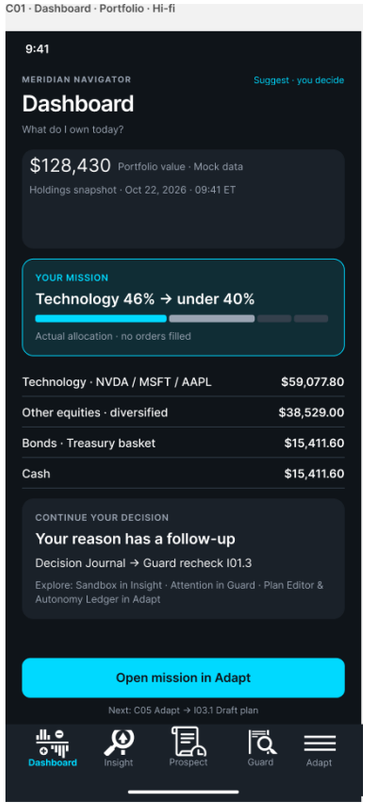
WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

Every design answers a stated problem, so a reviewer can check the reasoning, not only the screen.

The AI flow, screen by screen

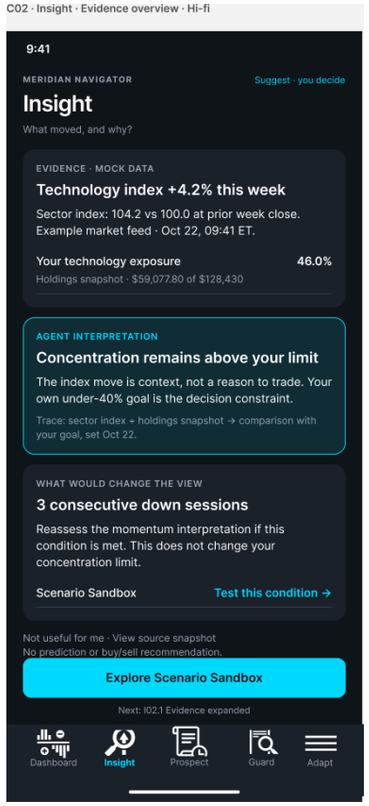
Dashboard leads to Insight, Prospect, Guard, and Adapt. Each step is a choice the user makes.

C01 · Dashboard · Portfolio · Hi-fi



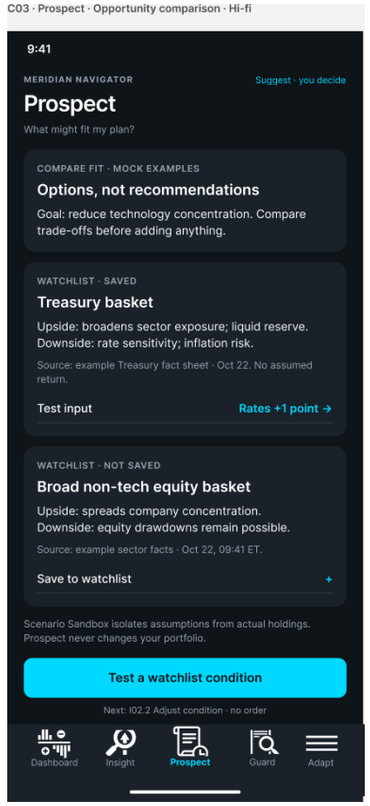
1 · DASHBOARD

C02 · Insight · Evidence overview · Hi-fi



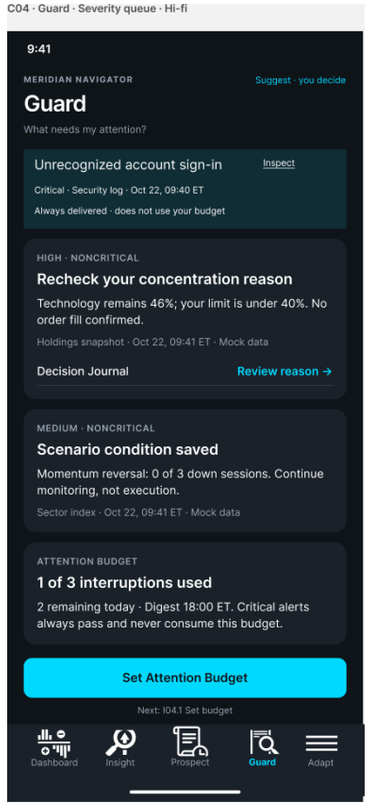
2 · INSIGHT

C03 · Prospect · Opportunity comparison · Hi-fi



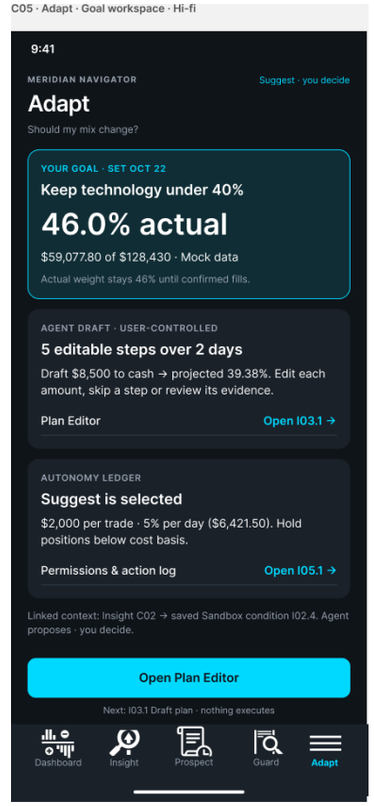
3 · PROSPECT

C04 · Guard · Severity queue · Hi-fi



4 · GUARD

C05 · Adapt · Goal workspace · Hi-fi



5 · ADAPT

THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

The AI flow is one dashboard leading to four steps: Insight, Prospect, Guard, and Adapt. Each step is a choice the user makes.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

Adapt is where the advice rule is most at risk. Its wording must read as proposed steps, not buy or sell advice.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

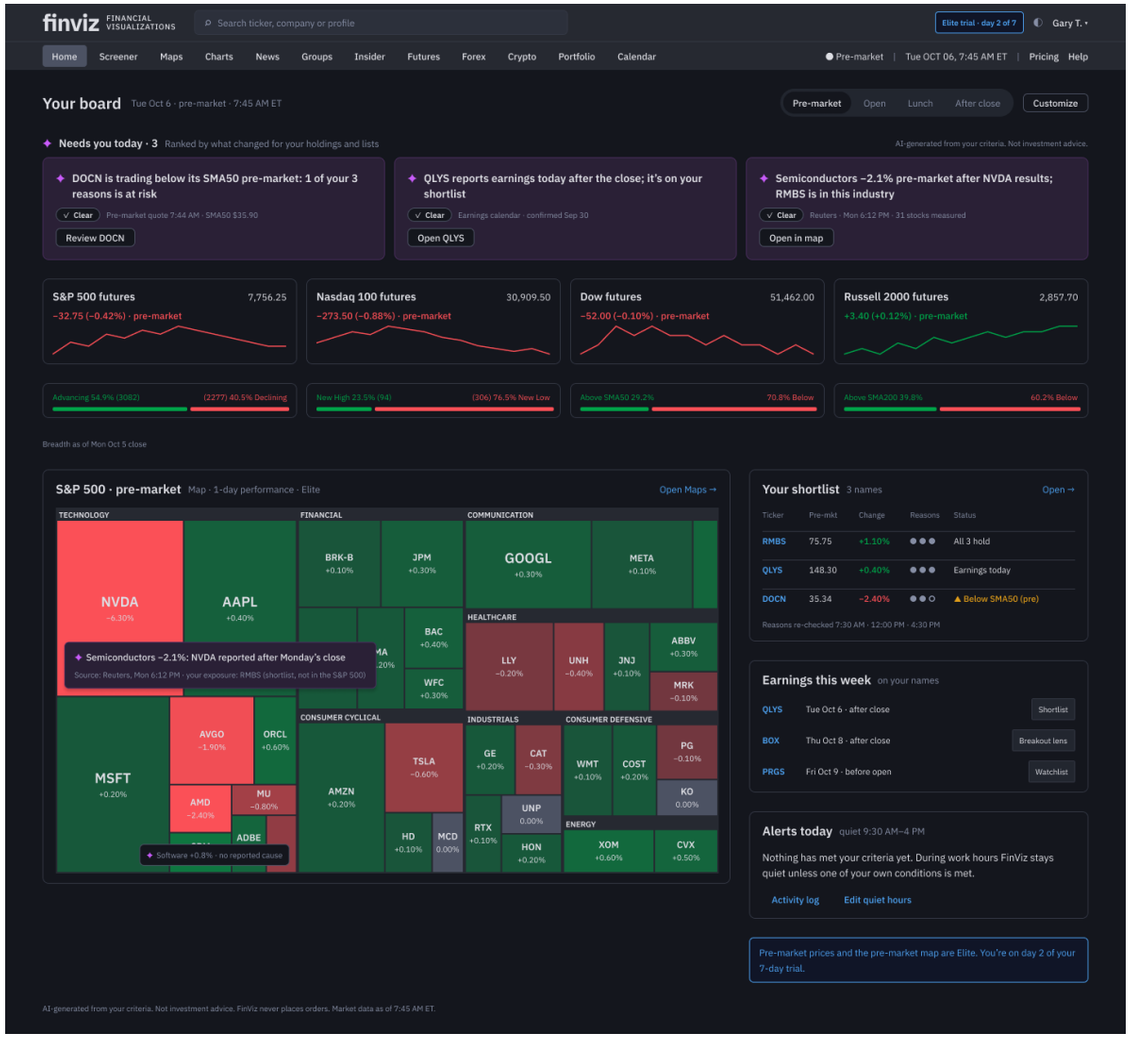
I found agent wording that broke the advice rule and changed it on the board, so the flow and the rule agree.

Portfolio prototype. Mock data. Hypotheses until validated. Proposed-step language only.

End-to-end design process, including Design Thinking and AI-supported methods, for an AI layer on the FinViz stock screener that guides a swing trader through the trading day

FinViz

Helping FinViz cut the time from sign-up to Elite from 42 to 21 days by getting new traders to a screen they trust, then watching it for them



"Alerts are everything. Once you close FinViz, you get nothing."

How this case study is organized

The final experience first, then the reasoning, data and method behind it. Process artifacts are in the appendix.

01
Overview
Hero and contents

02
Context & constraints
Business goal, stakeholders, success, limits

03
Problem: user and AI
What users struggle with; what the AI must do

04
Data foundation
Sources, volume, quality, labels

05
The solution, hi-fi
One trade through one trading day, 19 screens

06
Reasoning & trade-offs
Chosen vs rejected, accuracy vs control

07
Methodology
AI methods, validation, UX research

08
Implementation
Built on FinViz; new services; collaboration

09
Results & impact
Targets and how they'll be measured

10
Learnings & Next Steps
What I learned; what to validate before launch

The brief, and how we answer it

WEEK 1

Domain, needs, pains, AI Solution Canvas

→ Context file, personas, 27 pains scored, KPI tree, canvas

WEEK 2

Onboarding or filters: first success faster

→ First Steps + Filtering → The Trading Day · On Watch (OW1–OW7) → hi-fi flow

WEEK 3

Alerts & notifications: input, output, refinement

→ Canvas v2, three journeys, 18 ideas, AN7–AN8

WEEK 4

Charts UX: insights, accuracy, just in time

→ Chart Lens: lenses over a list, reliability layer (CL1–CL4) · Insight Board dashboard (DB1–DB5)

WHERE WE DELIBERATELY DEPART FROM THE BRIEF

Brief: users are mostly expert day traders and multi-portfolio managers.	We center Growth Gary, a swing trader with a day job: the largest new-user group that can't watch the market at work, where alerts sell Elite. Day traders stay the conversion lever.
Brief: users want expert recommendations with probability scores.	No AI-originated probabilities or buy/sell. Attributed analyst views are allowed (pending compliance); history is shown as history, with sample sizes.
Brief: mobile is a goal.	Desktop only for this exploration, as Week 2 asks; FinViz has no native app. Mobile is deferred, not dropped.

Competitive landscape: where FinViz is strong, and where the AI layer fits

Examples from the FinViz research notes, as of September 2026.

Product	Where it is strong	Where the AI layer fits
TradingView	Charting and community. Ships AI chart analysis and document summaries.	Explains the trader's own screen. FinViz stays the fastest place to find ideas.
Trade Ideas	Real-time scanning and alerts at tick speed.	FinViz does not compete on tick speed. Push alerts on a saved screen matter more to this user.
Bloomberg Terminal	Market data and news flow for professionals.	Cost and complexity. FinViz's job is discovery for individual traders.

Source: FinViz research notes. Competitor features change. Re-check before publishing.

The user problem and the AI problem

Defined separately, so the AI only does what a rule can’t.

USER PROBLEM

Gary can find ideas but can’t hold on to them. 89 filters with no explanation; a list that forgets why he picked each stock; nothing reaches him at work; the decision to hold or exit happens in his head (P1, P5, P8, P9, P13).

AI PROBLEM

Infer a screen from 3 example tickers · explain why each row matched from real values · re-check his own reasons against fresh data 3× a day · detect chart patterns at support with measurable criteria · summarize overnight news on his names only, with sources · turn his corrections into proposed rule changes.

WHY AI IS APPROPRIATE

Translating examples and plain English into 89 filters, and summarizing many sources, are language tasks. Scanning 30 charts for the same setup every day is repetitive perception. Remembering his reasons needs memory. Where a rule is enough we used a rule: the since-last-night diff, exit lines, quiet hours and the activity log are not AI.

Pain points, scored by user and business impact

1. Ideas can’t become a working, watched screen
2. Blind during market hours
3. Too many results, and no reason why they matched
4. Which metric matters, and what counts as good?
5. Filters in fixed buckets; exact values are Elite
6. Alert noise
7. Catalysts scattered across pages

“Once you close FinViz you get nothing, and setting up alerts today is quirky.”

Design review feedback, Sept 30

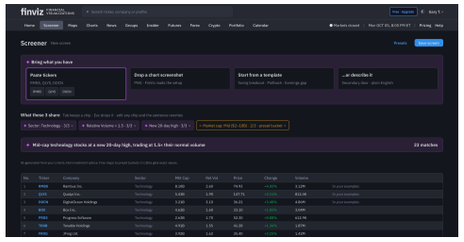
One trade, followed through one trading day

This case study follows **Growth Gary**, a swing trader with a day job, through a single trade. He finds an idea at night, checks it before work, gets one alert while he's busy, and decides after the close whether his reasons still hold. **FinViz does the watching and explaining at the right moment; Gary makes every decision, in his own broker.**

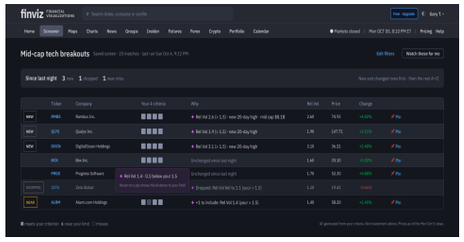
☾ 8–10 PM	☾ while he sleeps	🌅 7:30 AM	🌅 9:30 AM–4 PM	🌅 4:30 PM
1	2	3	4	5
Evening	Overnight	Before work	During work	After the close
Reviews what's new, pins 3–5 names, taps "Watch these for me"	Nothing	Reads one short note	Taps one alert, if it comes	Decides: hold, or exit in his own broker

The whole trading day, in 19 screens

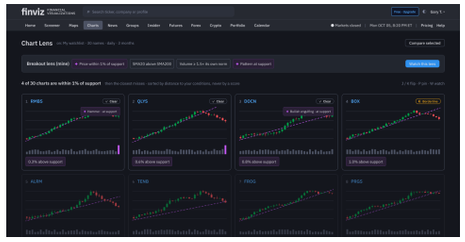
One trade, Monday evening to Sunday. Every screen is designed in hi-fi and linked as a clickable prototype.



01 Show It
Mon 8:05 PM

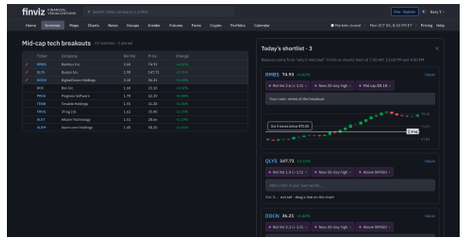


02 Since last night
Mon 8:10 PM

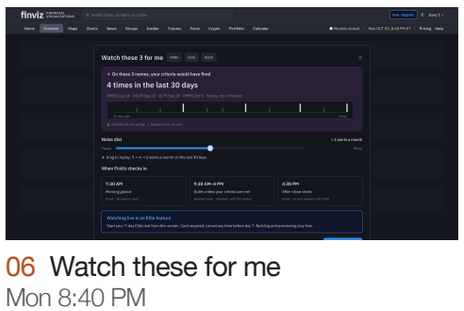


03 Lens grid
Mon 8:20 PM

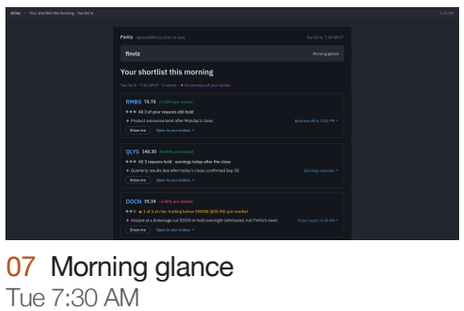
04 Linked compare
Mon 8:26 PM



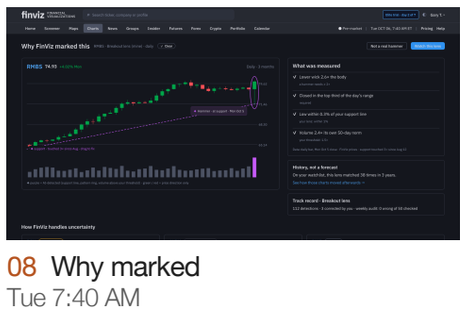
05 Reasons ledger
Mon 8:32 PM



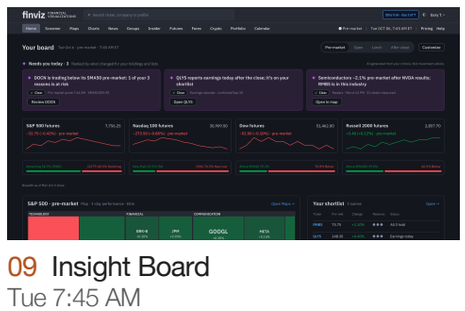
06 Watch these for me
Mon 8:40 PM



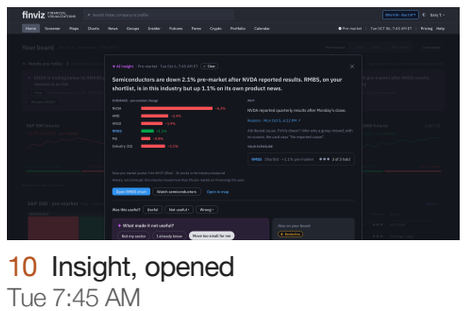
07 Morning glance
Tue 7:30 AM



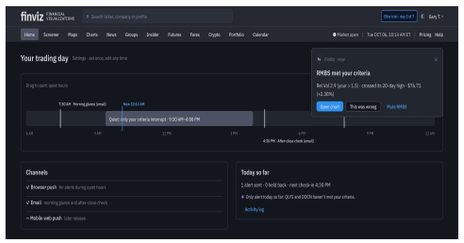
08 Why marked
Tue 7:40 AM



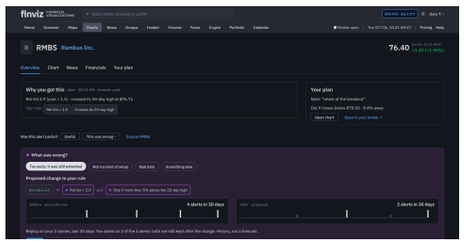
09 Insight Board
Tue 7:45 AM



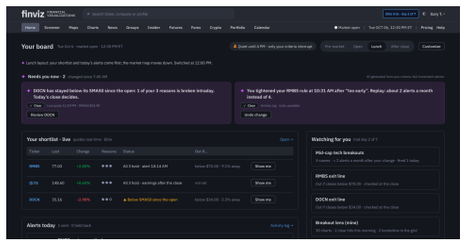
10 Insight, opened
Tue 7:45 AM



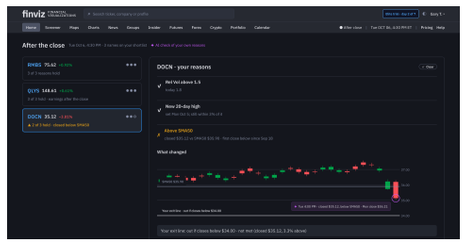
11 Quiet hours, one alert
Tue 10:14 AM



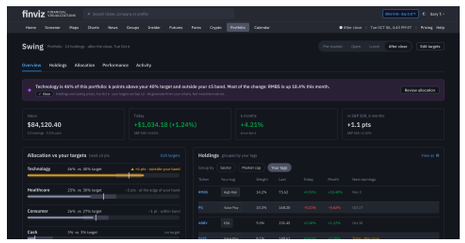
12 This was wrong
Tue 10:31 AM



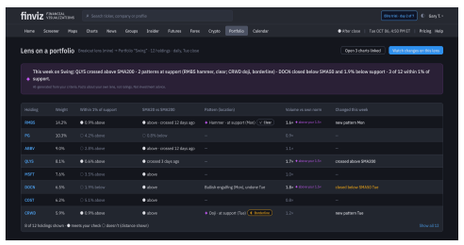
13 Board at lunch
Tue 12:30 PM



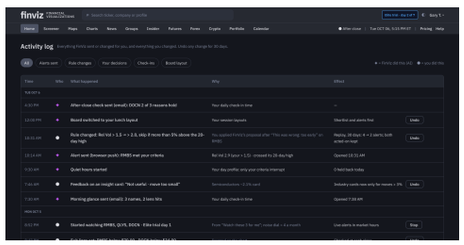
14 Reasons still hold?
Tue 4:30 PM



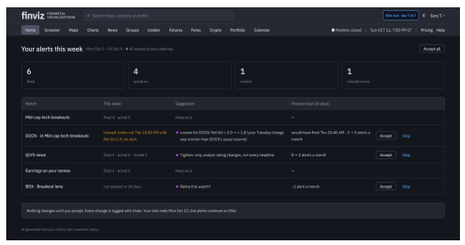
15 Portfolio vs plan
Tue 4:45 PM



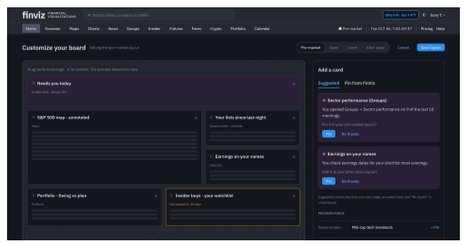
16 Lens on portfolio
Tue 4:50 PM



17 Activity log + Undo
Tue 5:15 PM



18 Weekly review
Sun 7 PM



19 Build the board
Sunday

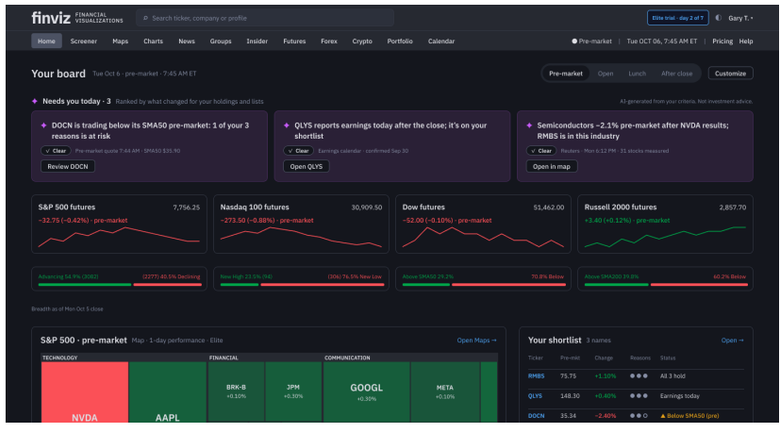
TRY IT

Open the clickable prototype →

Starts at step 1 in Figma

The User Journey: From market noise to a focused next step

Six beats on the Insight Board: Gary's day around work, then Mike, an advisor. The board surfaces what changed; he decides.



1 · Morning DB1 · 7:45 AM

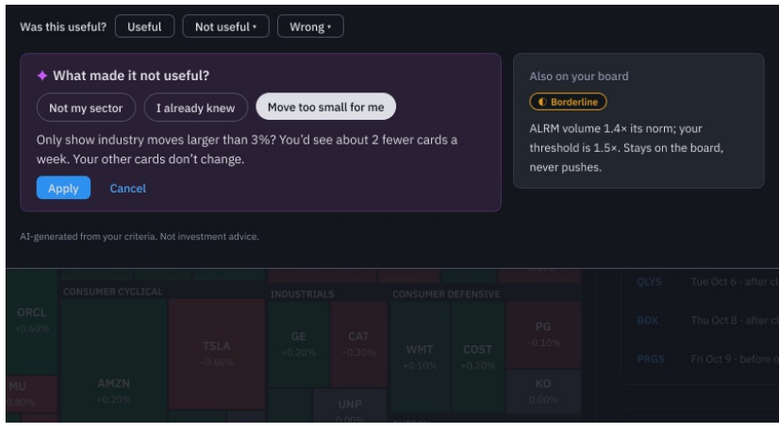
"What needs my attention?"

Three findings about his own names come first: DOCN at risk, QLYS earnings, semis down with RMBS exposed.

2 · Investigating DB2

"Show me the evidence."

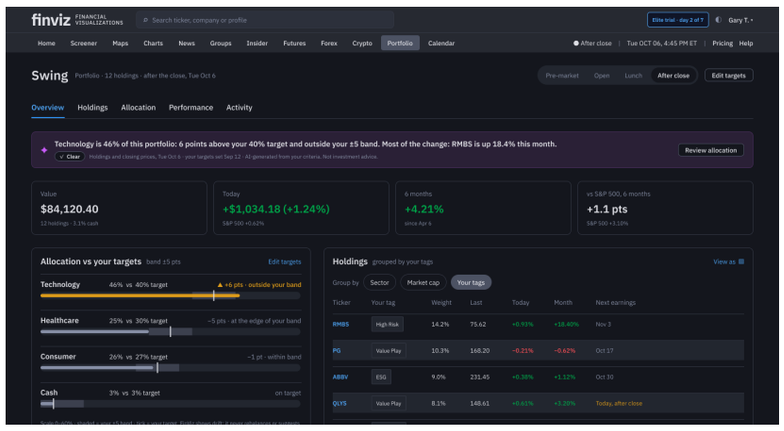
The card shows measured moves, quote time and the Reuters source; RMBS +1.1% on its own news.



3 · Refining DB2 · feedback

"Ask before changing it."

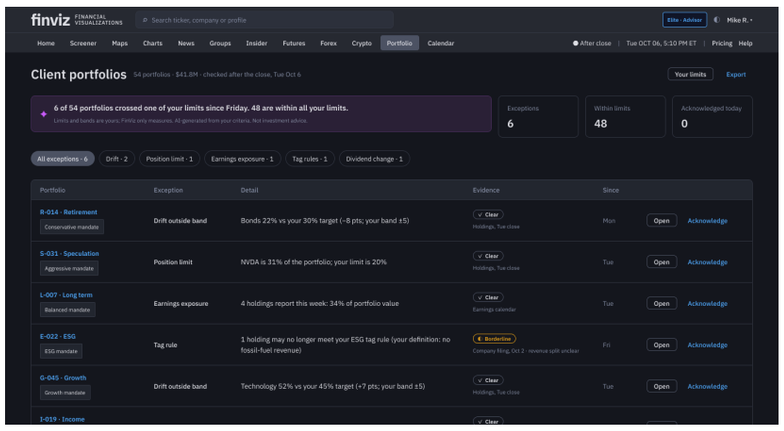
"Move too small for me" → a previewed threshold change he applies or cancels.



4 · After the close DB3 · 4:45 PM

"How do I compare with my plan?"

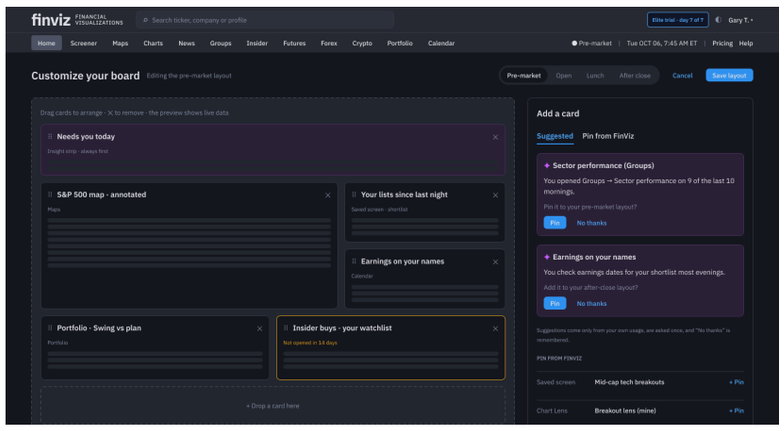
Tech 46% vs his 40% target; the cause is RMBS +18.4%. Explained, never rebalanced.



5 · Advisor DB4 · Mike

"Exceptions, not 54 dashboards."

Mike starts with 6 portfolios that crossed his limits; uncertainty stays visible.



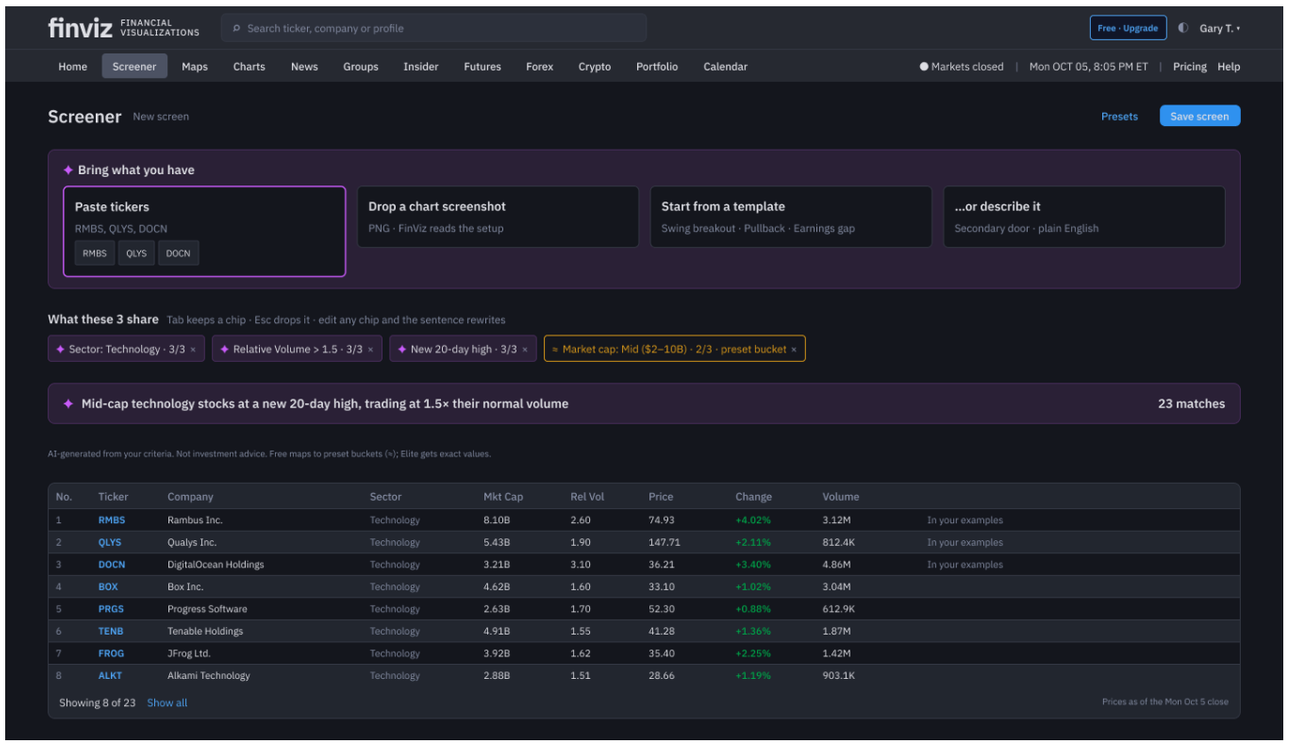
6 · Personalization DB5 · Sunday

"Build the board around my routine."

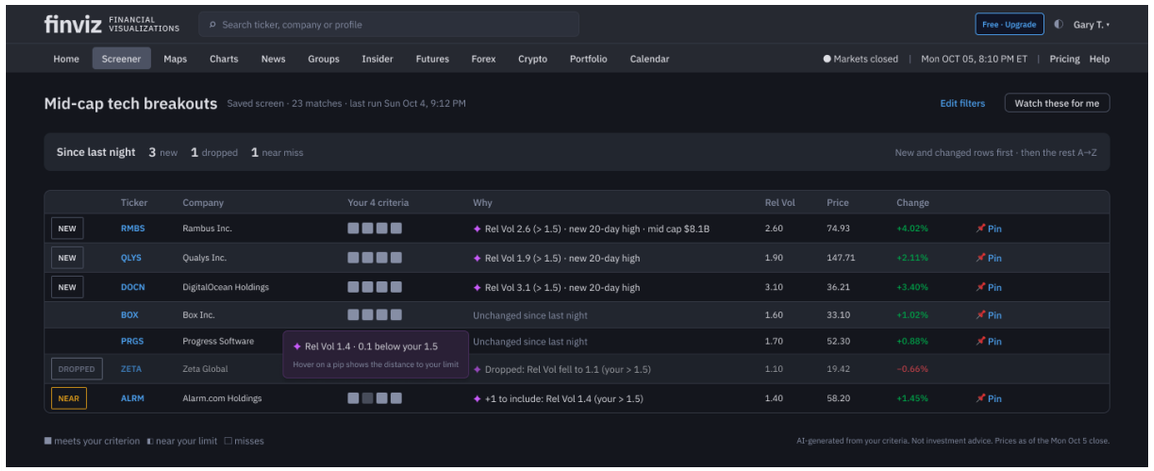
Habit-based suggestions he accepts or declines; every change reversible.

Evening: Turn his idea into a screen he trusts

Mon Oct 5, 8 PM, after Monday's close. Free account.



STEP 1 · OW1 Pastes 3 tickers; AI writes what they share as editable filter chips

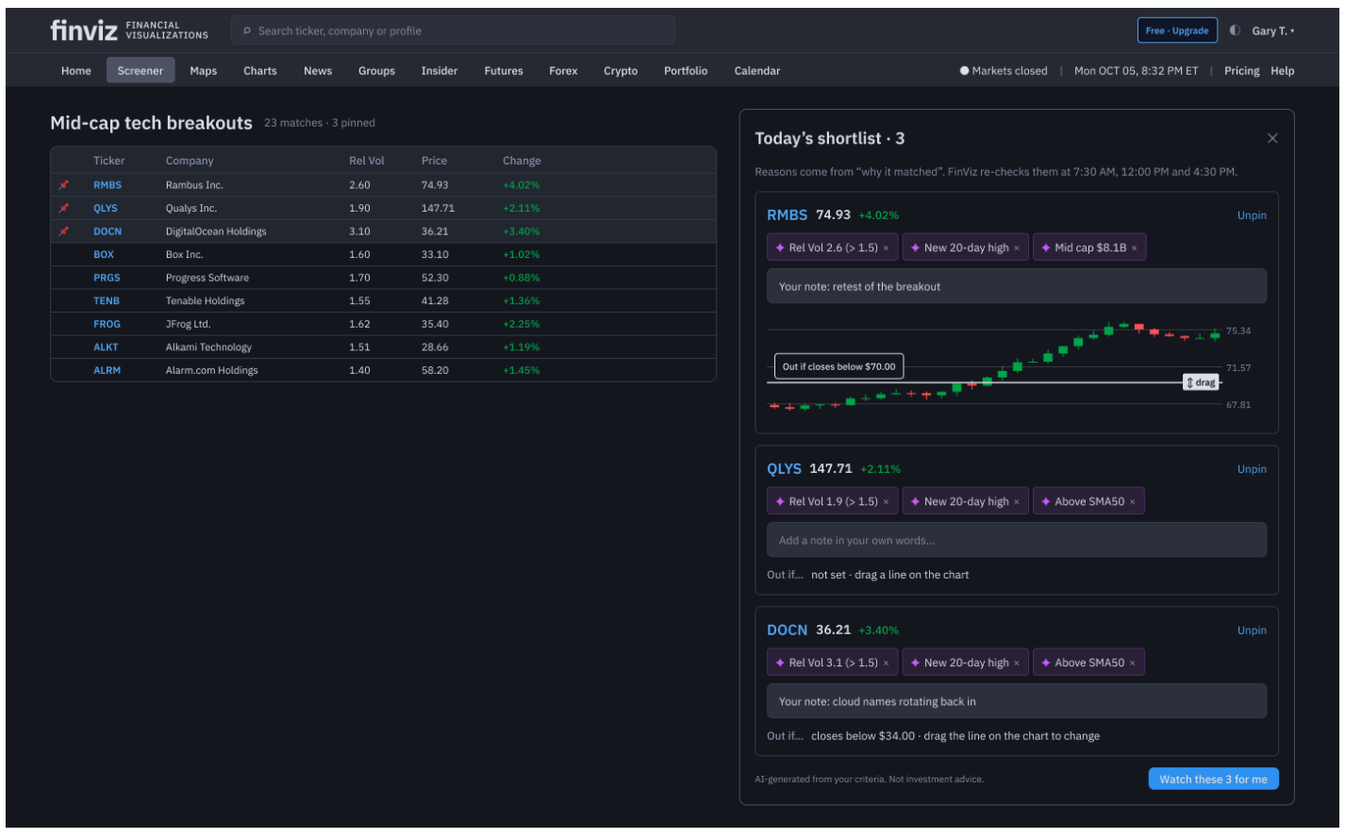


STEP 2 · OW2 New, dropped and near-miss rows first, each with which of his criteria it meets

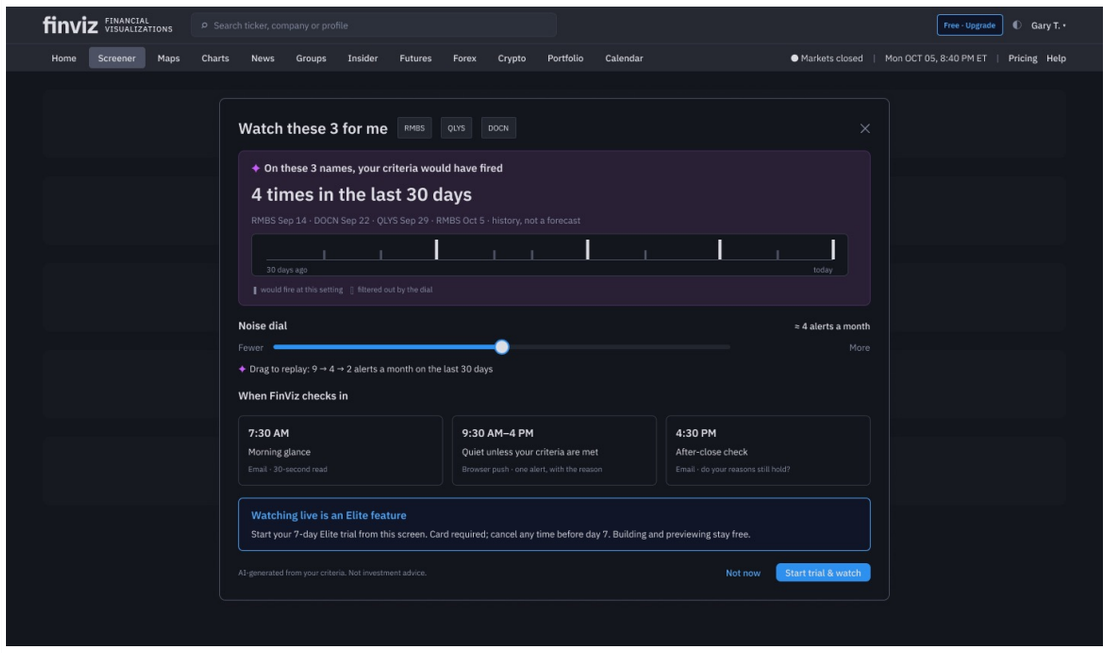
AI BEHAVIOR Programming by example, constrained to FinViz's real filters. Decision point: he keeps or drops each chip (Tab / Esc).

Evening: Remember why, then watch it for me

Mon 8:32–8:52 PM. The one earned Elite moment.



STEP 5 · OW3 Pinned names keep their reasons as checkable conditions; exit lines dragged on the chart

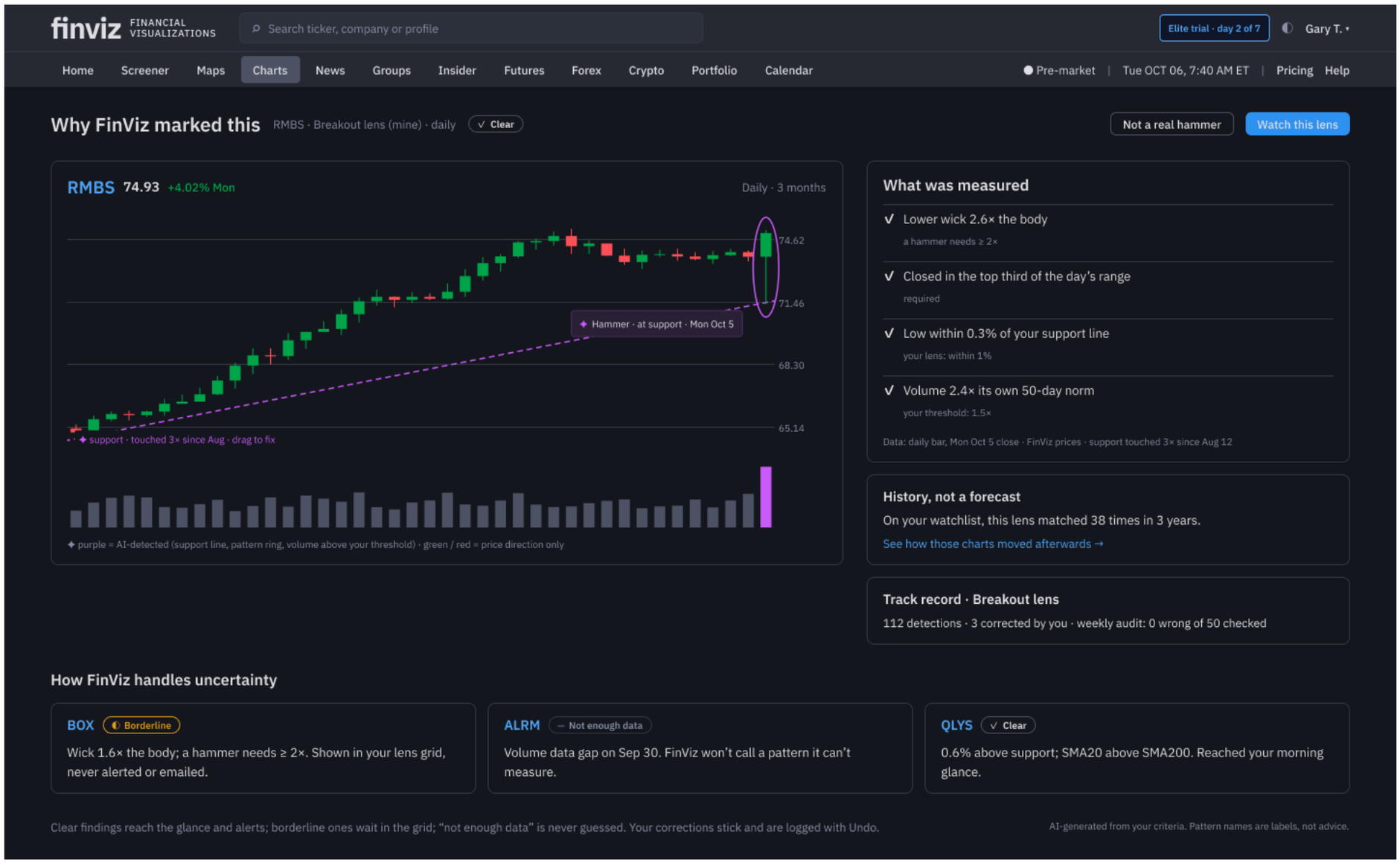


STEP 6 · OW4 Replay: "would have fired 4 times in the last 30 days"; noise dial; 7-day trial starts here

DECISION POINT He commits only after seeing what watching would have done. History, never a forecast.

Close-up · Step 8 · CL4 · Why FinViz marked this

Tue 7:40 AM. Opened from “Why marked?” in the morning glance.



AI BEHAVIOR

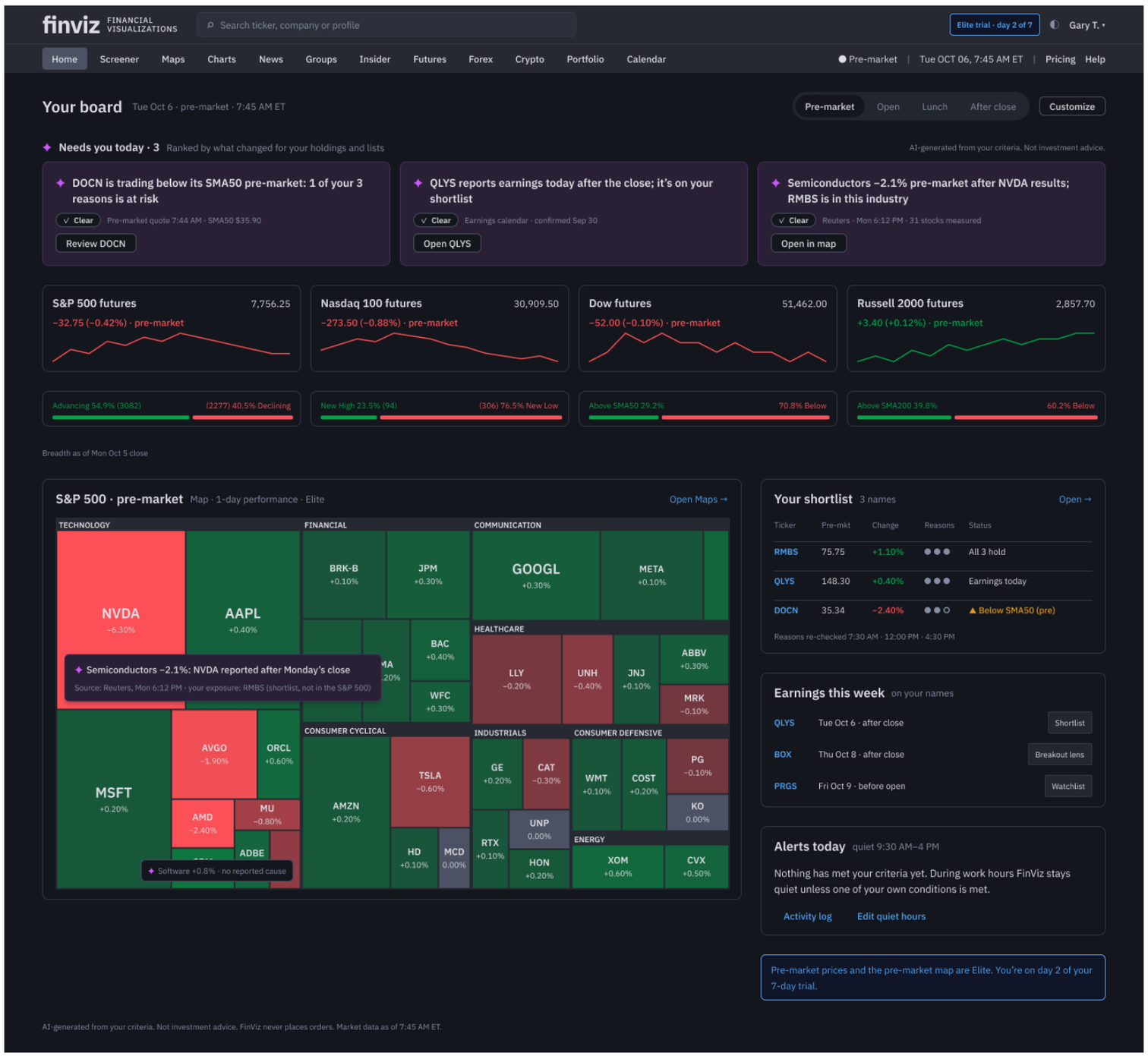
Measurements, not a confidence score: wick 2.6× body, at support, volume 2.4× its norm

Clear, borderline or not enough data; only clear findings reach his inbox

History with its sample size (38 matches in 3 years) and a visible track record

Close-up · Step 9 · DB1 · Insight Board, pre-market

Tue 7:45 AM. FinViz Home, upgraded.

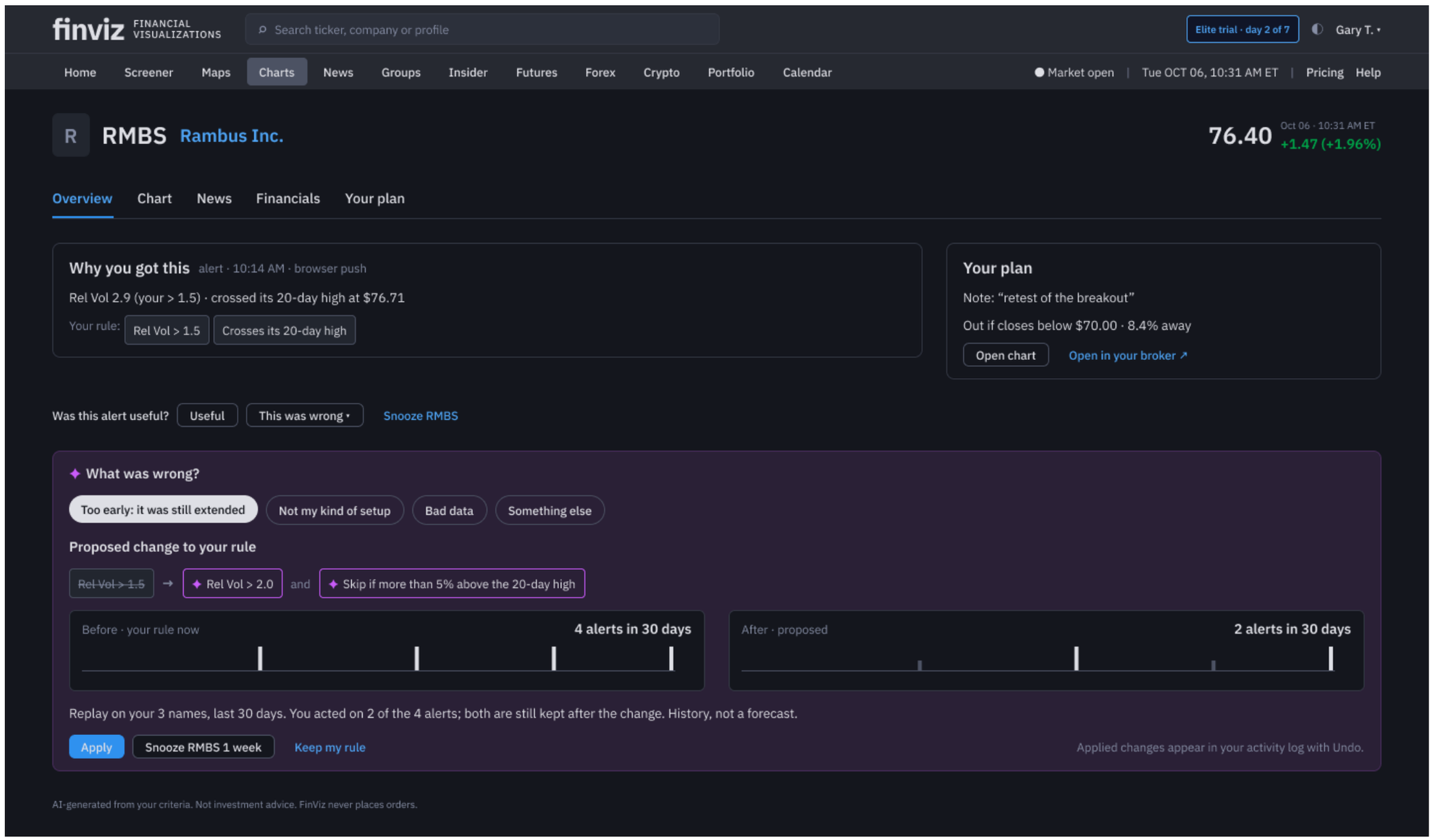


AI BEHAVIOR

- Three findings that need him today, each sourced and labelled Clear
- The familiar parts stay: index row, breadth bars, S&P 500 map, now with AI notes
- Pre-market prices on his own names are the Elite moment

Close-up · Step 12 · AN7 · “This was wrong” → proposed fix

Tue 10:31 AM. The alert opened on the RMBS quote page.



DECISION POINT

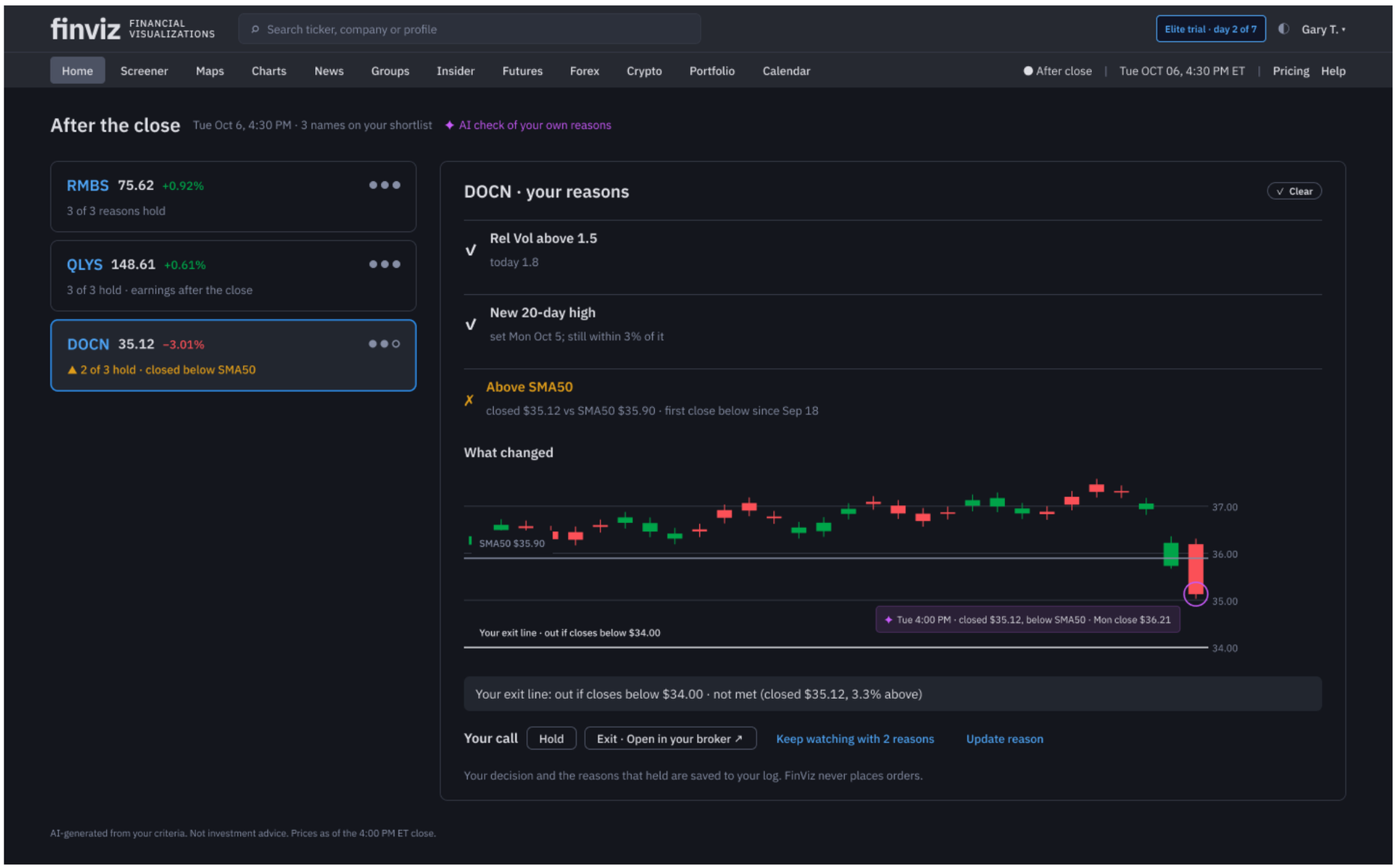
His reason (“too early”) becomes a specific change to his own rule

Before/after replay: 4 → 2 alerts in 30 days, both acted-on alerts kept

Nothing changes until he applies it; every change is logged with Undo

Close-up · Step 14 · OW7 · Reasons Still Hold?

Tue 4:30 PM. DOCN closes below its SMA50: a reason breaks.



DECISION POINT

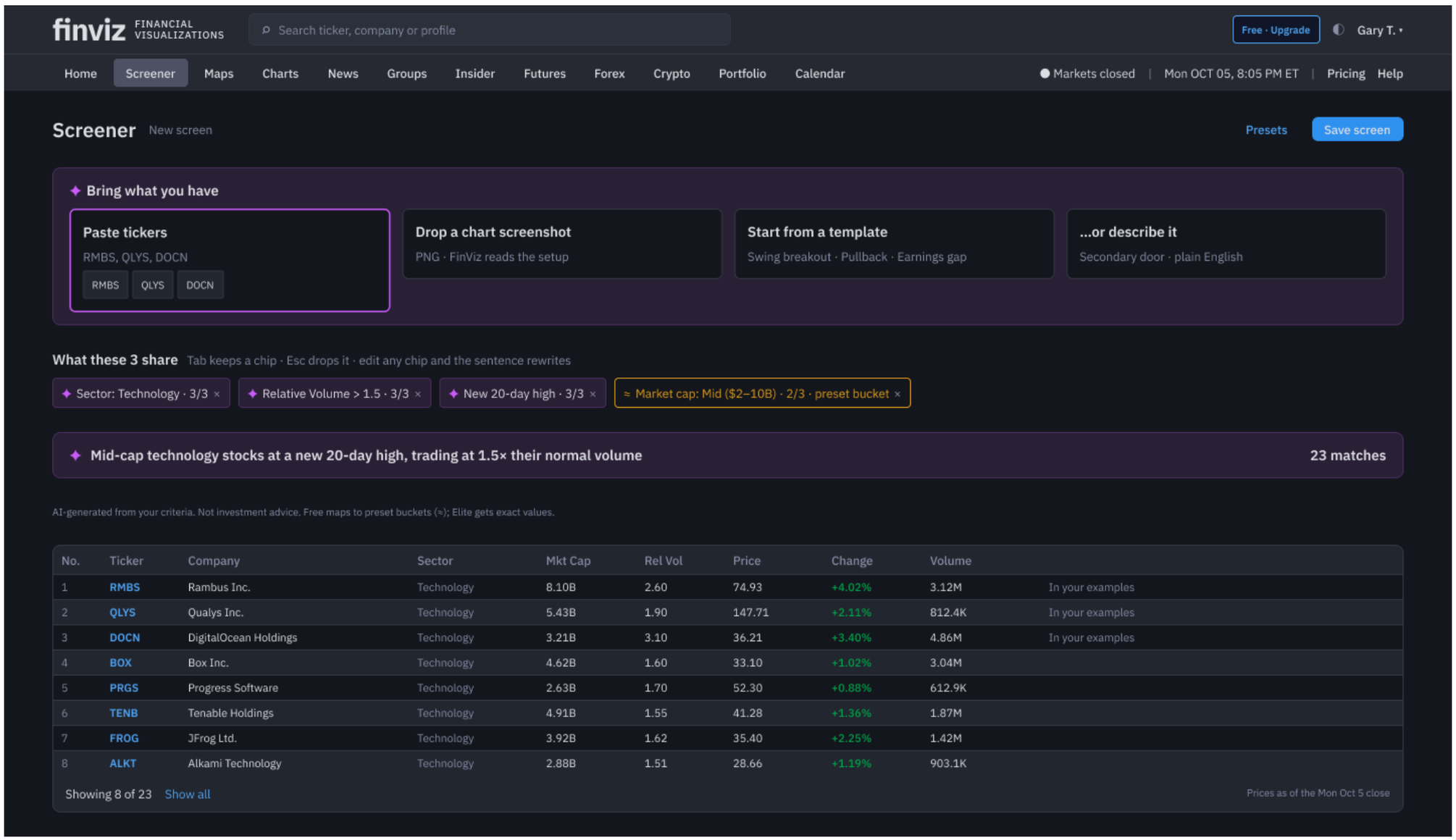
A checklist that ticks itself against today's close

What changed and when, on the chart; his exit line ($34.00) not met

Hold or exit is his call, in his own broker; FinViz never places orders

Try it: click through the whole day

The full trading day is a clickable prototype in Figma, starting at step 1: Show It.



PROTOTYPE

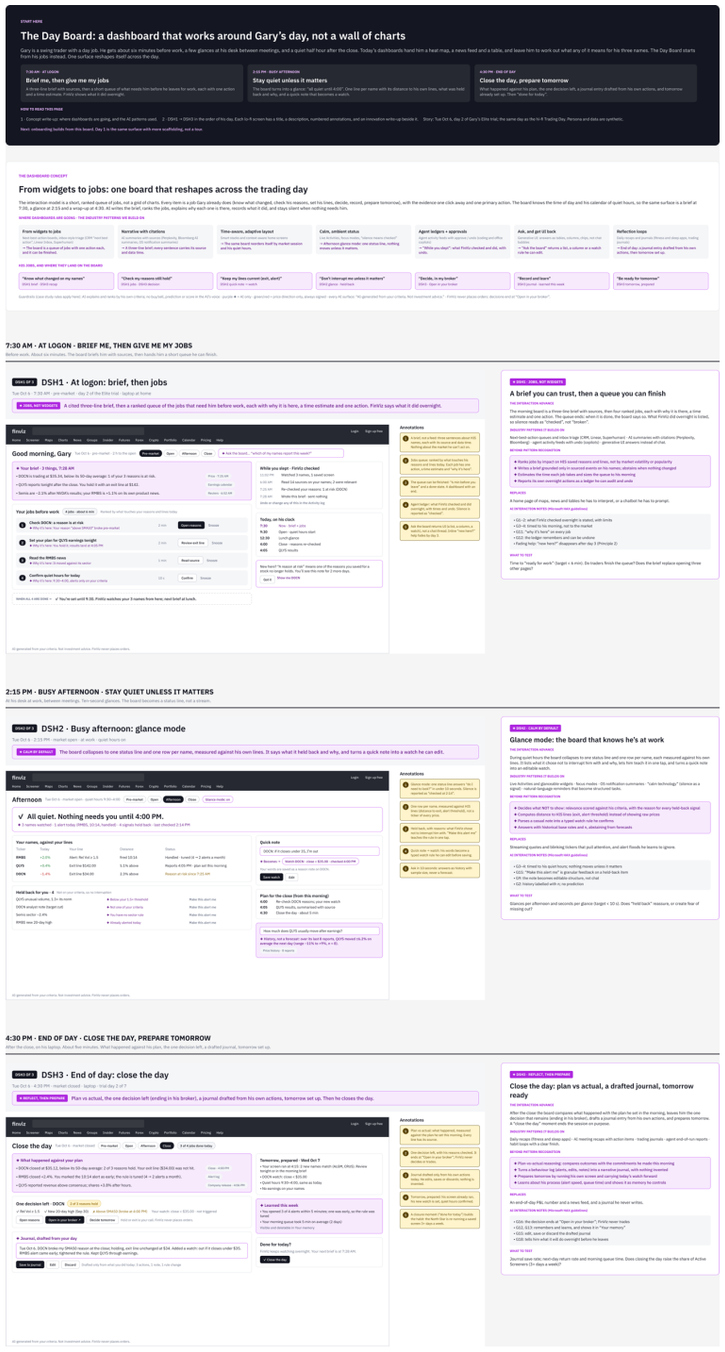
Open the Figma prototype →

19 linked hi-fi screens, each moving forward through its real button

Also available offline, with the narrative for every step: The-Trading-Day-Prototype.html

Wireframes: the Day Board, drawn before the model

Lo-fi to hi-fi, for logon, afternoon, and end of day. Figma page: Dashboards · The Day Board.



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

Onboarding today is a tour, and nothing shows a swing trader what changed since last night. The check is done by hand, across tabs.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

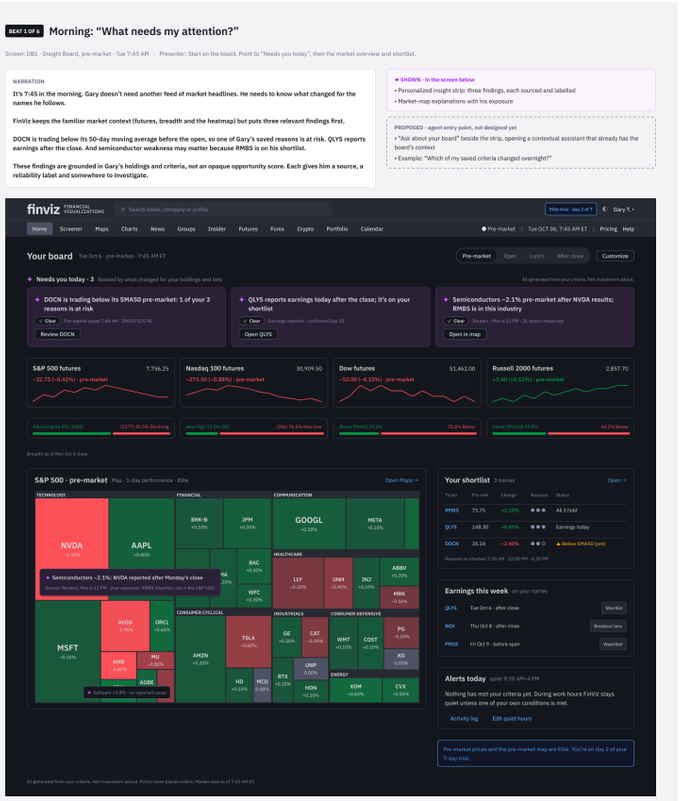
The Day Board is drawn for three moments of the day: logon, afternoon, and end of day. One layout, and every card names its source and why it appeared.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I drew the board before the model. The layout was tested against the trader's routine, so the AI fills a structure that already works.

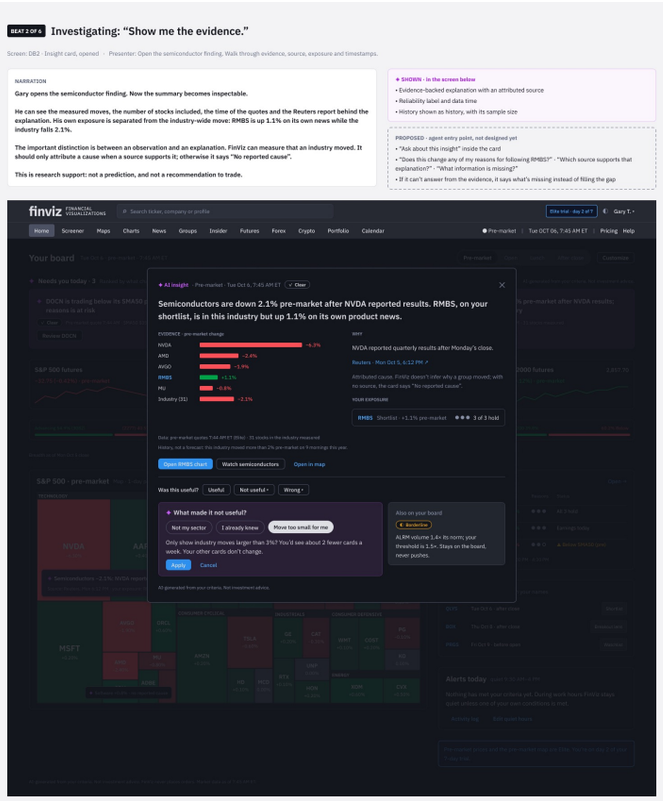
User flow: one trader's morning, in six beats

Each beat asks one question. Three beats shown here; the rest are in the walkthrough page.



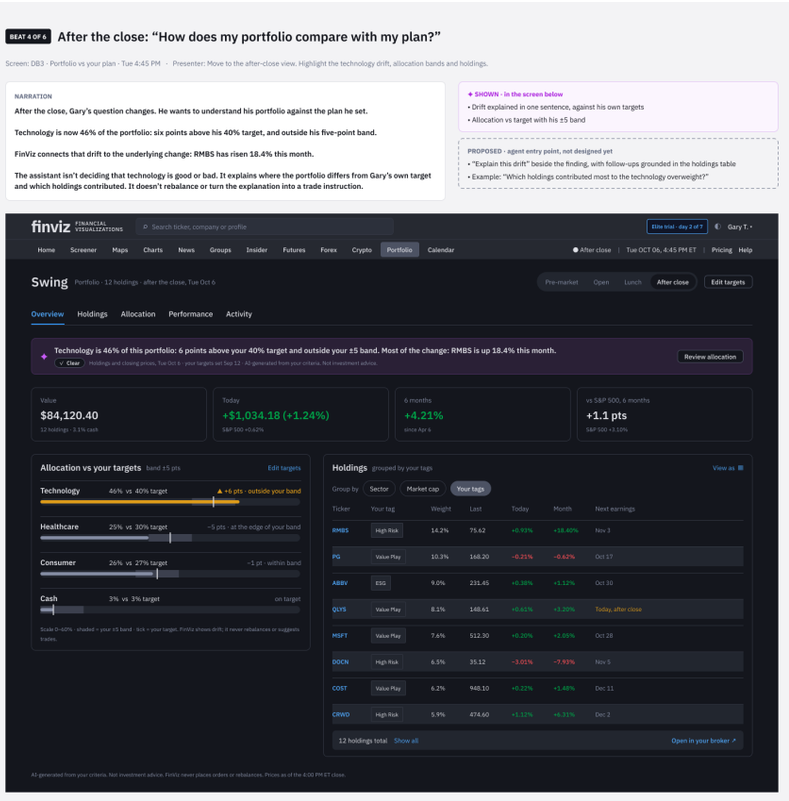
BEAT 1 · MORNING

“What needs my attention?”



BEAT 2 · INVESTIGATING

“Show me the evidence.”



BEAT 4 · AFTER THE CLOSE

“How does my portfolio compare with my plan?”

THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

A swing trader cannot read 11,666 tickers each morning. The question is what needs attention, and the answer cannot be a black box.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

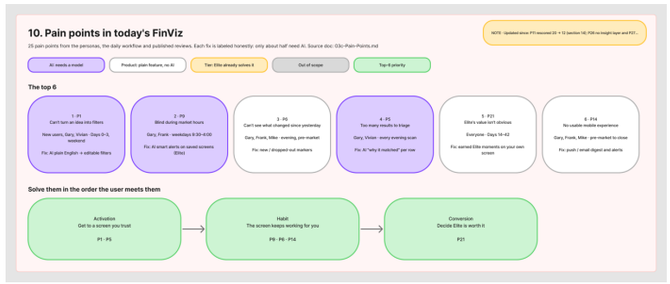
The AI surfaces what changed. Each insight carries its evidence, and the trader decides. Nothing is changed without asking first.

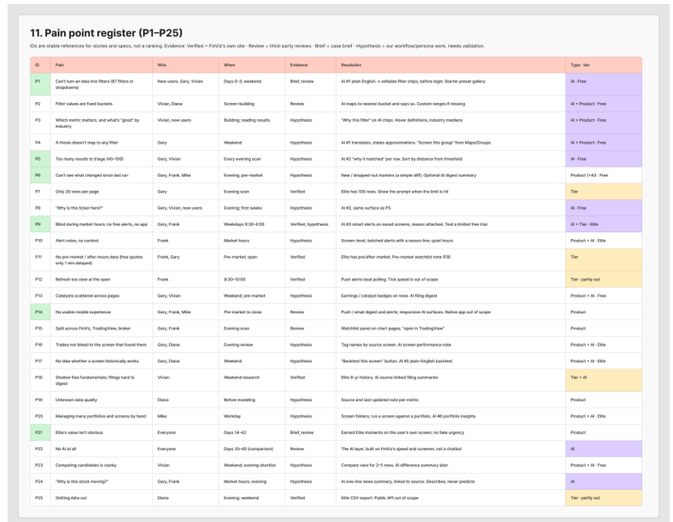
WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

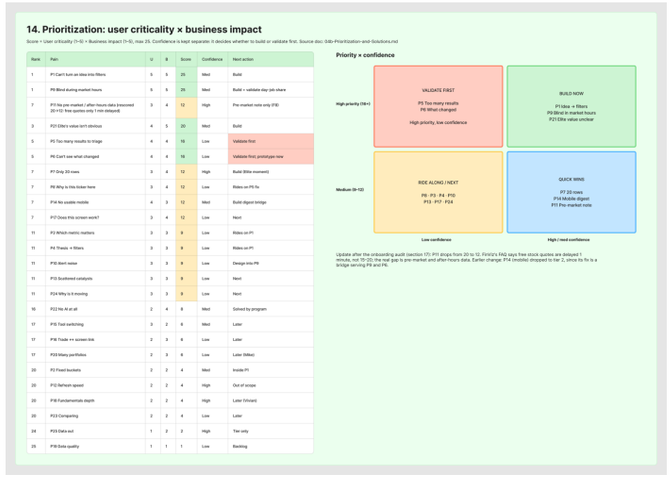
I wrote the flow as the questions a trader asks, so reviewers can follow each decision and see the rules on screen.

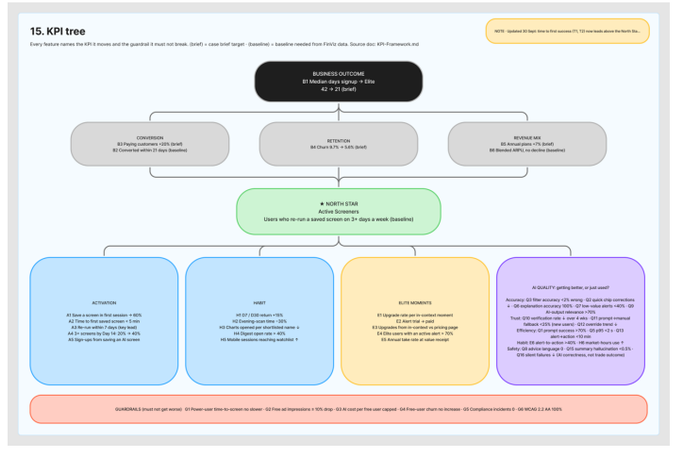
FigJam: pain points and KPIs, the record behind the design

FinViz AI: Swing Trader Workflow board. Sections 10, 11, 14, and 15.









THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

The reasons for each decision sat in separate documents, so a KPI or a backlog item could drift away from the pain point it answers.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

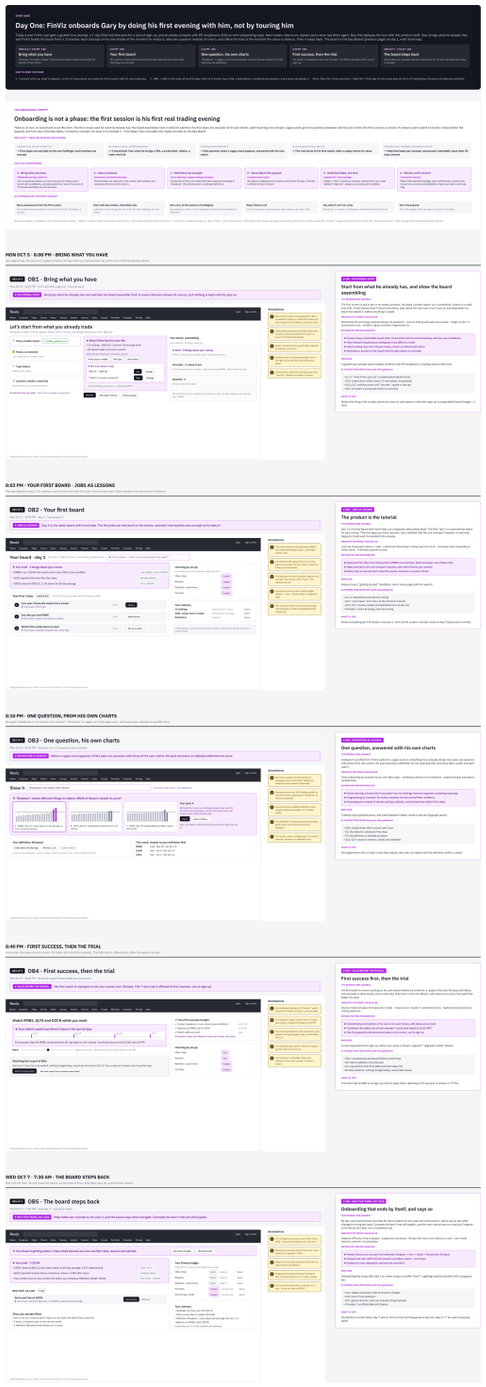
Pain points, the pain register, prioritization, and the KPI tree sit on one board. Each KPI traces back to a pain point it is meant to move.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I kept the working record in the open, so the team could challenge a KPI or a backlog item before it reached a screen.

Onboarding Day One: no tour, the first evening

Lo-fi to hi-fi. Figma page: Onboarding · Day One.



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

FinViz onboarding today is a tour video. A new trader learns outside the product, then has to remember it on the first screen.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

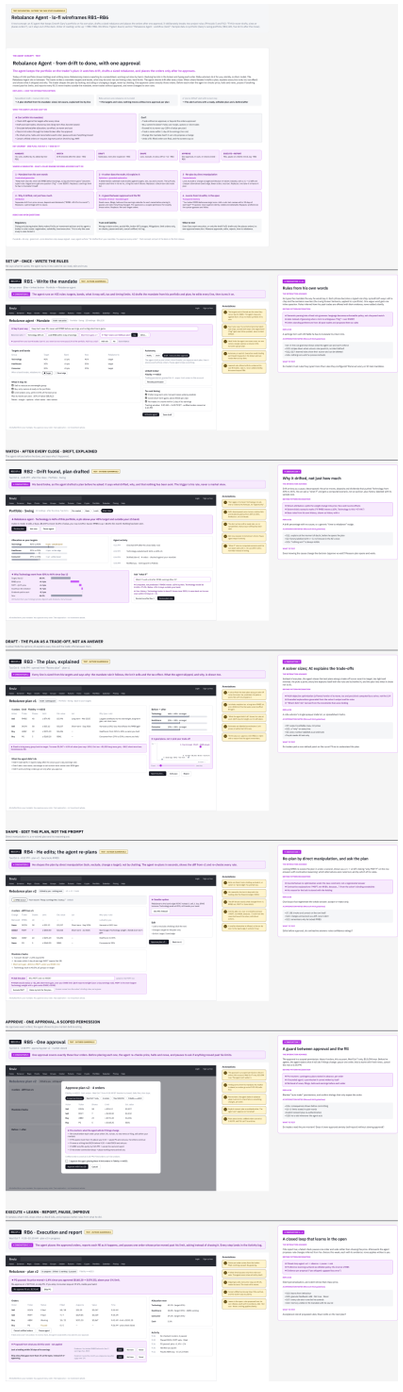
Day One is AI-led with no tour. Each screen teaches what it shows at the moment it is used, so learnability is a property of every screen.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I drew Day One as a sequence of screens, so the first evening can be reviewed step by step, not only as a principle.

Test: a rebalance agent, outside the guardrails

Figma page: Rebalance Agent (outside guardrails).



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

An agent that rebalances a portfolio can act beyond what the trader set. That is the most serious risk in the concept.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

The rebalance idea is drawn as a test, outside the guardrails, with the boundary stated on the screen. It is not part of the first release.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I kept the riskiest idea labeled as a test, so reviewers can see the line between proposal and action.

The daily blueprint, from morning to close

FigJam working document, section 3.

3. The daily and weekly cycle: service blueprint

All times US Eastern. Market hours 9:30 AM to 4:00 PM. For the part-time swing trader, most FinViz value is delivered outside market hours: the evening scan is the core session.

	Outside market hours · FinViz light	Market open 9:30 AM–4:00 PM · FinViz nearly absent		Outside market hours · FinViz strongest	
	Pre-market	Market hours (open + midday)	Close	Evening scan ★ + review	Weekend prep
When · where · device	7:00–9:15 AM · kitchen or commute · phone · 10–15 min	9:30 AM–3:30 PM · at work · phone glances	3:30–4:00 PM · at work · phone · 2–5 min	~8–10 PM weeknights · home · laptop · 30–60 min	Sat/Sun · home · laptop · 1–2 hrs
Goal	Did anything break overnight? Adjust or cancel orders	Don't miss a stop or a breakout	Confirm closing strength or weakness	Build tomorrow's watchlist and plan orders	Pick the week's themes, refine screens
Gary does	Checks futures and news. Checks whether watchlist or holdings gapped or reported earnings. Cancels orders if a setup broke	Glances at broker app between meetings: filled? stopped? Reacts only when notified	Checks whether positions close strong. Sometimes enters near the close to confirm a breakout	Checks breadth on Home. Re-runs 2–4 saved screens. Scans results, opens 5–15 charts, shortlists 3–5. Sets entry, stop, target. Stages orders. Journals fills, moves stops	Reviews last week's trades. Checks sector heat map and Groups. Checks earnings calendar. Refines or creates screens. Backtests an idea. Builds a 10–30 name focus list
FinViz touchpoints today	Home (futures, headlines) · Quote pages · News. On mobile web: no app	None. No free alerts, no app. Elite email/push alerts are the only touchpoint	Portfolio on mobile web · quick Maps glance	Home · Screener presets · Charts view · Quote · News · Portfolio / Color Flags	Maps · Groups · Calendar · Screener · Backtests (Elite) · Portfolio
Other tools	Broker app, news app, X	Broker app notifications (fills, stops)	Broker app	TradingView (charting), broker (orders), trade journal	TradingView, journal, YouTube / Substack
Pain points (see 11 · register)	P6 · P11 · P13 · P14 Free data is delayed and there's no pre-market data. Clunky mobile web. Checks each name one by one	P9 · P10 · P24 · P14 Misses breakouts on names that weren't staged. Can't see why something moved. Broker alert noise	P11 · P14 Mobile web is slow to scan	P1 · P5 · P6 · P7 · P8 · P15 · P16 Triaging 40–100 results to find 5. Re-checking why each ticker is there. Can't see what's new since yesterday. Jumping between FinViz and TradingView	P1 · P2 · P3 · P4 · P13 · P17 Turning a thesis into filters. No idea whether a screen has historically worked. Earnings dates scattered
Free vs Elite friction	Pre-market data (4 AM) is Elite	Alerts are Elite-only: free users are blind here	Real-time quotes are Elite	Free shows 20 rows vs 100. Advanced filters are Elite	Backtests, 8-yr financials and export are Elite
AI touchpoint	NEW: morning screen digest by push/email. "NVDA −4% pre-mkt on earnings; 2 new names entered Breakouts overnight"	#3 Smart alerts: "AMD entered your Breakouts screen (Rel Vol 2.3, above SMA50)". Reason attached, batched to avoid noise	#3 variant: "2 watchlist names are closing above resistance"	#2 Why it matched on every row · NEW: "new since last run" markers · #1 for tweaks ("same but only above $10") · NEW: screen performance note	#1 plain-English screens · #5 plain-English backtest · NEW: earnings flags across watchlist names
Elite moment	Real-time pre-market data	Alerts: the strongest hook for this segment	Real-time quotes	"Watch this screen for me tomorrow" prompt after saving. 100 rows	Backtests, export
Emotional state	Rushed, getting ready for work. Must take under 2 min	Distracted, anxious. Only interrupt when it's worth it	Quick check, low attention	Focused but tired after work. Speed and low cognitive load matter most	Unhurried and curious. Best moment to learn new features
Saved screen	Checked	Watched	Watched	Re-run, trusted	Created, proven

THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

A swing trader's day runs across tools, and each moment has a different need. Without a map, the design guesses at the day.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

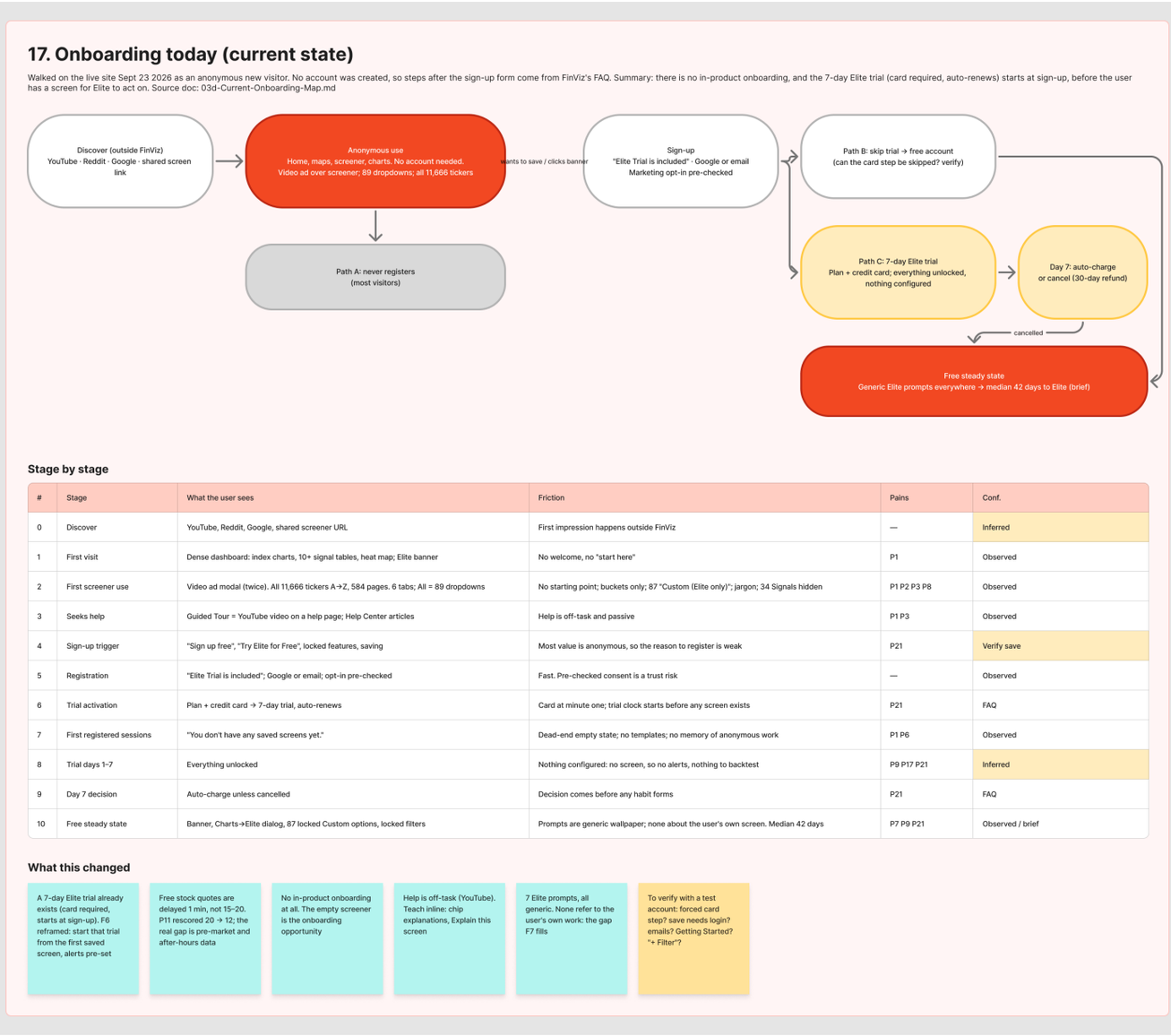
The blueprint lays out the trader's day in order, with the touchpoints where FinViz could help and where it should stay out of the way.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I mapped the whole day before designing any screen, so each screen answers a moment in that day.

Onboarding today: the baseline

FigJam working document, section 19.



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

The current onboarding is a tour and help articles. Without a baseline, the team cannot tell whether a change helps.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

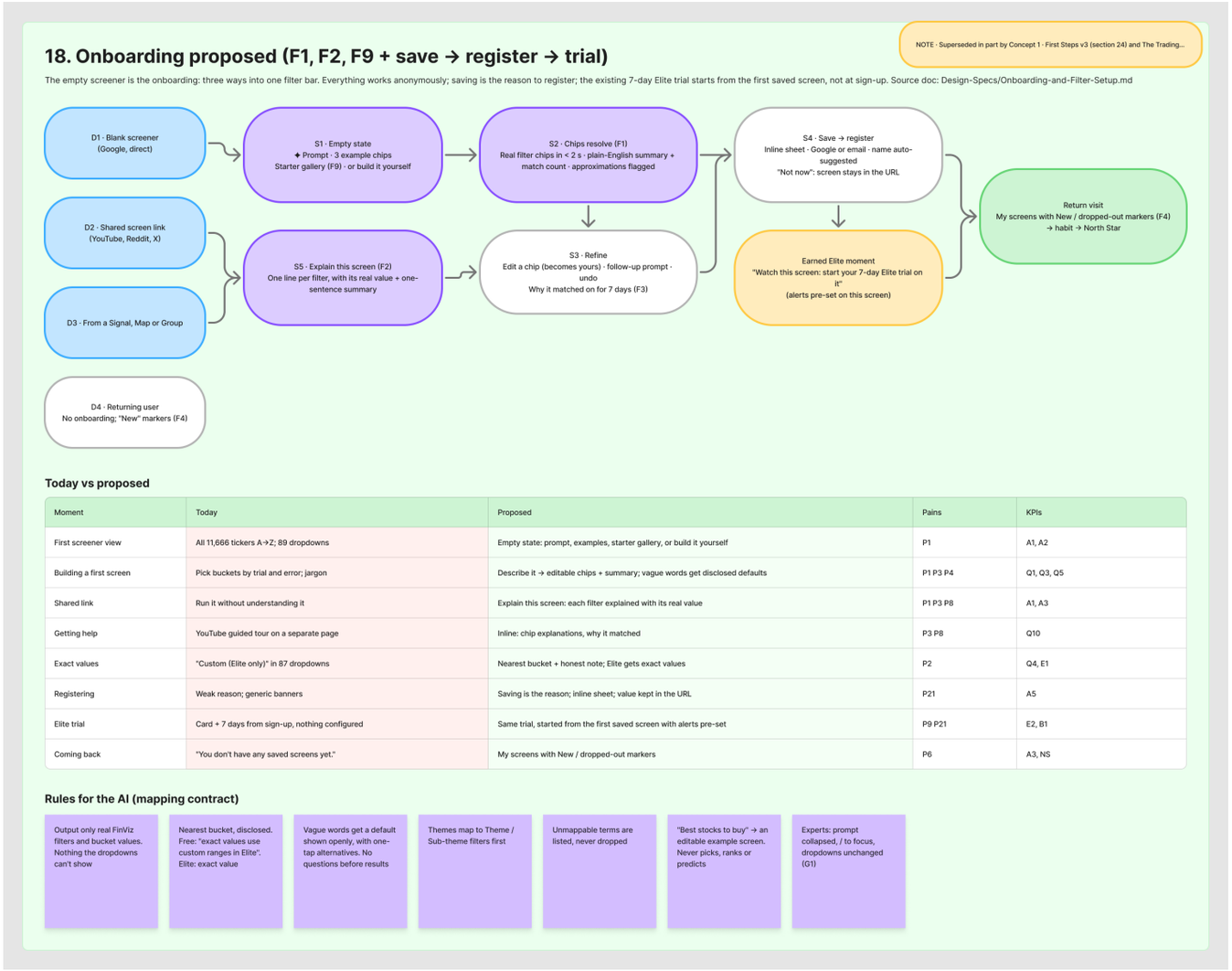
The board records each step a new trader takes today, with the gap at each step. It is the baseline the proposed onboarding is measured against.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I documented today before proposing a change, so the team could check the new flow against the old one.

Onboarding proposed: learning in place

FigJam working document, section 20.



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

A tour teaches before the trader needs anything. By the time the trader reaches the screen, the lesson is gone.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

The proposed flow teaches on the screen the trader is using, one step at a time, with no separate tour. Each step traces back to a gap on the baseline board.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

Each proposed step is traced to a gap in today's flow, so the change answers a stated problem.

Concept 1: First Steps

FigJam working document, section 17.

19. Concept 1 · First Steps (formerly Onboarding) · v2

Start from what you already know. Learn by doing. Help fades per concept. Onboarding is a layer on top of Concept 2 (Filtering), not a flow: no tour, no wizard, nothing a repeat user must dismiss. Hero moment: paste your own watchlist → "What these share" → a working screen in about 20 seconds. Source: Design-Specs/Two-Concepts.md

Frictions in today's FinViz this removes

#	Current friction (observed on the live site)	Source	Removed by
01	Video ad covers the screener on first load, then a second loads	03d stage 2	Business test: no interstitial before the first result (gated by G2)
02	Dense homepage, no "start here"	03d stage 1	"Find stocks like…" on Home opens the four doors
03	Default = all 11,666 tickers A→Z; no starting point	03d · P1	Four doors; start from stocks you already like
04	89 unexplained dropdowns, jargon	03d · P1 P3	Find a filter by meaning; grounded live explanations
05	34 Signals and 42 Themes hidden in dropdowns	03d	Semantic finder returns Signals + Themes with filters
06	Help is off-task (YouTube tour on a separate page)	03d · P3	In-place, per-concept help
07	Weak reason to register	03d · P21	Saving is the reason; your work comes with you
08	Marketing opt-in pre-checked	03d stage 5	Opt-in unchecked
09	Card trial at sign-up, before anything is configured	03d · P21	Trial started from the first saved screen, with a grounded preview
010	"You don't have any saved screens yet"; anonymous work lost	03d stage 7	Anonymous work carried into the account
011	Generic Elite prompts everywhere	03d §4 · P21	One earned moment tied to the user's own screen
012	Repeat users get no help with unfamiliar or new features	P3	Per-concept fading; new features arrive at Explain; Catch me up

Mechanics · each names the AI / UX advance it uses

1.1 Four doors
Describe it · Show it · Template · Build it

Advance: multimodal input

1.2 "What these share"
Paste tickers or a watchlist → shared traits as chips with coverage ("7 of 9 mid cap"), outliers named

Advance: programming by example

1.3 Explain & remix
Shared screens explained filter by filter; forks with diffs + version history

Advance: transparent, reversible edits

1.4 Find a filter by meaning
"debt" → Debt/Equity + mini-distribution; filters, Signals and Themes together

Advance: semantic retrieval

1.5 Grounded explanations + fading
"312 stocks have RSI < 30 now, e.g. AMD at 28"; Explain → Hint → Quiet; Fluency Ledger

Advance: grounded generation + adaptive UI

1.6 Your work comes with you
Anonymous screens shown before sign-up and kept; opt-in unchecked

Advance: transparent, portable memory

1.7 First-save moment
"This screen had 4 new entries last week. Start your 7-day trial on it?"

Advance: grounded counterfactual preview

1.8 Catch me up
Away 30+ days: one line on what changed in their screens + new features at Explain

Advance: bounded background agent

Programming by example, the hero mechanic:

```
1  What these 9 stocks share
2  ✦ Sector: Technology ..... 9 of 9   [add]
3  ✦ Market Cap: Mid ($2–10B) .. 7 of 9   [add]
   outliers: NVDA (mega), SOUN (small)
4  ✦ Price above SMA50 ..... 6 of 9   [add]
5  ✦ Relative Volume > 1 ..... 4 of 9   (weak, not
   added)
6  + 31 other stocks share the first three traits
   [Show them]
```

Guardrails

- Never add a step, modal or tour a repeat user must dismiss (G1)
- "What these share" describes traits; it never evaluates or recommends (Q8)
- Grounded examples are chosen by the criterion, never by performance
- Pasted data is session-only unless saved; screenshots never stored
- Fluency is never a label, score or anything social

Hero sequences to prototype

1 · Paste your watchlist → "What these share" → accept 3 traits → a 31-stock screen in ~20 s

2 · Find a filter by meaning: "debt" → Debt/Equity with mini-distribution → chip

3 · Same chip, three sessions: live grounded example → hint dot → quiet

4 · Anonymous screens shown before sign-up → saved → "had 4 new entries last week" → start trial on this screen

KPIs: A1 save in first session → 60% · A2 first saved screen < 5 min · A6 paste → first screen < 30 s (new) · A5 sign-ups from saving · Q17 trait accuracy ≥ 98% (new) · Q10 verification ↓ · Q11 fallback < 25% · E2 trial → paid · G1 · G4
Backlog: F2 F9 F31 F35 F36 F37 F38 F39 + first-save moment

THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

A new trader does not know which first step matters. The first session can end before the first useful result.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

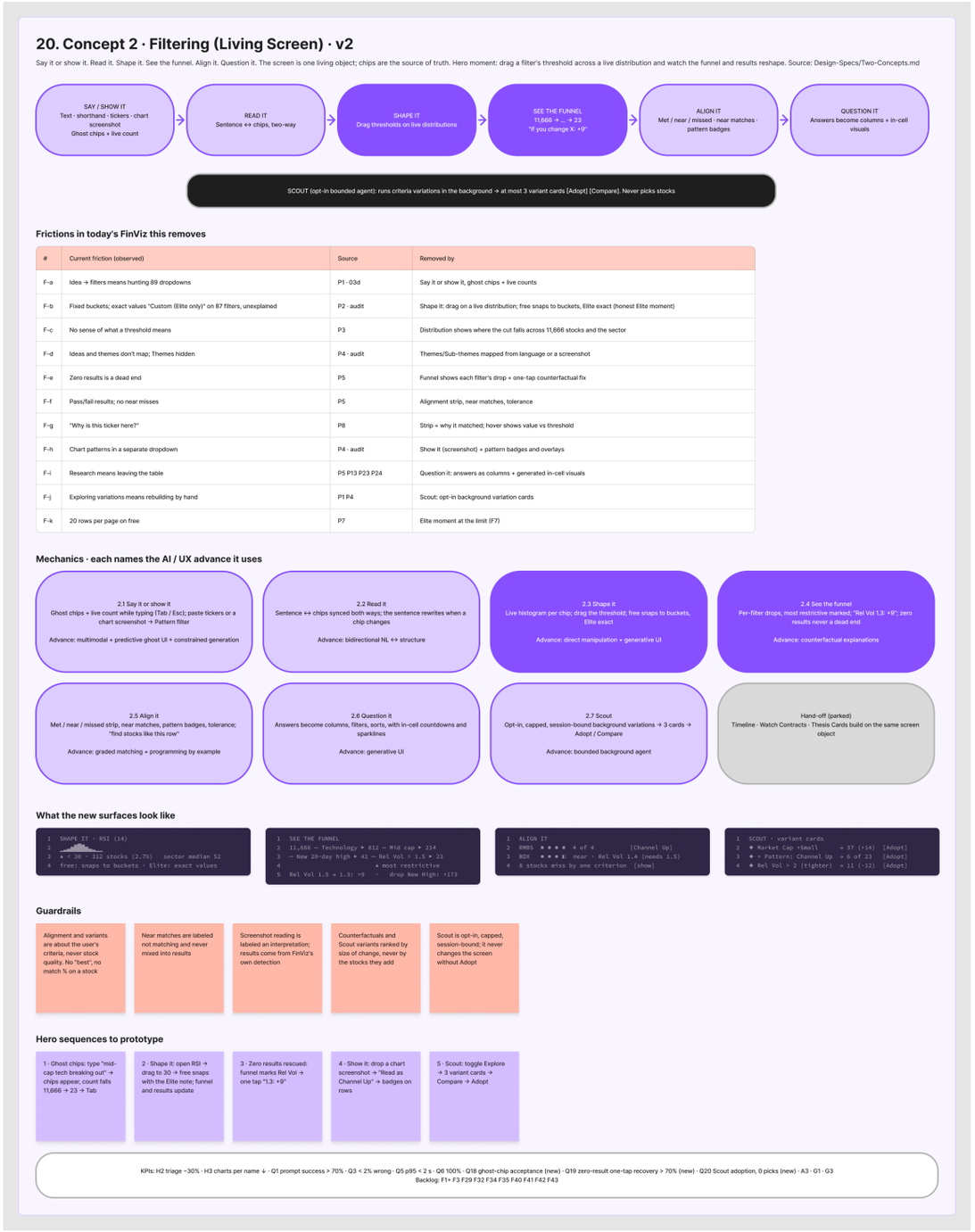
First Steps is one of three lead concepts. It builds the first success around a short, guided route to a screen the trader trusts.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I wrote each concept as a building block with its own test, so the team could compare them on the same measures.

Concept 2: Filtering

FigJam working document, section 18.



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

The screener has 89 filter dropdowns across six tabs, and a new trader does not know which ones answer their question.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

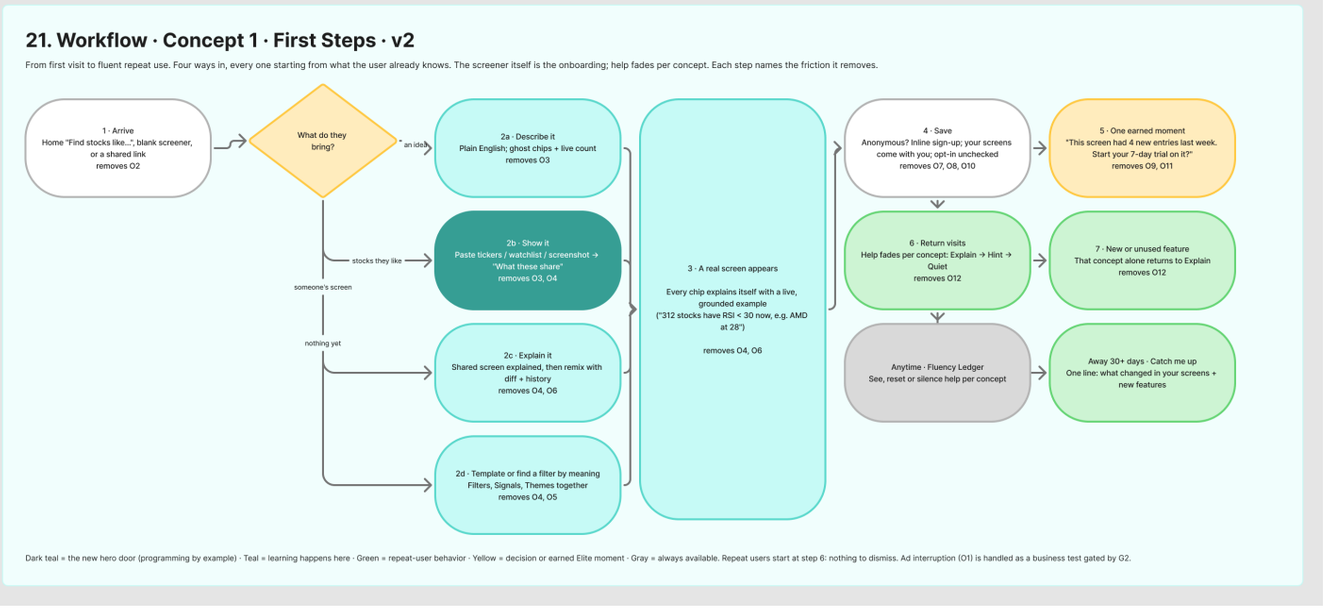
Filtering is the second concept. It builds the first success around choosing the right filters for a question, not around the full list.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I checked each concept against the same pain points, so the choice between concepts rests on evidence, not preference.

Workflow: First Steps

FigJam working document, section 21.



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

A concept is only useful if it works across the whole path, not only on one screen.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

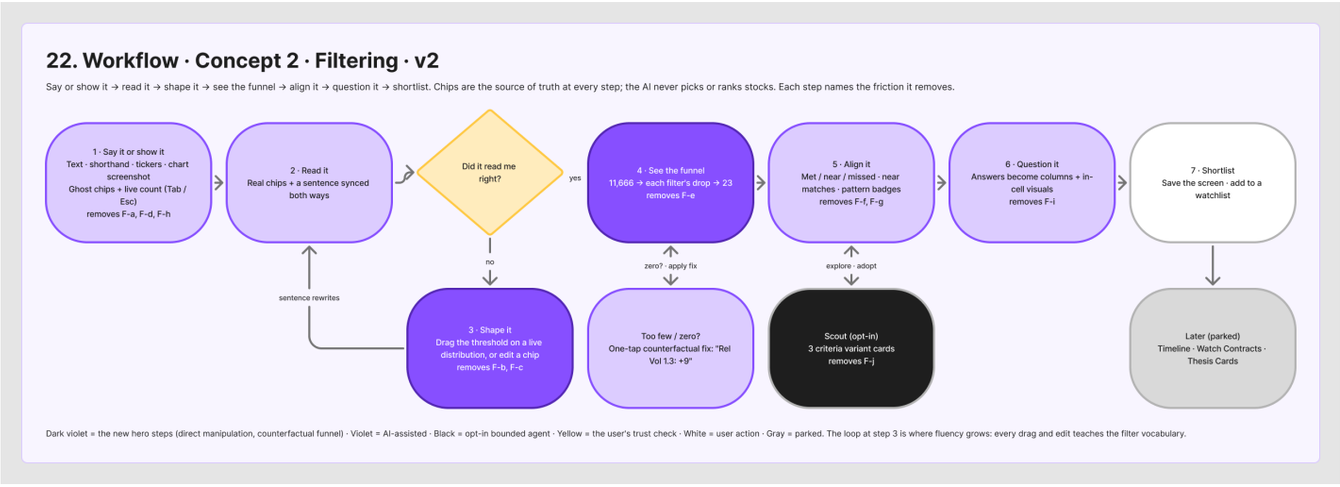
The workflow shows the path from first sign-on to the first trading day, with the screens and the decision points for the concept.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I traced each concept's workflow, so a reviewer can follow the path and find where it breaks.

Workflow: Filtering

FigJam working document, section 22.



THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

Filtering can look simple on one screen but fail across a session, when the trader changes a filter and loses the result.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

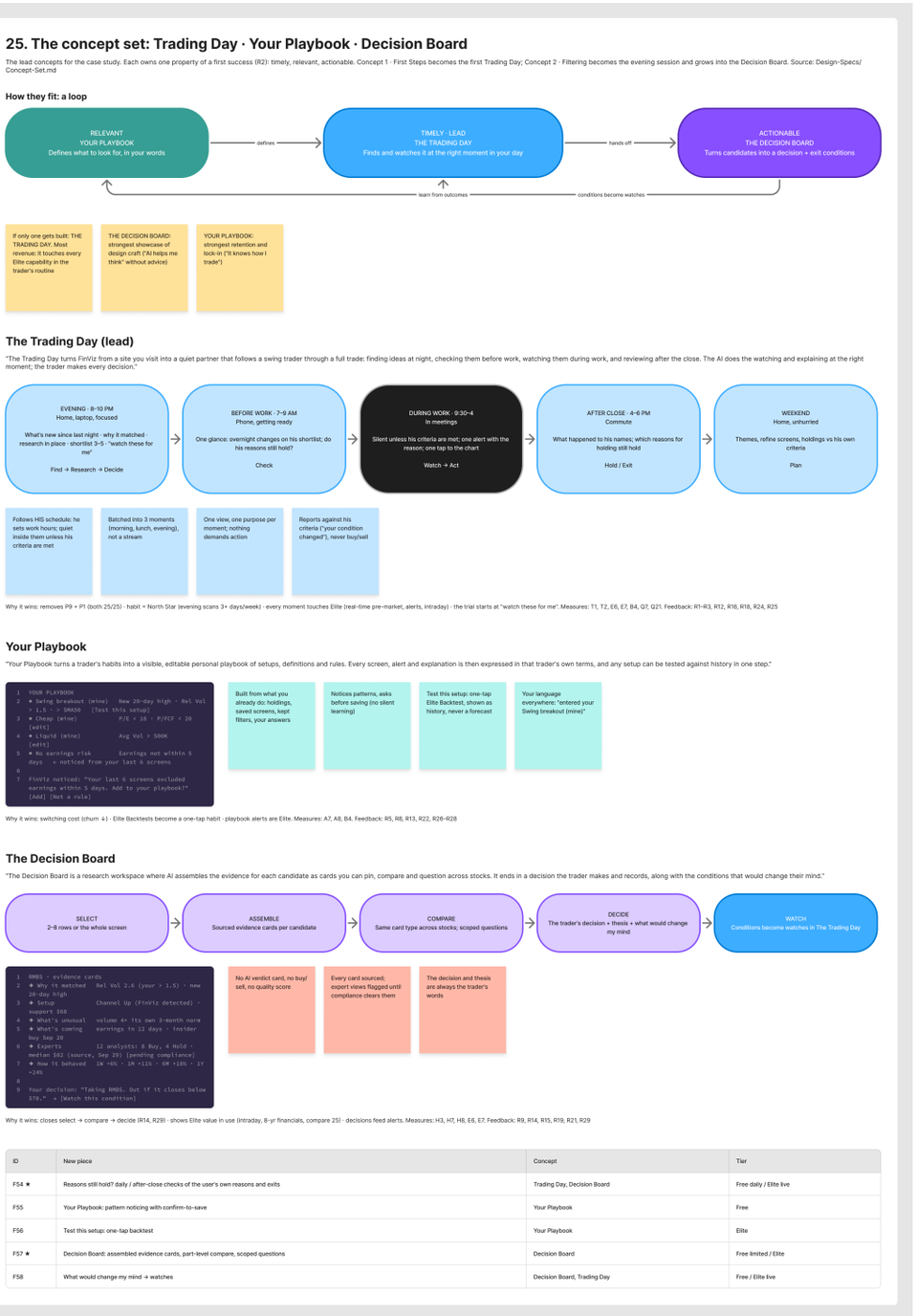
The filtering workflow shows the same path for concept two, so the two concepts can be compared step for step.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

Both workflows follow one format, so the comparison is fair.

The concept set: three ways into the day

FigJam working document, section 25.



25. The concept set: Trading Day · Your Playbook · Decision Board

The lead concepts for the case study. Each owns one property of a first success (R2): timely, relevant, actionable. Concept 1 · First Steps becomes the first Trading Day; Concept 2 · Filtering becomes the evening session and grows into the Decision Board. Source: Design-Specs/Concept-Set.md

How they fit: a loop

RELEVANT
YOUR PLAYBOOK
Defines what to look for, in your words

defines →

TIMELY · LEAD
THE TRADING DAY
Finds and watches it at the right moment in your day

hands off →

ACTIONABLE
THE DECISION BOARD
Turns candidates into a decision + exit conditions

learn from outcomes ← conditions become watches

If only one gets built: THE TRADING DAY. Most revenue: it touches every Elite capability in the trader's routine

THE DECISION BOARD: strongest showcase of design craft ("AI helps me think" without advice)

YOUR PLAYBOOK: strongest retention and lock-in ("It knows how I trade")

The Trading Day (lead)

"The Trading Day turns FinViz from a site you visit into a quiet partner that follows a swing trader through a full trade: finding ideas at night, checking them before work, watching them during work, and reviewing after the close. The AI does the watching and explaining at the right moment; the trader makes every decision."

EVENING · 8–10 PM
Home, laptop, focused
What's new since last night · why it matched · research in place · shortlist 3–5 · "watch these for me"
Find → Research → Decide

BEFORE WORK · 7–9 AM
Phone, getting ready
One glance: overnight changes on his shortlist; do his reasons still hold?
Check

DURING WORK · 9:30–4
In meetings
Silent unless his criteria are met; one alert with the reason; one tap to the chart
Watch → Act

AFTER CLOSE · 4–6 PM
Commute
What happened to his names; which reasons for holding still hold
Hold / Exit

WEEKEND
Home, unhurried
Themes, refine screens, holdings vs his own criteria
Plan

Follows HIS schedule: he sets work hours; quiet inside them unless his criteria are met

Batched into 3 moments (morning, lunch, evening), not a stream

One view, one purpose per moment; nothing demands action

Reports against his criteria ("your condition changed"), never buy/sell

Why it wins: removes P9 + P1 (both 25/25) · habit = North Star (evening scans 3+ days/week) · every moment touches Elite (real-time pre-market, alerts, intraday) · the trial starts at "watch these for me". Measures: T1, T2, E6, E7, B4, Q7, Q21. Feedback: R1–R3, R12, R16, R18, R24, R25

Your Playbook

"Your Playbook turns a trader's habits into a visible, editable personal playbook of setups, definitions and rules. Every screen, alert and explanation is then expressed in that trader's own terms, and any setup can be tested against history in one step."

```
1  YOUR PLAYBOOK
2  ★ Swing breakout (mine)   New 20-day high · Rel Vol
   > 1.5 · > SMA50   [Test this setup]
3  ★ Cheap (mine)            P/E < 18 · P/FCF < 20
   [edit]
4  ★ Liquid (mine)           Avg Vol > 500K
   [edit]
5  ★ No earnings risk        Earnings not within 5
   days   + noticed from your last 6 screens
6
7  FinViz noticed: "Your last 6 screens excluded
   earnings within 5 days. Add to your playbook?"
   [Add] [Not a rule]
```

Built from what you already do: holdings, saved screens, kept filters, your answers

Notices patterns, asks before saving (no silent learning)

Test this setup: one-tap Elite Backtest, shown as history, never a forecast

Your language everywhere: "entered your Swing breakout (mine)"

Why it wins: switching cost (churn ↓) · Elite Backtests become a one-tap habit · playbook alerts are Elite. Measures: A7, A8, B4. Feedback: R5, R8, R13, R22, R26–R28

The Decision Board

"The Decision Board is a research workspace where AI assembles the evidence for each candidate as cards you can pin, compare and question across stocks. It ends in a decision the trader makes and records, along with the conditions that would change their mind."

SELECT
2–8 rows or the whole screen

ASSEMBLE
Sourced evidence cards per candidate

COMPARE
Same card type across stocks; scoped questions

DECIDE
The trader's decision + thesis + what would change my mind

WATCH
Conditions become watches in The Trading Day

```
1  RMBS · evidence cards
2  ◆ Why it matched   Rel Vol 2.6 (your > 1.5) · new
   20-day high
3  ◆ Setup            Channel Up (FinViz detected) ·
   support $68
4  ◆ What's unusual   volume 4× its own 3-month norm
5  ◆ What's coming    earnings in 12 days · insider
   buy Sep 20
6  ◆ Experts          12 analysts: 8 Buy, 4 Hold ·
   median $82 (source, Sep 29) [pending compliance]
7  ◆ How it behaved   1W +6% · 1M +11% · 6M +18% · 1Y
   +24%
8
9  Your decision: "Taking RMBS. Out if it closes below
   $70." → [Watch this condition]
```

No AI verdict card, no buy/sell, no quality score

Every card sourced; expert views flagged until compliance clears them

The decision and thesis are always the trader's words

Why it wins: closes select → compare → decide (R14, R29) · shows Elite value in use (intraday, 8-yr financials, compare 25) · decisions feed alerts. Measures: H3, H7, H8, E6, E7. Feedback: R9, R14, R15, R19, R21, R29

ID	New piece	Concept	Tier
F54 ★	Reasons still hold? daily / after-close checks of the user's own reasons and exits	Trading Day, Decision Board	Free daily / Elite live
F55	Your Playbook: pattern noticing with confirm-to-save	Your Playbook	Free
F56	Test this setup: one-tap backtest	Your Playbook	Elite
F57 ★	Decision Board: assembled evidence cards, part-level compare, scoped questions	Decision Board	Free limited / Elite
F58	What would change my mind → watches	Decision Board, Trading Day	Free / Elite live

THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

Three possible first experiences, and no shared way to compare them.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

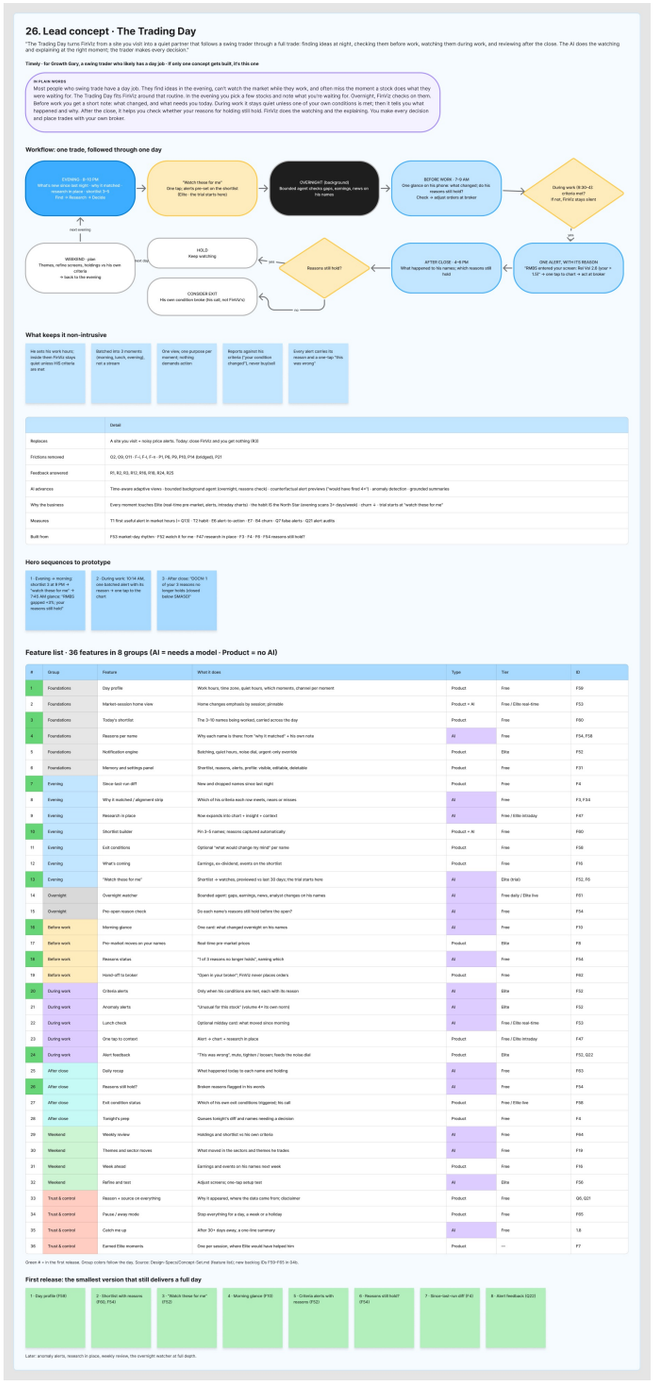
The Trading Day, Your Playbook, and The Decision Board are three concepts, each built around one property of a first success.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I set the three concepts side by side, so the team chose a lead on evidence, not on the first idea.

Lead concept: The Trading Day

FigJam working document, section 26.



26. Lead concept · The Trading Day

"The Trading Day turns FinViz from a site you visit into a quiet partner that follows a swing trader through a full trade: finding ideas at night, checking them before work, watching them during work, and reviewing after the close. The AI does the watching and explaining at the right moment; the trader makes every decision."

Timely · for Growth Gary, a swing trader who likely has a day job · If only one concept gets built, it's this one

IN PLAIN WORDS
Most people who swing trade have a day job. They find ideas in the evening, can't watch the market while they work, and often miss the moment a stock does what they were waiting for. The Trading Day fits FinViz around that routine. In the evening you pick a few stocks and note what you're waiting for. Overnight, FinViz checks on them. Before work you get a short note: what changed, and what needs you today. During work it stays quiet unless one of your own conditions is met; then it tells you what happened and why. After the close, it helps you check whether your reasons for holding still hold. FinViz does the watching and the explaining. You make every decision and place trades with your own broker.

Workflow: one trade, followed through one day

EVENING · 8–10 PM
What's new since last night · why it matched · research in place · shortlist 3–5
First → Research → Decide

"Watch these for me"
One tap: alerts pre-set on the shortlist
(Elite · the trial starts here)

OVERNIGHT (Background)
Bounded agent checks gaps, earnings, news on his names

BEFORE WORK · 7–9 AM
One glance on his phone: what changed, do his reasons still hold?
Check → adjust orders at broker

During work (8:30–4)
criteria met?
If not, FinViz stays silent

ONE ALERT, WITH ITS REASON
"RIMES entered your screen: fast for 2.8 (your = 1.5)" → one tap to chart → act at broker

AFTER CLOSE · 4–8 PM
What happened to his names, which reasons still hold

Reasons still hold?

HOLD
Keep watching

CONSIDER EXIT
His own condition broke (his call, not FinViz's)

WEEKEND · plan
Themes, reflex screens, holdings vs his own criteria
→ back to the evening

next evening

next week

yes

no

What keeps it non-intrusive

He sets his work hours; inside them FinViz stays quiet unless HIS criteria are met	Batched into 3 moments (morning, lunch, evening), not a stream	One view, one purpose per moment; nothing demands action	Reports against his criteria ("your condition changed"), never buy/sell	Every alert carries its reason and a one-tap "this was wrong"

	Detail
Replaces	A site you visit + noisy price alerts. Today: close FinViz and you get nothing (#3)
Frictions removed	O2, O6, O11 · F-L, F-I, F-A · P1, P8, P9, P13, P14 (bridged), P21
Feedback answered	01, 82, 83, 812, R16, 018, 824, R25
AI advances	Time-aware adaptive views · bounded background agent (overnight, reasons check) · counterfactual alert previews ("would have fired 4×") · anomaly detection · grounded summaries
Why the business	Every moment touches Elite (real-time pre-market, alerts, intraday charts) · the habit IS the North Star (evening scans 3+ days/week) · churn ↓ · trial starts at "watch these for me"
Measures	T1 first useful alert in market hours (= O13) · T2 habit · E6 alert-to-action · E7 · E4 churn · Q7 false alerts · Q21 alert audits
Built from	P33 market-day rhythm · P32 watch it for me · P47 research in place · F3 · F4 · F9 · P34 reasons still hold?

Hero sequences to prototype

1 · Evening · morning shortlist	2 · During work	3 · After close
1 · Evening · morning shortlist 3 at 8 PM → "watch these for me" → 7:45 AM glance: "RMBS gapped +11%, your reasons still hold"	2 · During work, 10:14 AM, one batched alert with its reason → one tap to the chart	3 · After close: "DOCN 1 of your 3 reasons no longer holds (closed below SMA50)"

Feature list · 36 features in 8 groups (AI = needs a model · Product = no AI)

#	Group	Feature	What it does	Type	Tier	ID
1	Foundations	Day profile	Work hours, time zone, quiet hours, which moments, channel per moment	Product	Free	F39
2	Foundations	Market-session home view	Home changes emphasis by session; pinnable	Product + AI	Free / Elite real-time	F33
3	Foundations	Today's shortlist	The 3–10 names being worked, carried across the day	Product	Free	F60
4	Foundations	Reasons per name	Why each name is there: from "why it matched" + his own note	AI	Free	F54, F58
5	Foundations	Notification engine	Batching, quiet hours, noise dial, urgent-only override	Product	Elite	F52
6	Foundations	Memory and settings panel	Shortlist, reasons, alerts, profile: visible, editable, deletable	Product	Free	F31
7	Evening	Since-last-run diff	New and dropped names since last night	Product	Free	F4
8	Evening	Why it matched / alignment strip	Which of his criteria each row meets, nears or misses	AI	Free	F3, F34
9	Evening	Research in place	Now exposés into chart + insight + context	AI	Free / Elite intraday	F47
10	Evening	Shortlist builder	Pin 3–5 names; reasons captured automatically	Product + AI	Free	F60
11	Evening	Exit conditions	Optional "what would change my mind" per name	Product	Free	F56
12	Evening	What's coming	Earnings, ex-dividend, events on the shortlist	Product	Free	F15
13	Evening	"Watch these for me"	Shortlist → watches, previewed to last 30 days; the trial starts here	AI	Elite (trial)	F52, F0
14	Overnight	Overnight watcher	Bounded agent: gaps, earnings, news, analyst changes on his names	AI	Free daily / Elite live	F01
15	Overnight	Pre-open reason check	Do each name's reasons still hold before the open?	AI	Free	F54
16	Before work	Morning glance	One card: what changed overnight on his names	AI	Free	F10
17	Before work	Pre-market moves on your names	Real-time pre-market prices	Product	Elite	F8
18	Before work	Reasons status	"1 of 3 reasons no longer holds", easing which	AI	Free	F54
19	Before work	Hand-off to broker	"Open in your broker"; FVAS never places orders	Product	Free	F62
20	During work	Criteria alerts	Only when his conditions are met, each with its reason	AI	Elite	F32
21	During work	Anomaly alerts	"Unusual for this stock" (volume 4× its own norm)	AI	Elite	F32
22	During work	Lunch check	Optional midday card: what moved since morning	AI	Free / Elite real-time	F33
23	During work	One tap to context	Alert + chart + research in place	Product	Free / Elite intraday	F47
24	During work	Alert feedback	"This was wrong": mute, tighten / loosen; feeds the noise dial	Product	Elite	F32, G22
25	After close	Daily recap	What happened today to each name and holding	AI	Free	F63
26	After close	Reasons still hold?	Broken reasons flagged in his words	AI	Free	F54
27	After close	Exit condition status	Which of his own exit conditions triggered; his call	Product	Free / Elite live	F56
28	After close	Tonight's prep	Queues tonight's diff and names needing a decision	Product	Free	F4
29	Weekend	Weekly review	Holdings and shortlist vs his own criteria	AI	Free	F64
30	Weekend	Themes and sector moves	What moved in the sectors and themes he trades	AI	Free	F19
31	Weekend	Week ahead	Earnings and events on his names next week	Product	Free	F15
32	Weekend	Refine and test	Adjust screens; one-tap setup test	AI	Elite	F56
33	Trust & control	Reason + source on everything	Why it appeared, where the data come from; disclaimer	Product	Free	Q5, G21
34	Trust & control	Pause / away mode	Stop everything for a day, a week or a holiday	Product	Free	F65
35	Trust & control	Catch me up	After 30+ days away, a one-time summary	AI	Free	1.8
36	Trust & control	Earned Elite moments	One per session, where Elite would have helped him	Product	--	F7

Green # = in the first release. Group orders follow the day. Source: Design Specs/Concept Set.md (feature list); new backlog IDs F33–F65 in 04b.

First release: the smallest version that still delivers a full day

1 · Day profile (F39)	2 · Shortlist with reasons (F60, F54)	3 · "Watch these for me" (F52)	4 · Morning glance (F10)	5 · Criteria alerts with reasons (F32)	6 · Reasons still hold? (F54)	7 · Since-last-run diff (F4)	8 · Alert feedback (G22)

Later: anomaly alerts, research in place, weekly review, the overnight watcher at full depth.

THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

A trader who opens FinViz cold has no single picture of the day ahead.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

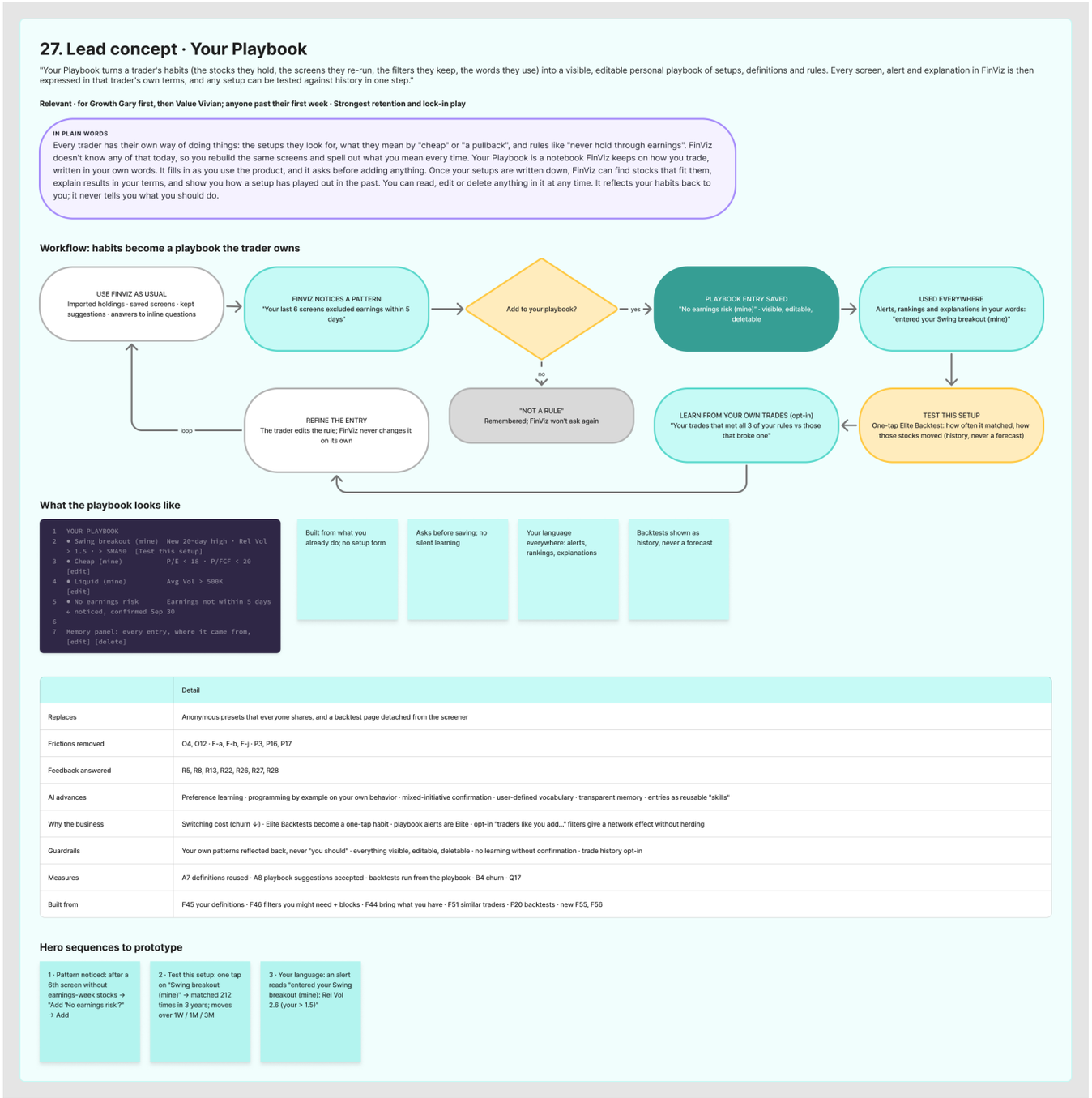
The Trading Day follows one trade through one day, from the evening idea to the next morning check. It is the lead concept.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I made it the lead and recorded the reasons on the board, so the choice can be challenged.

Concept: Your Playbook

FigJam working document, section 27.



27. Lead concept · Your Playbook

"Your Playbook turns a trader's habits (the stocks they hold, the screens they re-run, the filters they keep, the words they use) into a visible, editable personal playbook of setups, definitions and rules. Every screen, alert and explanation in FinViz is then expressed in that trader's own terms, and any setup can be tested against history in one step."

Relevant · for Growth Gary first, then Value Vivian; anyone past their first week · Strongest retention and lock-in play

IN PLAIN WORDS

Every trader has their own way of doing things: the setups they look for, what they mean by "cheap" or "a pullback", and rules like "never hold through earnings". FinViz doesn't know any of that today, so you rebuild the same screens and spell out what you mean every time. Your Playbook is a notebook FinViz keeps on how you trade, written in your own words. It fills in as you use the product, and it asks before adding anything. Once your setups are written down, FinViz can find stocks that fit them, explain results in your terms, and show you how a setup has played out in the past. You can read, edit or delete anything in it at any time. It reflects your habits back to you; it never tells you what you should do.

Workflow: habits become a playbook the trader owns

What the playbook looks like

```
YOUR PLAYBOOK
• Swing breakout (mine)  New 20-day high · Rel Vol > 1.5 · > SMA50  [Test this setup]
• Cheap (mine)           P/E < 18 · P/FCF < 20  [edit]
• Liquid (mine)          Avg Vol > 500K  [edit]
• No earnings risk       Earnings not within 5 days + noticed, confirmed Sep 30

Memory panel: every entry, where it came from, [edit] [delete]
```

Built from what you already do; no setup form

Asks before saving; no silent learning

Your language everywhere: alerts, rankings, explanations

Backtests shown as history, never a forecast

	Detail
Replaces	Anonymous presets that everyone shares, and a backtest page detached from the screener
Frictions removed	O4, O12 · F-a, F-b, F-j · P3, P16, P17
Feedback answered	R5, R8, R13, R22, R26, R27, R28
AI advances	Preference learning · programming by example on your own behavior · mixed-initiative confirmation · user-defined vocabulary · transparent memory · entries as reusable "skills"
Why the business	Switching cost (churn ↓) · Elite Backtests become a one-tap habit · playbook alerts are Elite · opt-in "traders like you add…" filters give a network effect without herding
Guardrails	Your own patterns reflected back, never "you should" · everything visible, editable, deletable · no learning without confirmation · trade history opt-in
Measures	A7 definitions reused · A8 playbook suggestions accepted · backtests run from the playbook · B4 churn · Q17
Built from	F45 your definitions · F46 filters you might need + blocks · F44 bring what you have · F51 similar traders · F20 backtests · new F55, F56

Hero sequences to prototype

1 · Pattern noticed: after a 6th screen without earnings-week stocks → "Add 'No earnings risk'?" → Add

2 · Test this setup: one tap on "Swing breakout (mine)" → matched 212 times in 3 years; moves over 1W / 1M / 3M

3 · Your language: an alert reads "entered your Swing breakout (mine): Rel Vol 2.6 (your > 1.5)"

THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

A trader's own rules are not in the product, so the screener cannot apply them.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

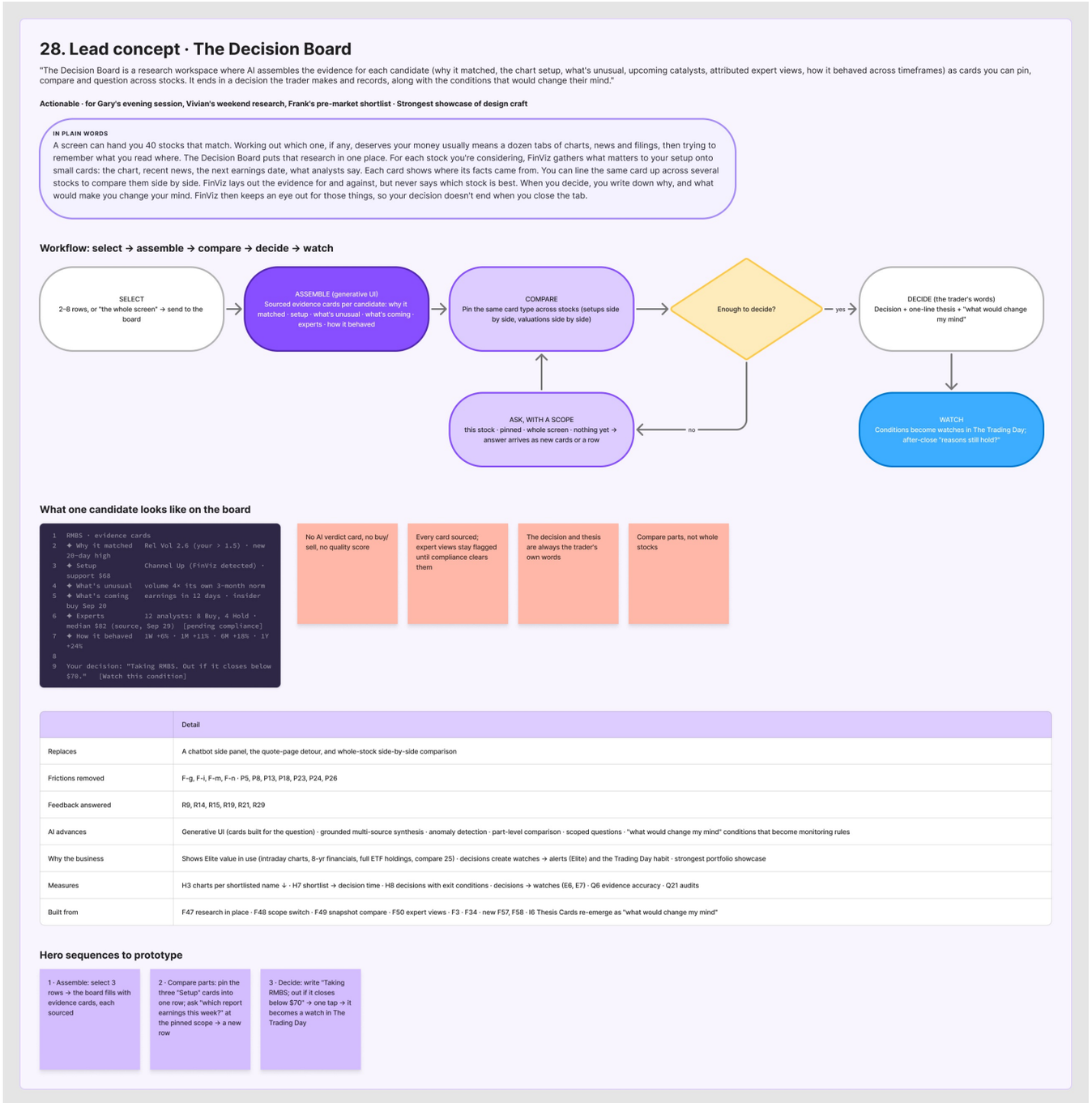
Your Playbook stores the trader's rules as a screen they can rerun. It is a workflow, not a tip.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I tested it against the same measures as the lead concept, so the comparison stays fair.

Concept: The Decision Board

FigJam working document, section 28.



28. Lead concept · The Decision Board

"The Decision Board is a research workspace where AI assembles the evidence for each candidate (why it matched, the chart setup, what's unusual, upcoming catalysts, attributed expert views, how it behaved across timeframes) as cards you can pin, compare and question across stocks. It ends in a decision the trader makes and records, along with the conditions that would change their mind."

Actionable · for Gary's evening session, Vivian's weekend research, Frank's pre-market shortlist · Strongest showcase of design craft

IN PLAIN WORDS

A screen can hand you 40 stocks that match. Working out which one, if any, deserves your money usually means a dozen tabs of charts, news and filings, then trying to remember what you read where. The Decision Board puts that research in one place. For each stock you're considering, FinViz gathers what matters to your setup onto small cards: the chart, recent news, the next earnings date, what analysts say. Each card shows where its facts came from. You can line the same card up across several stocks to compare them side by side. FinViz lays out the evidence for and against, but never says which stock is best. When you decide, you write down why, and what would make you change your mind. FinViz then keeps an eye out for those things, so your decision doesn't end when you close the tab.

Workflow: select → assemble → compare → decide → watch

What one candidate looks like on the board

```
1  RMBS · evidence cards
2  ✦ Why it matched   Rel Vol 2.6 (your > 1.5) · new 20-day high
3  ✦ Setup            Channel Up (FinViz detected) · support $68
4  ✦ What's unusual   volume 4× its own 3-month norm
5  ✦ What's coming    earnings in 12 days · insider buy Sep 20
6  ✦ Experts          12 analysts: 8 Buy, 4 Hold · median $82 (source, Sep 29)  [pending compliance]
7  ✦ How it behaved   1W +6% · 1M +11% · 6M +18% · 1Y +24%
8
9  Your decision: "Taking RMBS. Out if it closes below $70."   [Watch this condition]
```

No AI verdict card, no buy/sell, no quality score

Every card sourced; expert views stay flagged until compliance clears them

The decision and thesis are always the trader's own words

Compare parts, not whole stocks

	Detail
Replaces	A chatbot side panel, the quote-page detour, and whole-stock side-by-side comparison
Frictions removed	F-g, F-i, F-m, F-n · P5, P8, P13, P18, P23, P24, P26
Feedback answered	R9, R14, R15, R19, R21, R29
AI advances	Generative UI (cards built for the question) · grounded multi-source synthesis · anomaly detection · part-level comparison · scoped questions · "what would change my mind" conditions that become monitoring rules
Why the business	Shows Elite value in use (intraday charts, 8-yr financials, full ETF holdings, compare 25) · decisions create watches → alerts (Elite) and the Trading Day habit · strongest portfolio showcase
Measures	H3 charts per shortlisted name ↓ · H7 shortlist → decision time · H8 decisions with exit conditions · decisions → watches (E6, E7) · Q6 evidence accuracy · Q21 audits
Built from	F47 research in place · F48 scope switch · F49 snapshot compare · F50 expert views · F3 · F34 · new F57, F58 · I6 Thesis Cards re-emerge as "what would change my mind"

Hero sequences to prototype

1 · Assemble: select 3 rows → the board fills with evidence cards, each sourced

2 · Compare parts: pin the three "Setup" cards into one row; ask "which report earnings this week?" at the pinned scope → a new row

3 · Decide: write "Taking RMBS; out if it closes below $70" → one tap → it becomes a watch in The Trading Day

THE PROBLEM IT ANSWERS

Decisions are made quickly, and the reasons are lost.

THE SOLUTION AND THE INNOVATION

The Decision Board records the reason for each decision next to the evidence that supported it.

WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT MY LEADERSHIP

I drew the decision record as its own concept, so reasons can be reviewed later.

Eight design lead calls that changed the work

	Sept 23	Sept 23	Sept 23	Sept 24	Sept 30	Sept 30	Sept 30	Oct 1
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Map today's onboarding before designing	Desktop only, for now	One design for first-time and repeat users	Remove real frictions with new AI models	Optimize time to first success; no chat box first	Set the advice line, pending compliance	Lead with the swing trader's trading day	Bring teammates' screens in line with the rules

Teal marks the team design review

DESIGN LEAD CALL One design for first-time and repeat users

learnability is a property of every screen; no wizard, no tour.

AI explains and verifies; it never recommends, predicts or places orders.

every explanation is attached to a chip, a row or an alert.

“why it matched” on every row and every alert.

help per concept fades with fluency and returns after 30 days.

an alert is previewed against the last 30 days before it is saved.

AI writes filters, rules and columns, never chat bubbles.

base rates with sample sizes, never a confidence % on a trade.

screens and watches keep the reasons they were created.

Microsoft HAX guidelines and Google PAIR.

The AI UX workflow: AI drafts, the design lead decides

1 · Frame

DESIGN LEAD

Sets the question, audience, scope and rules: desktop only, no advice, purple means AI

2 · Draft

AI AGENTS

Research, docs, FigJam boards and Figma screens, drafted against those rules

3 · Review

LEAD + TEAM

Fact checks on the live site; critique with the team; rule breaks caught

4 · Decide

DESIGN LEAD

What to adopt, rename, cut or lead with, and why

5 · Propagate

AI AGENTS

Each decision applied across every doc, board and screen

Repeated in every phase: research → principles → concepts → screens. Rules set by the lead live in the project brief, so every AI draft starts from them.

Trust is designed, then measured

< 2%

filter translations wrong (weekly audit)

100%

explanation accuracy: “why it matched” built from real values

< 40%

alerts with no action, the biggest driver of trust erosion

0

compliance incidents: no advice, no forecasts, no orders

Targets from the KPI framework, sitting next to product metrics so a faster screen never comes at the cost of a wrong one.

How success will be measured

42 → 21

days from sign-up to Elite

3+ days

a week re-running a saved screen: the North Star

< 5 min

to a first saved screen

> 40%

of alerts lead to an action

Concept-stage work: these are targets with a plan to baseline them, not results.

What leading with AI taught me

The bottleneck moves to judgment

Drafts take minutes. The lead's value is framing, checking facts and deciding what to keep.

Write the rules down once

Rules in the project brief made every AI draft start compliant.

Check the live product, not the docs

One live-site walk overturned two assumptions.

Reconcile, don't overwrite

Teammates' screens kept their best ideas and lost only what broke the rules.

MORE WORK

More work, on request.

PROJECT	WHAT IT IS
Wells Fargo mySMALLBUSINESS	A B2B mobile app that helps small business owners track spending and plan
Meridian Navigator	An AI trading prototype built in SwiftUI, with a design system shared with Figma
Show It	A live prototype of FinViz’s hero mechanic, with an eval that scores the AI

Full archived case studies at michaeljthibodeau.com

CONTACT

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